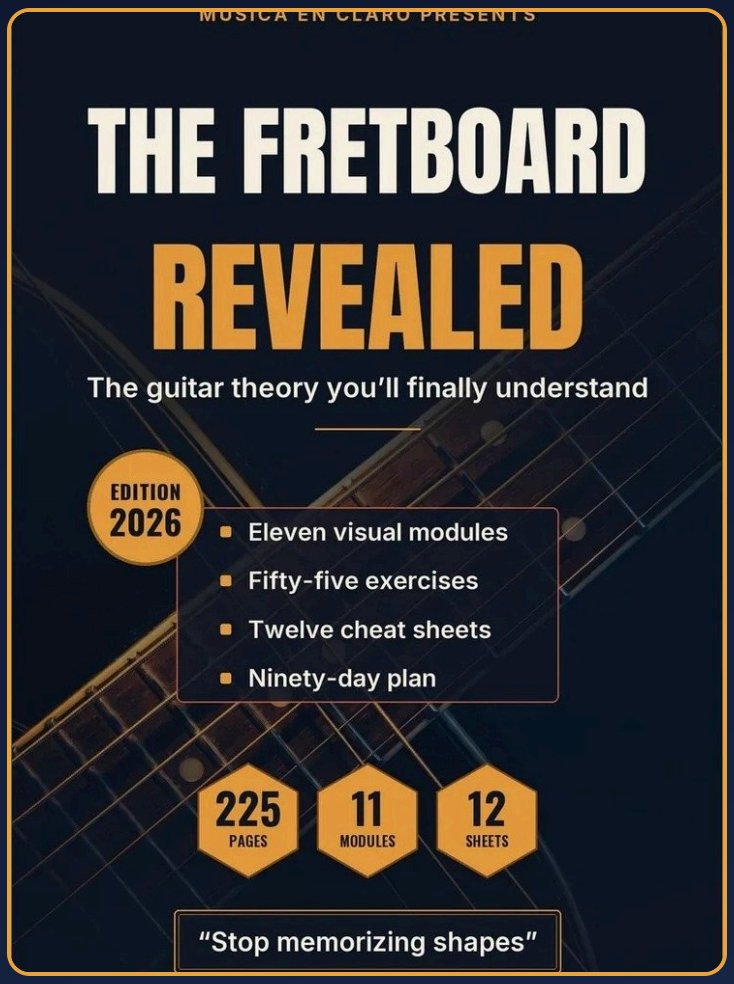
BONUS 4

180 Exercises

Two exercises a day, five minutes each, over 18 weeks



How the 180 exercises work

Eighteen weeks. Five days a week. **Two exercises a day, five minutes each**: that is 15 hours of guided practice. Every exercise has a goal and a box to tick when you can do it.

- Do the two exercises of the day in order. Use a timer for five minutes each.
- If an exercise feels too hard, repeat it the next day. If it feels easy, move on.
- The exercises follow the book module by module: weeks 1-3 go with module 1, weeks 4-6 with modules 2 and 3, and so on.
- All the diagrams use standard tuning (E A D G B E).

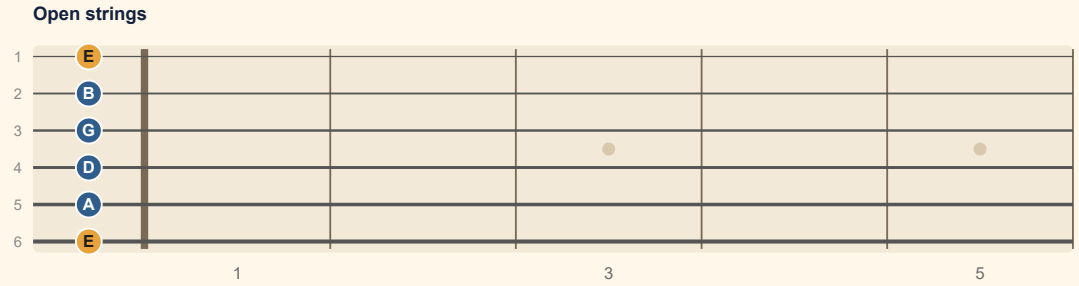
WEEKS	EXERCISES	THEME
1	1-10	Open strings and natural notes
2	11-20	Strings 4 and 3, octave shapes
3	21-30	Sharps, flats and finding any note
4	31-40	Intervals on the neck
5	41-50	The major scale formula
6	51-60	Positions, relative minor, pentatonic
7	61-70	Dorian and Mixolydian
8	71-80	The other modes
9	81-90	Triads and harmonizing the scale
10	91-100	Barre chords and sevenths
11	101-110	Sevenths, sus chords, tensions
12	111-120	CAGED: shapes C, A, G
13	121-130	CAGED completed and pentatonic boxes
14	131-140	Progressions and Roman numerals
15	141-150	Circle of fifths and modulation
16	151-160	Soloing with intention
17	161-170	Modal vamps and expression
18	171-180	Working songs out and writing

Week 1: Open strings and natural notes

EXERCISE 1 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: Name the six open strings

1. Play each open string from 6 to 1 and say its name out loud: E, A, D, G, B, E.
2. Repeat three times, then say them from memory with your eyes closed, touching each string.



Standard tuning, string 6 (low) to string 1 (high).

☐ Goal: Name all six open strings in order, 6 to 1, without hesitation.

EXERCISE 2 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Open strings in random order

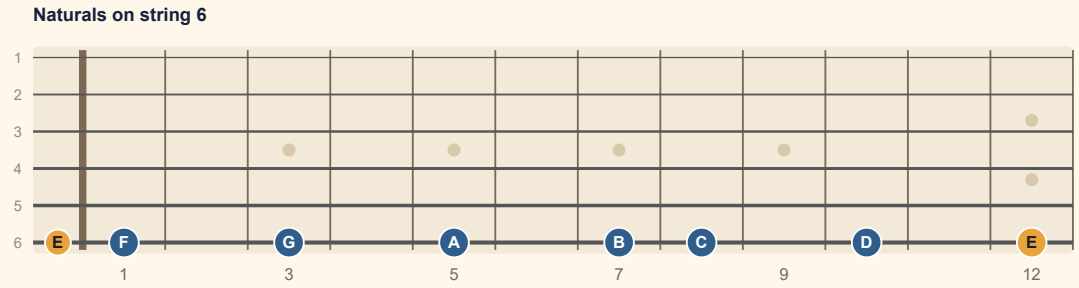
1. Set a metronome to 60 bpm. Play one open string per beat.
2. Go 6 to 1, then 1 to 6, then jump around at random, always saying the name as you play.
3. Finish with 30 seconds of random jumps without looking at the neck.

☐ Goal: Name any open string instantly, in any order, at one string per second.

EXERCISE 3 — 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: Natural notes on string 6

1. Play string 6 at frets 0, 1, 3, 5, 7, 8, 10, 12 and say E F G A B C D E.
2. Go up and back down twice, one note per beat at 60 bpm.
3. Cover the neck with your hand and name the fret 5 and fret 8 notes from memory.



Frets 0, 1, 3, 5, 7, 8, 10, 12.

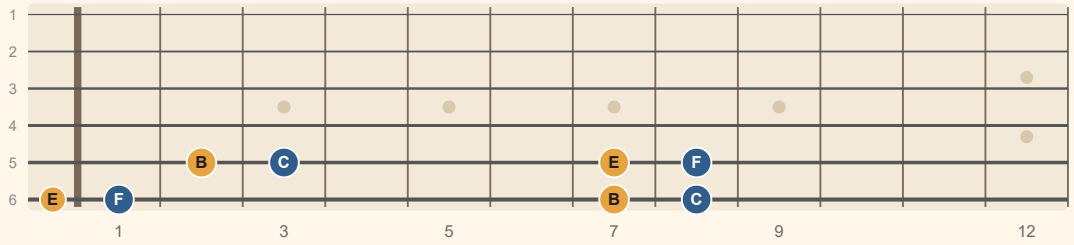
☐ Goal: Play and name the eight natural notes on string 6 (E to E).

EXERCISE 4 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Spot the two half steps

1. On string 6 play E (fret 0) to F (fret 1): one fret, a half step. Then play B (fret 7) to C (fret 8).
2. Now play F to G (frets 1 to 3). It takes two frets: a whole step.
3. Say out loud: E-F and B-C are the only natural neighbors with no note in between.

The two natural half steps



E-F and B-C sit one fret apart on every string.

☐ Goal: Explain in one sentence that E-F and B-C are half steps and all other natural neighbors are whole steps.

EXERCISE 5 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: String 6 up and down by name

1. Set a metronome to 70 bpm. Play the naturals on string 6 up from fret 0 to 12 and back down, saying each name on the beat.
2. If you miss a name, stop, find the note again, and restart from that note.
3. Do two clean rounds.

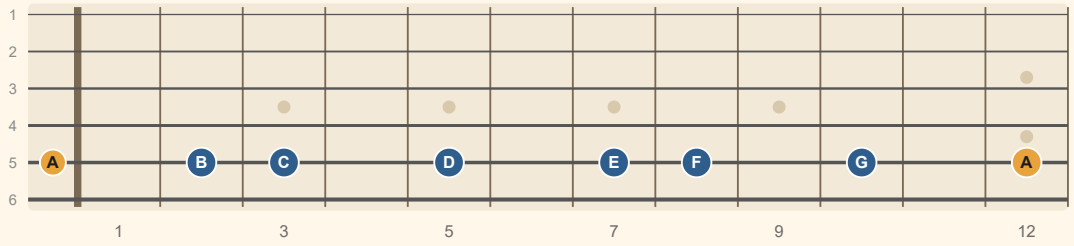
☐ Goal: Run string 6 up and down at 70 bpm with no wrong names.

EXERCISE 6 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Natural notes on string 5

1. Play string 5 at frets 0, 2, 3, 5, 7, 8, 10, 12 and say A B C D E F G A.
2. Go up and back down twice at 60 bpm.
3. Notice B-C (frets 2-3) and E-F (frets 7-8) are the half steps again.

Naturals on string 5



Frets 0, 2, 3, 5, 7, 8, 10, 12.

☐ Goal: Play and name the eight natural notes on string 5 (A to A).

EXERCISE 7 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: Fret-number call-out on string 5

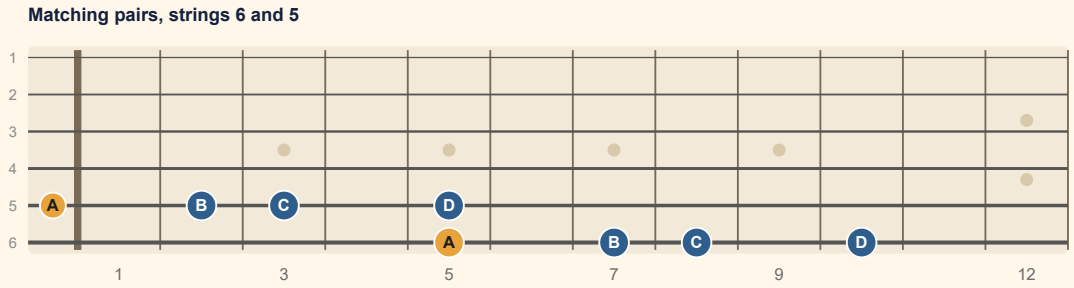
1. Use a timer or phone to pick fret numbers from this list at random: 2, 3, 5, 7, 8, 10, 12.
2. Play the fret on string 5 and name the note before the next beat at 50 bpm: 2=B, 3=C, 5=D, 7=E, 8=F, 10=G, 12=A.
3. Do 20 random calls.

☐ Goal: Name the string 5 note at any natural fret in about one second.

EXERCISE 8 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: Same note on strings 6 and 5

1. Play A at string 6 fret 5, then the open string 5. They sound the same pitch.
2. Match B (string 6 fret 7 = string 5 fret 2), C (8 = 3) and D (10 = 5) the same way.
3. Play each pair back to back and listen for the match.



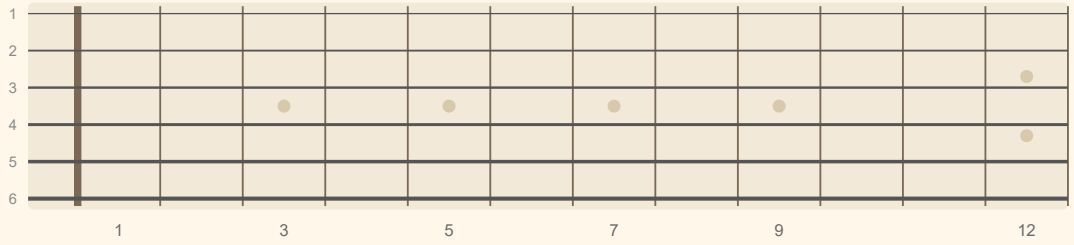
Fret 5 on string 6 = the next open string. Same pitch, two places.

☐ Goal: Find the same natural note on strings 6 and 5 using the rule: fret 5 on string 6 equals the open string 5.

EXERCISE 9 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Find every A on strings 6 and 5

1. Without help, find every A on strings 6 and 5 between frets 0 and 12.
2. Play each one and check by ear that they all sound like the same note.
3. Answer: string 6 fret 5, string 5 open, string 5 fret 12.



Mark the A notes on strings 6 and 5, then check the answer in the steps.

☐ Goal: Find all three A positions on strings 6 and 5 in under 20 seconds.

EXERCISE 10 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Week 1 speed round

1. Have a friend or a random list call 20 notes from E, F, G, A, B, C, D.
2. For each one, play it on string 6, then on string 5 (if it exists within frets 0-12).
3. Aim for 10 correct in a row.

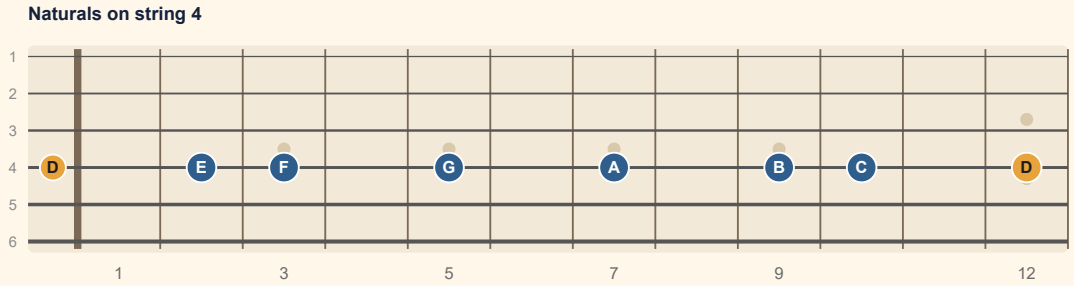
☐ Goal: Find any natural note on strings 6 and 5 within two seconds.

Week 2: Strings 4 and 3, octave shapes

EXERCISE 11 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: Naturals on string 4

1. Play string 4 at frets 0, 2, 3, 5, 7, 9, 10, 12 and say D E F G A B C D.
2. Go up and back down twice at 60 bpm.
3. Notice the half steps: E-F (frets 2-3) and B-C (frets 9-10).



Frets 0, 2, 3, 5, 7, 9, 10, 12.

☐ Goal: Play and name the eight natural notes on string 4 (D to D).

EXERCISE 12 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Whole or half? String 4 walk

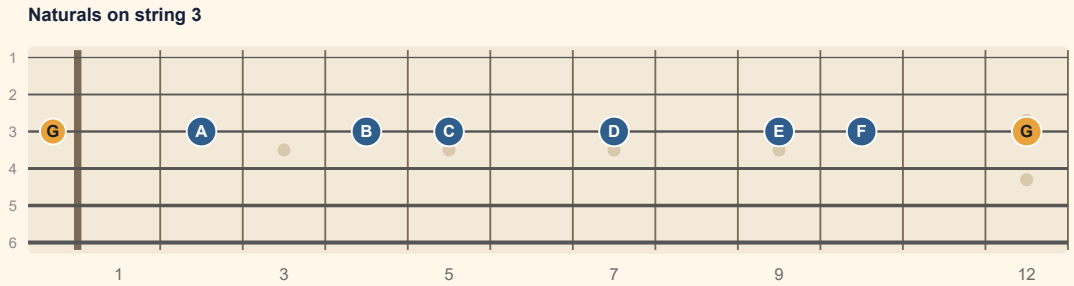
1. Play from the open D on string 4 up to fret 12 one natural at a time.
2. Before each move, say Whole or Half: D-E W, E-F H, F-G W, G-A W, A-B W, B-C H, C-D W.
3. Check yourself, then repeat down the string.

☐ Goal: Say the whole/half step pattern of the naturals on string 4 from memory.

EXERCISE 13 — 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: Naturals on string 3

1. Play string 3 at frets 0, 2, 4, 5, 7, 9, 10, 12 and say G A B C D E F G.
2. Go up and back down twice at 60 bpm.
3. Notice B-C is at frets 4-5 here, and E-F at frets 9-10.



Frets 0, 2, 4, 5, 7, 9, 10, 12.

☐ Goal: Play and name the eight natural notes on string 3 (G to G).

EXERCISE 14 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: String 3 name-the-fret game

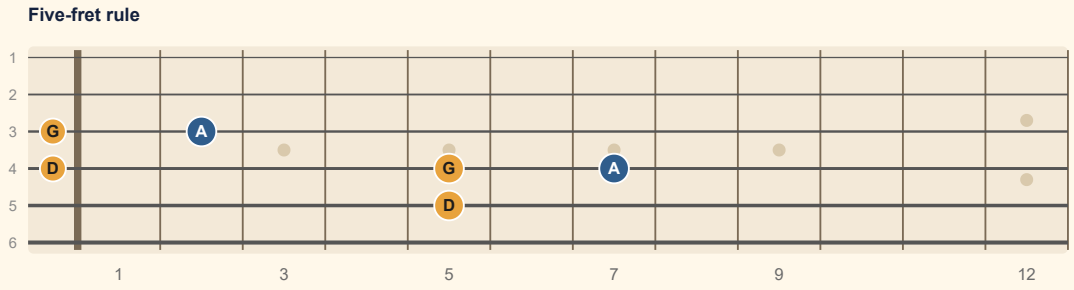
1. Pick a fret at random from 2, 4, 5, 7, 9, 10, 12. Name the note, then play it to check.
2. Do 15 picks at 50 bpm, one every four beats.
3. Redo any you got wrong.

☐ Goal: Name a string 3 natural from its fret number without counting from the open string.

EXERCISE 15 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: The five-fret rule

1. Play fret 5 on string 5, then the open string 4. Both are D.
2. Do the same on strings 4 and 3: fret 5 on string 4 (G) equals the open string 3. Then try fret 7 on string 4 (A) and fret 2 on string 3 (A).
3. Say the rule: fret 5 on one string matches the open string below it (not between strings 3 and 2).



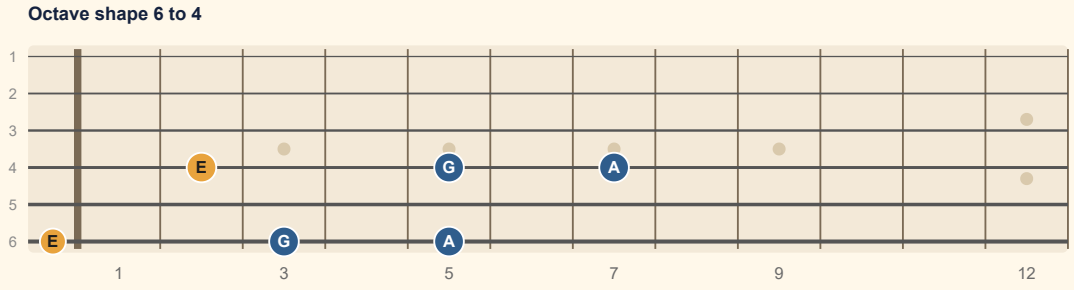
Same pitch, neighboring strings.

☐ Goal: Use the five-fret rule to jump between neighboring strings.

EXERCISE 16 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Octave shape: strings 6 and 4

1. Play E on string 6 open, then E on string 4 at fret 2. That is an octave: same name, higher sound.
2. Slide the shape: G at string 6 fret 3 and string 4 fret 5; A at string 6 fret 5 and string 4 fret 7.
3. Rule: the octave is two strings up and two frets higher.



Two strings up, two frets higher.

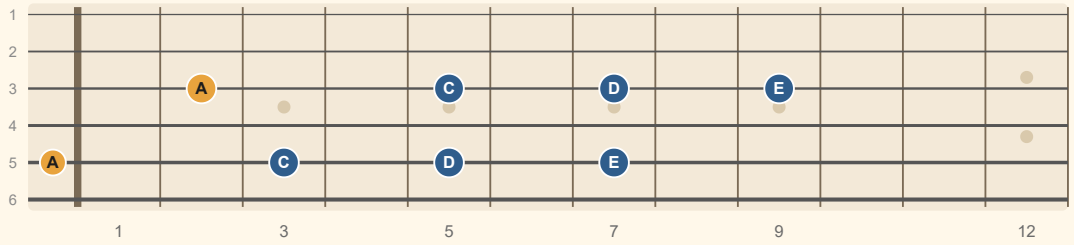
☐ Goal: Find the octave of any note on string 6 on string 4 using the +2 fret shape.

EXERCISE 17 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: Octave shape: strings 5 and 3

1. Play A on string 5 open, then A on string 3 at fret 2.
2. Slide the shape to C (string 5 fret 3, string 3 fret 5), D (5 and 7) and E (7 and 9).
3. Say the note name each time and listen for the octave.

Octave shape 5 to 3



Two strings up, two frets higher.

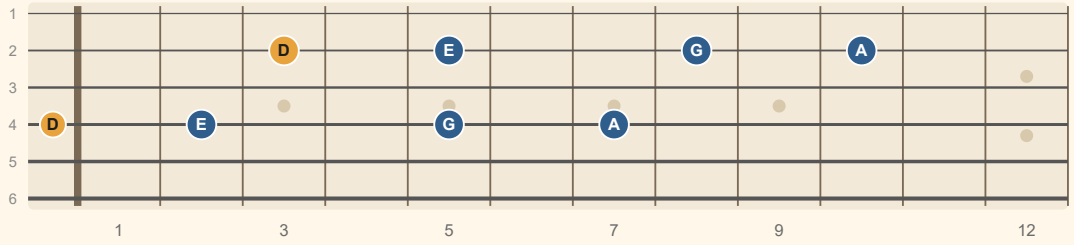
☐ Goal: Find the octave of any note on string 5 on string 3 with the +2 fret shape.

EXERCISE 18 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: Octave shape: strings 4 and 2

1. Play D on string 4 open and D on string 2 at fret 3. Because of the tuning between strings 3 and 2, this shape is three frets higher.
2. Also try E (string 4 fret 2, string 2 fret 5), G (5 and 8) and A (7 and 10).
3. Say each name aloud and compare with the 6 to 4 shape.

Octave shape 4 to 2



Two strings up, three frets higher.

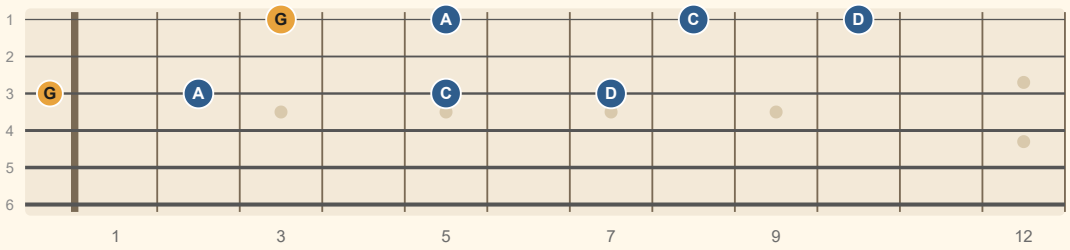
☐ Goal: Play the octave shape between strings 4 and 2 and explain why it is +3 frets.

EXERCISE 19 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Octave shape: strings 3 and 1

1. Play G on string 3 open and G on string 1 at fret 3.
2. Then A (string 3 fret 2, string 1 fret 5), C (5 and 8) and D (7 and 10).
3. Alternate the 6-to-4 and 3-to-1 shapes on A: string 6 fret 5 / string 4 fret 7, then string 3 fret 2 / string 1 fret 5.

Octave shape 3 to 1



Two strings up, three frets higher.

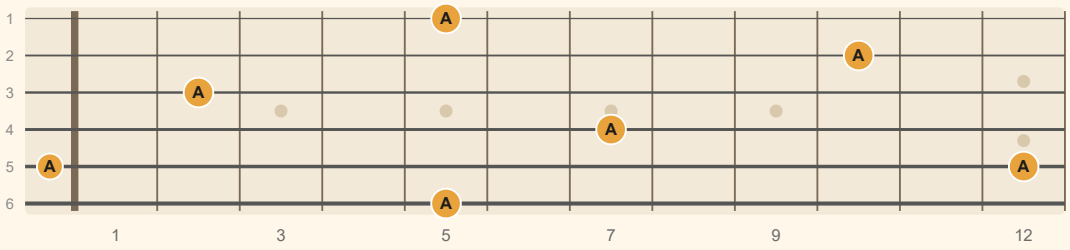
☐ Goal: Play octaves on strings 3 and 1 and tell which octave shapes use +2 and which use +3.

EXERCISE 20 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Week 2 octave tour of A

1. Start with A on string 5 open. Play its octave on string 3 (fret 2), then string 1 (fret 5).
2. Now start on A at string 6 fret 5, then string 4 fret 7, then string 2 fret 10.
3. Play the full list in order, saying A each time: 6/5, 5/0, 4/7, 3/2, 2/10, 1/5, 5/12.

Every A up to fret 12



Use the octave shapes to jump from one A to the next.

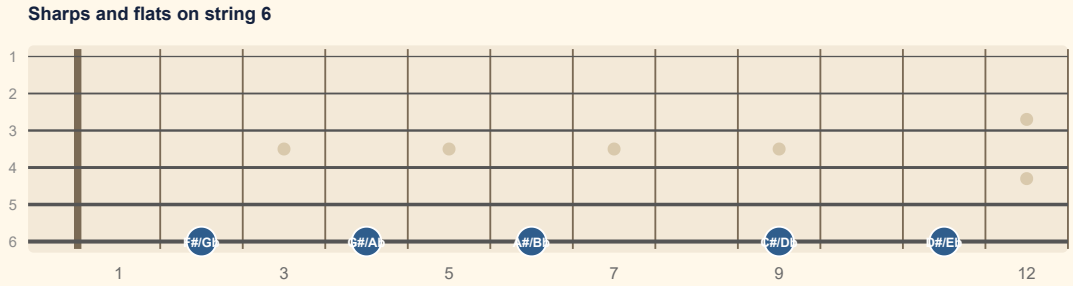
☐ Goal: Find every A on the neck up to fret 12 in under 30 seconds.

Week 3: Sharps, flats and finding any note

EXERCISE 21 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: Sharps and flats on string 6

1. A sharp raises a note one fret; a flat lowers it one fret. Play string 6 at frets 2, 4, 6, 9, 11.
2. Name each with both names: F#/Gb, G#/Ab, A#/Bb, C#/Db, D#/Eb.
3. Play each one between its two natural neighbors.



Each black-key note has two names.

☐ Goal: Name the five sharp/flat notes on string 6 with both names.

EXERCISE 22 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Chromatic walk on string 6

1. Play every fret from 0 to 12 on string 6, one per beat at 60 bpm.
2. Going up, name with sharps: E F F# G G# A A# B C C# D D# E. Going down, name with flats: E Eb D Db C B Bb A Ab G Gb F E.
3. Do two full rounds.

☐ Goal: Name all 12 notes on string 6 both ways, sharps up and flats down.

EXERCISE 23 — 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: The twelve-note alphabet

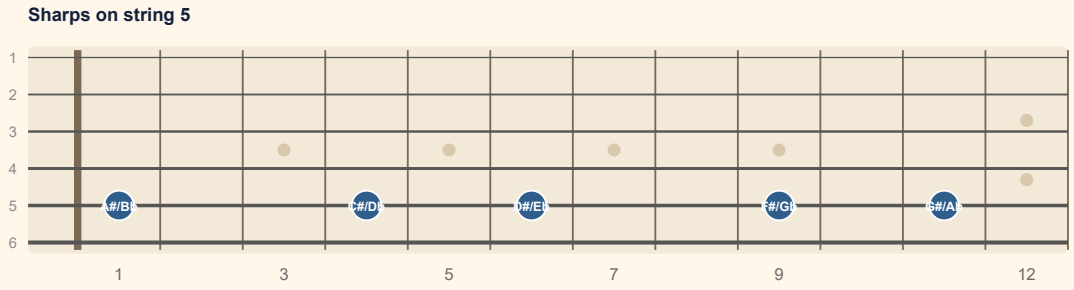
1. Write the 12 notes from memory on paper, starting on A: A A# B C C# D D# E F F# G G#.
2. Circle the two places with no sharp: B-C and E-F.
3. Say the alphabet forward and backward twice without looking.

☐ Goal: Recite the 12 notes in order, starting from any of them.

EXERCISE 24 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Sharps on string 5

1. Find the five sharps on string 5 at frets 1, 4, 6, 9, 11: A#, C#, D#, F#, G#.
2. Play each between its natural neighbors: A-A#-B, C-C#-D, D-D#-E, F-F#-G, G-G#-A.
3. Say both names (A#/Bb, C#/Db...) for each.



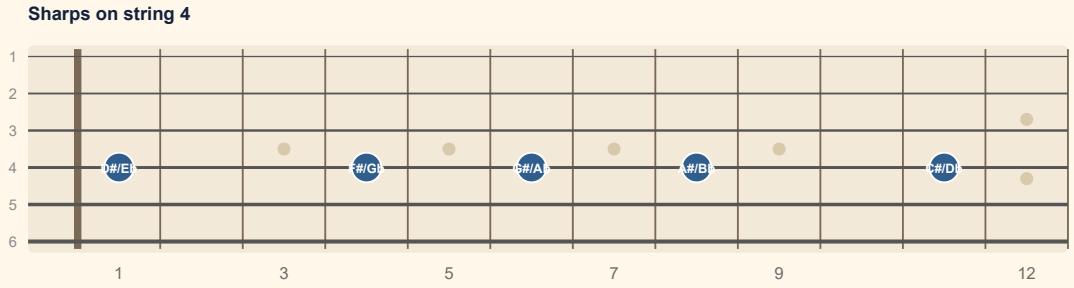
Black-key notes on string 5.

☐ Goal: Name every sharp/flat on string 5 by fret number.

EXERCISE 25 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Sharps on string 4

1. Find the five sharps on string 4 at frets 1, 4, 6, 8, 11: D#, F#, G#, A#, C#.
2. Play each between its natural neighbors, saying all three names.
3. Check against string 5: the D# on string 4 fret 1 is also string 5 fret 6.



Black-key notes on string 4.

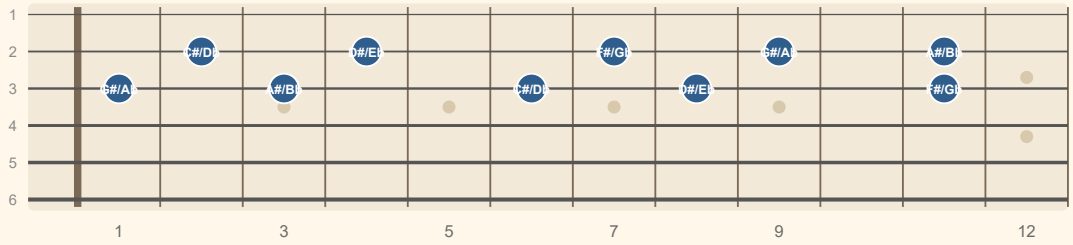
☐ Goal: Name every sharp/flat on string 4 by fret number.

EXERCISE 26 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Sharps on strings 3 and 2

1. String 3: G# fret 1, A# fret 3, C# fret 6, D# fret 8, F# fret 11. Play and name each.
2. String 2: C# fret 2, D# fret 4, F# fret 7, G# fret 9, A# fret 11. Play and name each.
3. Find one matching pair across the two strings: F# at string 3 fret 11 and string 2 fret 7.

Sharps on strings 3 and 2



Strings 3 and 2 are four frets apart (not five).

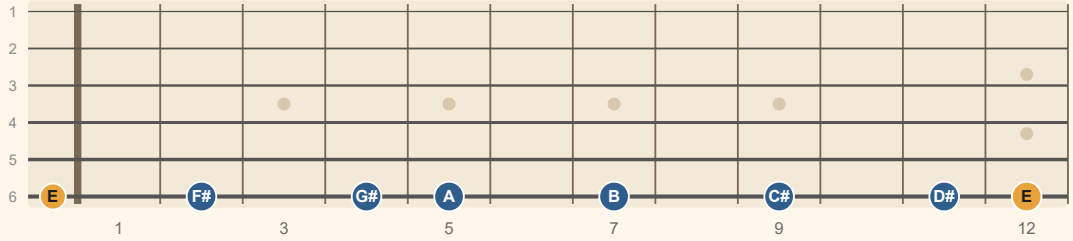
☐ Goal: Name every sharp/flat on strings 3 and 2 by fret number.

EXERCISE 27 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: Build a major scale from the step map

1. The major scale steps: Whole, Whole, Half, Whole, Whole, Whole, Half. Start on the open string 6 (E).
2. Play frets 0, 2, 4, 5, 7, 9, 11, 12 and name them: E F# G# A B C# D# E.
3. Check each step is the right size. Say Whole or Half as you go.

E major on string 6



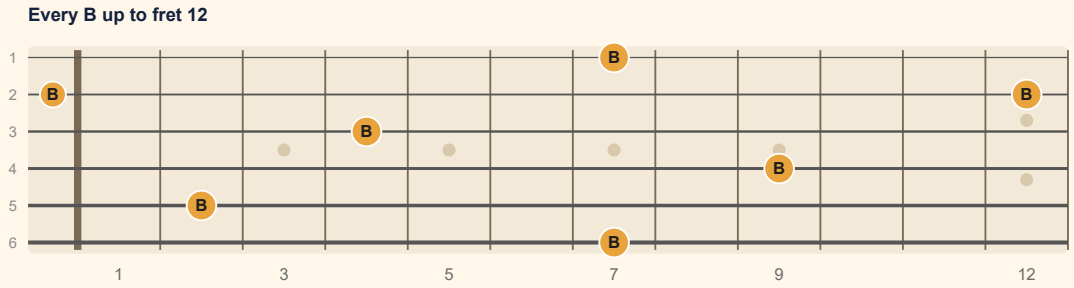
W W H W W W H from the open string.

☐ Goal: Use the step map to play a major scale on one string and name every note.

EXERCISE 28 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: Find any note: anchor and nudge

1. Use a known natural note as an anchor, then move one fret. To find F#, go to F (string 6 fret 1) and go one fret up to fret 2.
2. Find B on string 4: anchor on A (fret 7) then up two frets to fret 9. Find Bb on string 4: fret 8.
3. Now find Eb on string 5 (D is fret 5, so Eb is fret 6) and C# on string 3 (C is fret 5, so C# is fret 6).



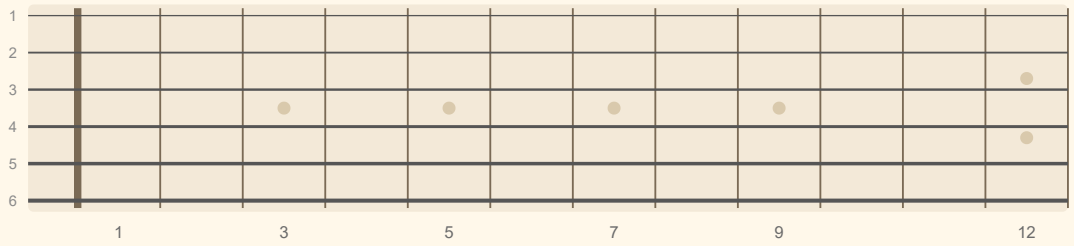
Use anchors to reach each B.

☐ Goal: Find a sharp or flat in two moves: land on the nearest natural, then step one fret.

EXERCISE 29 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Ten-second note finder

1. Pick one string (say string 6). Find each of these notes in 10 seconds or less: C, F#, Bb, D, G#, E, A, C#, F, B, Eb, G.
2. Answers on string 6: C 8, F# 2, Bb 6, D 10, G# 4, E 0, A 5, C# 9, F 1, B 7, Eb 11, G 3.
3. Repeat the whole list on string 5.



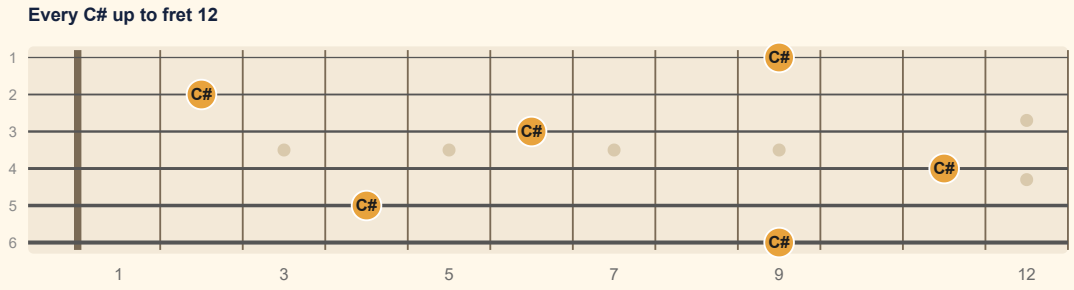
Mark each note as you find it.

☐ Goal: Find any note on string 6 or 5 within ten seconds.

EXERCISE 30 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Module 1 mastery check

1. Pick a note at random from the 12. Find it on all six strings between frets 0 and 12.
2. Example C#: string 6 fret 9, string 5 fret 4, string 4 fret 11, string 3 fret 6, string 2 fret 2, string 1 fret 9.
3. Do three different notes in five minutes.



All six positions of C#/Db.

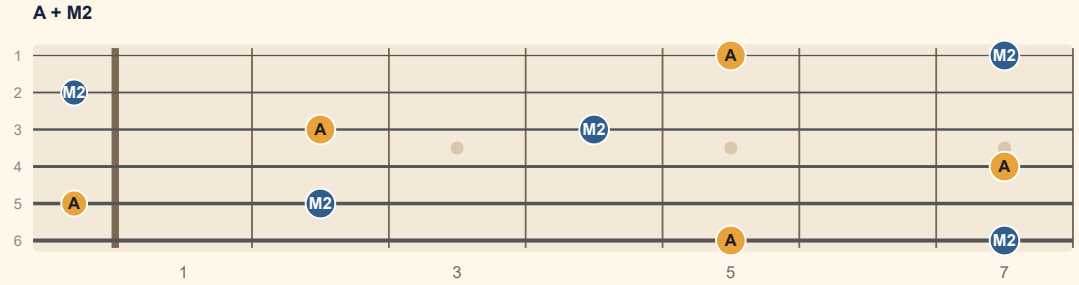
☐ Goal: Find any note on every string in under 30 seconds per note.

Week 4: Intervals on the neck

EXERCISE 31 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: Hear the whole step

1. Play your open A string (string 5), then the same string at fret 2 (B).
2. Repeat three times, slowly, listening to the size of the step. This distance is a major second (M2), also called a whole step.
3. Now start on the open low E string (string 6) and play fret 0, fret 2 (F#), fret 4 (G#). Each move is one whole step.



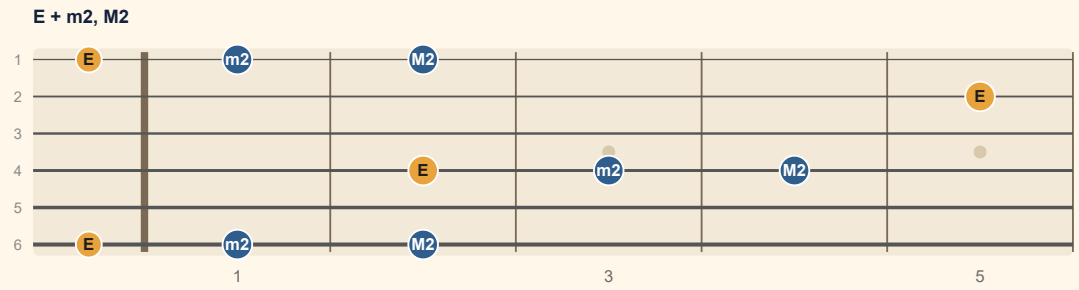
A major second sits two frets above the root on the same string.

☐ Goal: You can play a major second from any string and say it is two frets.

EXERCISE 32 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Hear the half step

1. Play the open E string (string 6), then fret 1 (F). That one-fret move is a minor second (m2), or half step.
2. Play A to A# on string 5 (fret 0, fret 1). Notice how tense and close it sounds.
3. On string 6, play G (fret 3), A (fret 5), A# (fret 6), C (fret 8). Say each distance out loud: whole, half, whole.



On string 6: the m2 is F (fret 1), the M2 is F# (fret 2).

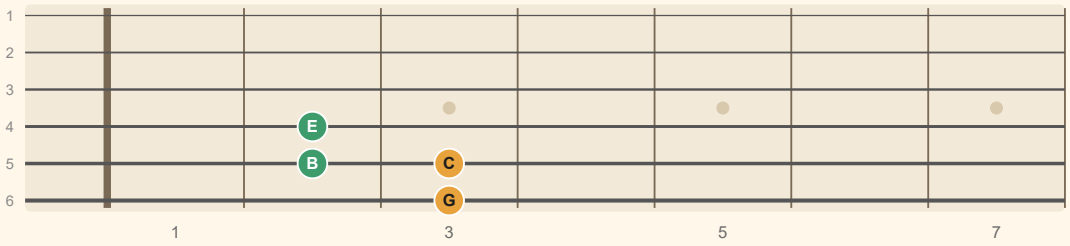
☐ Goal: You can tell a one-fret move from a two-fret move by ear and by eye.

EXERCISE 33 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: The major third shape

1. Play G on string 6, fret 3. Then play B on string 5, fret 2 (one string up, one fret back). That is a major third (M3).
2. Play the two notes together, then one after the other. Most players hear this as bright and happy.
3. Repeat with C on string 5, fret 3, and E on string 4, fret 2. Same shape, new notes.

Major third shape



M3 shape: one string up, one fret toward the nut.

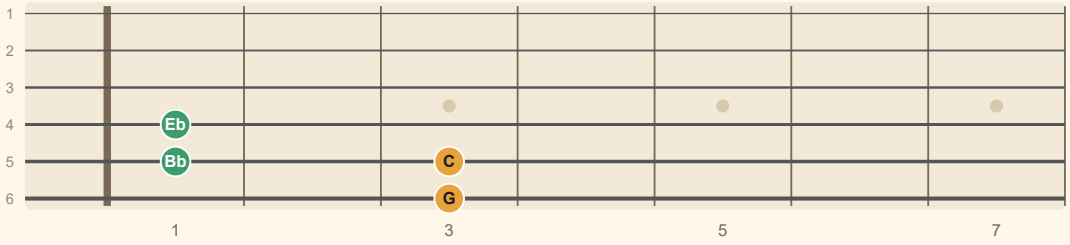
☐ Goal: You can land a major third from a root on strings 6 or 5 without counting frets.

EXERCISE 34 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: The minor third shape

1. Play G on string 6, fret 3, then Bb on string 5, fret 1 (one string up, two frets back). This is a minor third (m3).
2. Play it right after the major third from the last exercise. The only change is a single fret, but the mood turns darker.
3. Repeat from C on string 5, fret 3 up to Eb on string 4, fret 1.

Minor third shape



m3 shape: one string up, two frets toward the nut.

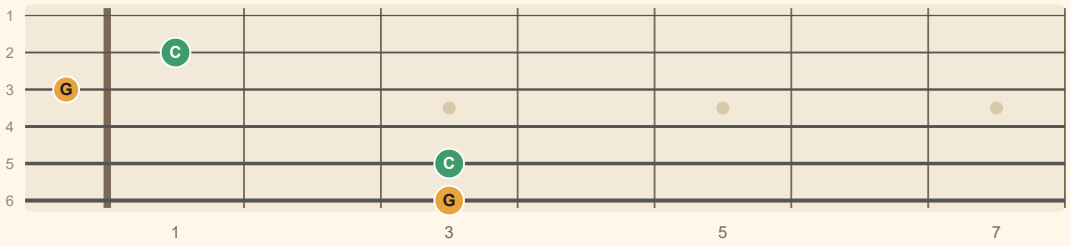
☐ Goal: You can name which third you played (major or minor) from sound alone, at least most of the time.

EXERCISE 35 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Fourths between strings

1. Play G on string 6, fret 3, then C on string 5, fret 3. Same fret, next string: a perfect fourth (P4).
2. Slide the pair to fret 5 (A to D), then to fret 7 (B to E). The shape never changes.
3. Try the one exception: play open G (string 3), then C on string 2, fret 1. The G and B strings are tuned a third apart, so the fourth moves up one fret.

Perfect fourth shape



P4 = same fret, next string up (except strings 3 to 2).

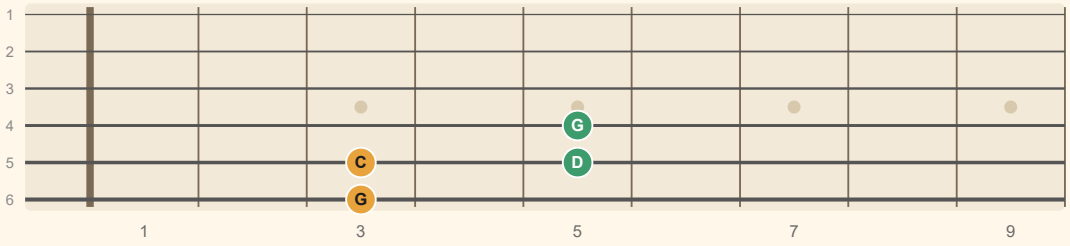
☐ Goal: You can find a perfect fourth above any note on strings 6 to 3 by moving one string up at the same fret.

EXERCISE 36 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Fifths: the two-fret hop

1. Play G on string 6, fret 3, then D on string 5, fret 5. One string up, two frets forward: a perfect fifth (P5).
2. Play them together. This open, stable sound is the heart of a power chord.
3. Move the shape to start on A (string 6, fret 5) and land on E (string 5, fret 7). Then try C on string 5, fret 3, up to G on string 4, fret 5.

Perfect fifth shape



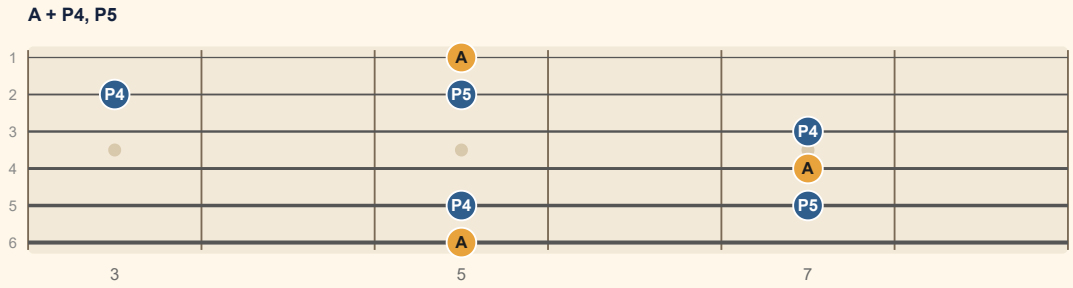
P5 shape: one string up, two frets forward.

☐ Goal: You can place a perfect fifth from any root on strings 6 or 5 and hear it as stable.

EXERCISE 37 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: Fourth and fifth side by side

1. Pick A on string 6, fret 5 as your root.
2. Play the P4 (D, string 5, fret 5), then the P5 (E, string 5, fret 7). Hear how the fourth leans toward resolving while the fifth feels settled.
3. Switch roots to B on string 6, fret 7 and repeat. Its fourth is E (string 5, fret 7), its fifth is F# (string 5, fret 9).



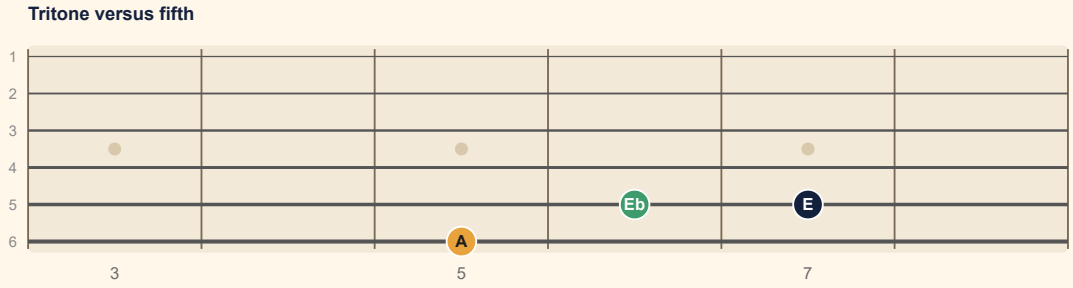
From A (string 6, fret 5): P4 is D, P5 is E.

☐ Goal: You can say which of two notes is the fourth and which is the fifth after playing them.

EXERCISE 38 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: The tense one: the tritone

1. Play A on string 6, fret 5. Then play Eb on string 5, fret 6 (one string up, one fret forward). This is a flat fifth, or tritone (b5).
2. Now play the true fifth, E, on string 5, fret 7. Move back and forth between fret 6 and fret 7 and listen to tension turning into rest.
3. Try the same on G: string 6 fret 3, then Db (string 5, fret 4), then D (string 5, fret 5).



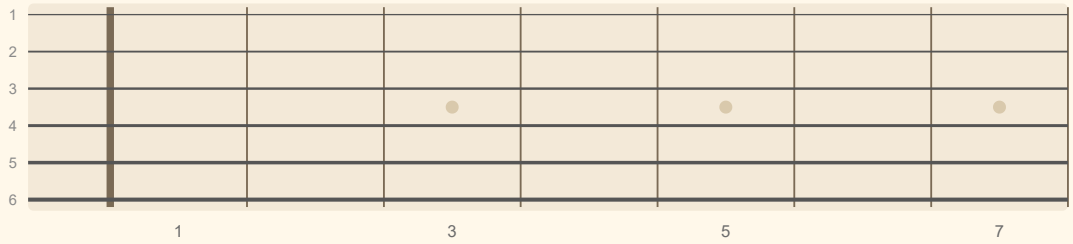
b5 is one fret below the P5.

☐ Goal: You can hear the difference between a b5 and a P5 one fret apart.

EXERCISE 39 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Fill in the intervals

1. Place your finger on G, string 6, fret 3.
2. On string 5 find and play the M3 (B), the P4 (C) and the P5 (D). On a sheet of paper write each note name and fret.
3. Check against the earlier shapes, then repeat from E on string 6 (open): M3 is G#, P4 is A, P5 is B on string 5.



Mark G (string 6 fret 3) and the three target notes on string 5.

☐ Goal: You can find M3, P4 and P5 from a root and write the fret number for each.

EXERCISE 40 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Sing and play the octave and fifth

1. Play G on string 6, fret 3 and G on string 4, fret 5 (skip one string, two frets forward). This is an octave (P8): same note, higher.
2. Think of the first two notes of Twinkle Twinkle, C then G: that jump is a perfect fifth. Find it on your guitar starting from C on string 5, fret 3.
3. Hum each interval (M2, M3, P4, P5, P8) before you play it, then check yourself.

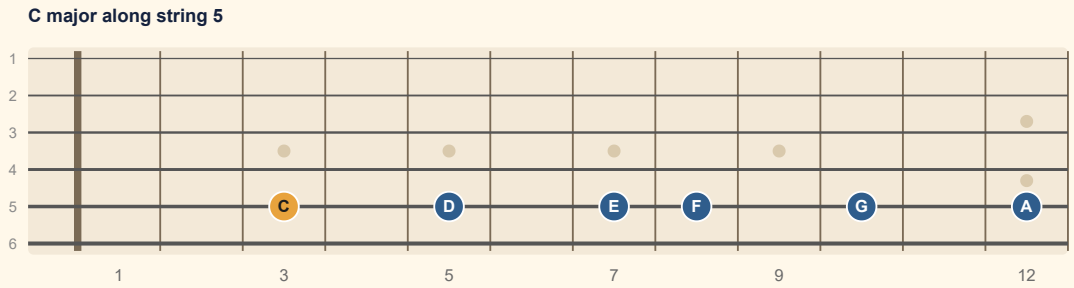
☐ Goal: You can recognize at least three of the five intervals by ear, and your hummed note matches the guitar.

Week 5: The major scale formula

EXERCISE 41 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: The major scale formula

1. The major scale is built with this pattern: whole, whole, half, whole, whole, whole, half (W W H W W W H).
2. Start on C, string 5, fret 3. Play C D E F G A along the string (frets 3, 5, 7, 8, 10, 12). Say whole or half for each move.
3. Notice the only half step so far is E to F (fret 7 to fret 8). The last half step, B to C, comes just past fret 12.



C major on one string: whole steps except E to F.

☐ Goal: You can recite W W H W W W H and point to where each half step falls.

EXERCISE 42 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Spell C major on paper

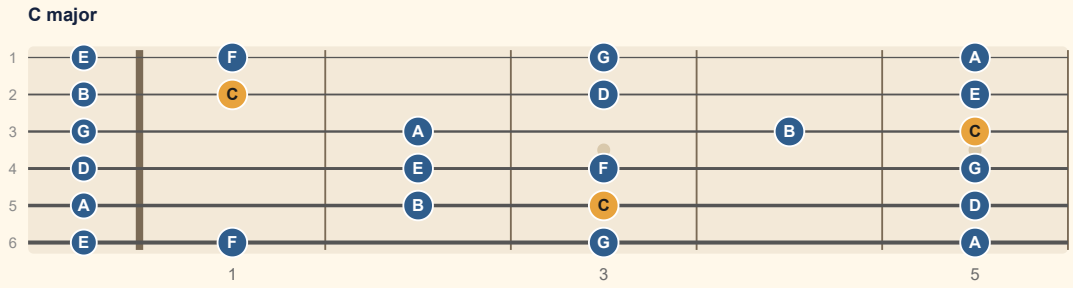
1. Write the seven letters of C major: C D E F G A B. No sharps, no flats.
2. Mark the two half steps with a small arrow: E to F, and B to C.
3. Without looking, say the notes forward, then backward, then every second note (C E G B). Use the degree numbers 1 to 7 too.

☐ Goal: You can write C major from memory with its two half-step spots marked.

EXERCISE 43 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: C major in open position

1. Look at the diagram. Play every note of C major in the first five frets, string by string, from string 6 up to string 1.
2. Say each note name as you play it; skip none.
3. Find every C. How many do you see? On which string is the root at fret 3?



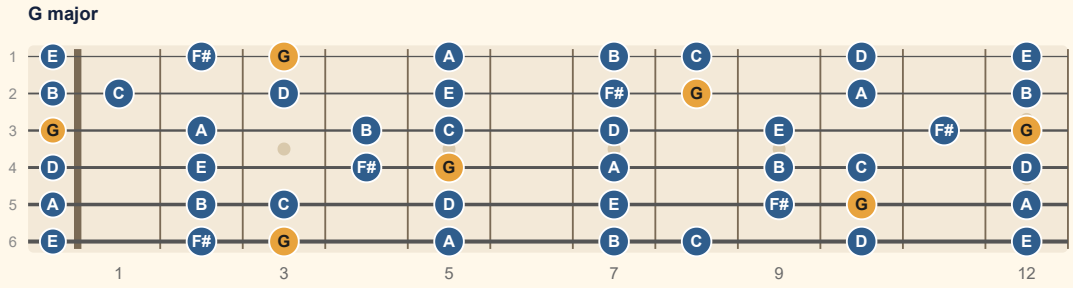
All notes of C major in frets 0 to 5.

☐ Goal: You can play all C major notes in open position while naming them.

EXERCISE 44 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Build G major with the formula

1. Start on G and apply W W H W W W H: G, A, B, C, D, E, and then F#.
2. Why F#? From E, a whole step lands on F#, not F. The seventh note sits a half step under G.
3. Write the seven notes down, then check them against the diagram.



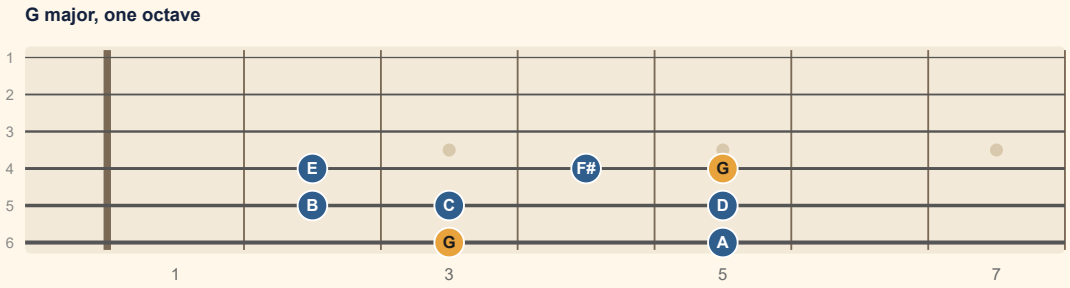
G major: the only sharp is F#.

☐ Goal: You can explain in one sentence why G major has one sharp.

EXERCISE 45 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: G major across three strings

1. Play G major as three short groups: string 6 (G fret 3, A fret 5), string 5 (B fret 2, C fret 3, D fret 5), string 4 (E fret 2, F# fret 4, G fret 5).
2. Go up slowly, then come back down. Say the note names aloud.
3. Find the F# and play it on its own: feel how it wants to move to G.



G major from string 6 fret 3 to string 4 fret 5.

☐ Goal: You can play an octave of G major across strings 6 to 4 with correct names.

EXERCISE 46 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Build D major from scratch

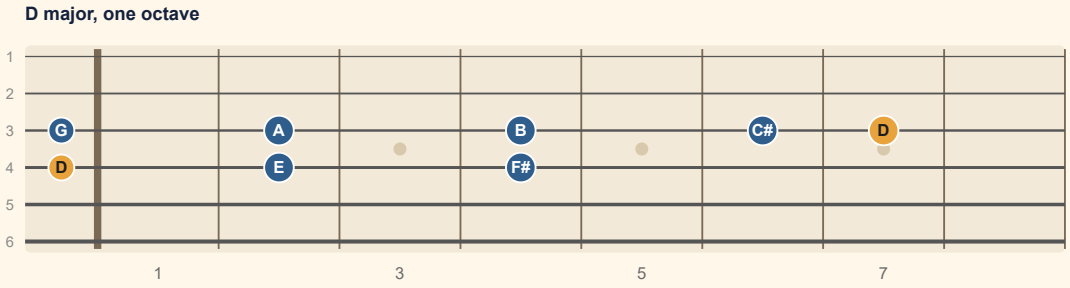
1. Start on D and apply the formula: D, E, F#, G, A, B, C#, D.
2. Write them down. Count the sharps: two, F# and C#.
3. Say the numbers and letters together: 1 D, 2 E, 3 F#, 4 G, 5 A, 6 B, 7 C#.

☐ Goal: You can spell D major without looking and name its two sharps.

EXERCISE 47 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: D major on strings 4 and 3

1. Play D major in one octave: string 4 open D, fret 2 E, fret 4 F#; string 3 open G, fret 2 A, fret 4 B, fret 6 C#, fret 7 D.
2. Hear the half step at the top (C# to D).
3. Play it down again, naming each note.



D major using strings 4 and 3.

☐ Goal: You can play a complete D major octave on two strings.

EXERCISE 48 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: Compare the three keys

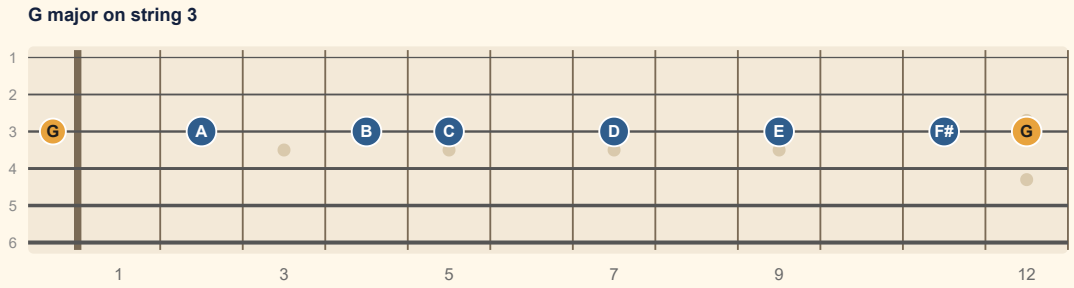
1. Write C major, G major and D major in three rows, one under the other.
2. Circle the notes that differ. G changes one note from C (F becomes F#). D changes one note from G (C becomes C#).
3. Predict the next key if you raise another note, then check: A major raises G to G#.

☐ Goal: You can state the number of sharps in each key (0, 1, 2) and which notes carry them.

EXERCISE 49 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: One string, two keys

1. On string 3 (the G string), play G major from the open string: G A B C D E F# G, at frets 0, 2, 4, 5, 7, 9, 11, 12.
2. Then play C major on the same string: C D E F G at frets 5, 7, 9, 10, 12.
3. Hear what changes: F# in G major, F natural in C major.



G major on one string: note the F# at fret 11.

☐ Goal: You can switch between G major and C major on one string and hear the F versus F# difference.

EXERCISE 50 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Degrees in three keys

1. Say the 1st, 3rd, 5th and 7th degrees of each key. C: C E G B. G: G B D F#. D: D F# A C#.
2. Play each group of four notes, one at a time, on any strings you like.
3. Close your eyes, pick a random key and degree, and answer in under five seconds.

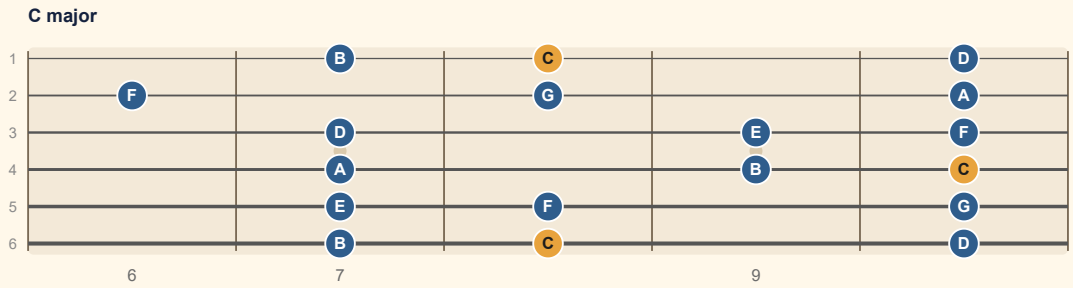
☐ Goal: You can name the 3rd, 5th and 7th of C, G and D without hesitation.

Week 6: Positions, relative minor, pentatonic

EXERCISE 51 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: C major position at frets 7 to 10

1. Place your first finger at fret 7. Play string by string: string 6 (B C D at 7, 8, 10), string 5 (E F G), string 4 (A B C at 7, 9, 10), string 3 (D E F), string 2 (G A at 8, 10), string 1 (B C D).
2. Go up slowly, then back down, naming each note.
3. Spot every C and say where the root is on strings 6, 4 and 1.



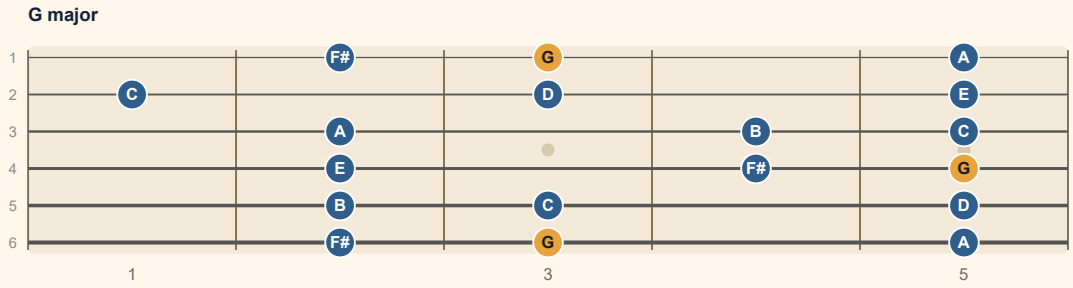
C major, position around frets 7 to 10.

☐ Goal: You can play the whole position from memory in both directions.

EXERCISE 52 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Slide the position down to G

1. Take the same finger pattern and move it five frets down. The root on string 6 is now fret 3 (G).
2. Play it from the lowest note to the highest: string 6 F# G A (frets 2, 3, 5), and so on. The notes spell G major.
3. Check there is one F# and no F natural anywhere.



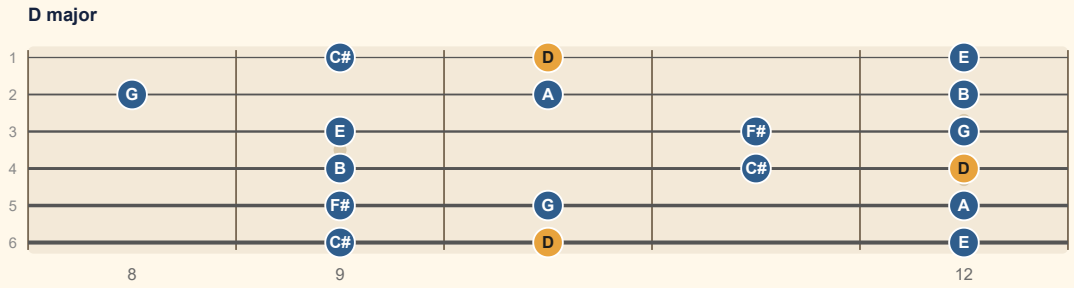
G major in position, frets 2 to 5.

☐ Goal: You can play G major in position by sliding the C major shape down five frets.

EXERCISE 53 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: Slide the position up to D

1. Move the shape two frets higher than C: the string 6 root is now fret 10 (D).
2. Play it from the lowest note to the highest: C#, D, E on string 6 (frets 9, 10, 12), and so on.
3. Say aloud: F# and C#, two sharps. Do you see both?



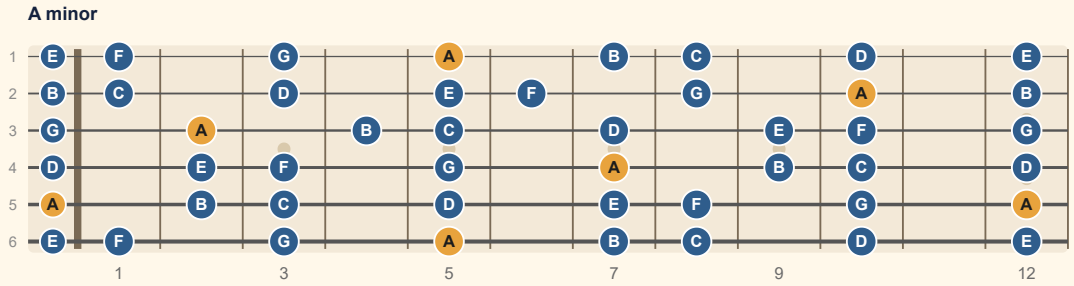
D major in position, frets 9 to 12.

☐ Goal: You can play D major in position and find its two sharps.

EXERCISE 54 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Find the relative minor

1. The relative minor starts on the 6th degree of a major scale. In C major, the 6th is A.
2. Play the same C major notes but start and end on A: A B C D E F G A. This is A natural minor.
3. Sing the sound of A as home. Notice how the same notes now feel darker.



A minor uses exactly the same notes as C major.

☐ Goal: You can say the relative minor of C major and play it starting on A.

EXERCISE 55 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Relative minors of G and D

1. Count to the 6th degree. G major: G A B C D E, so E minor. D major: D E F# G A B, so B minor.
2. Spell E minor: E F# G A B C D. Spell B minor: B C# D E F# G A.
3. Compare with the major keys they came from. Do the sharps match?

☐ Goal: You can name the relative minor of any of the three keys and spell it.

EXERCISE 56 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Same notes, two homes

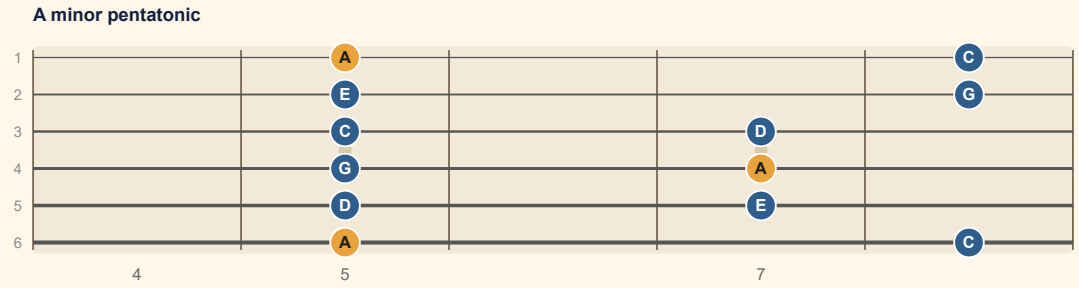
1. Play the C major position at frets 7 to 10 and finish on C (string 6, fret 8). Hear the bright, settled sound.
2. Now play the same position but start and end on A (string 4, fret 7): A B C, D E F, G A. Hear how it turns darker.
3. Alternate: play C then A three times each. The notes never change; only the home note does.

☐ Goal: You can hear major versus minor by changing only the target note.

EXERCISE 57 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: Minor pentatonic box 1

1. Put your first finger on fret 5. Play string 6: A (fret 5), C (fret 8). String 5: D (5), E (7). String 4: G (5), A (7). String 3: C (5), D (7). String 2: E (5), G (8). String 1: A (5), C (8).
2. Play it slowly up and down, two notes per string.
3. The five notes are A C D E G: no B, no F.



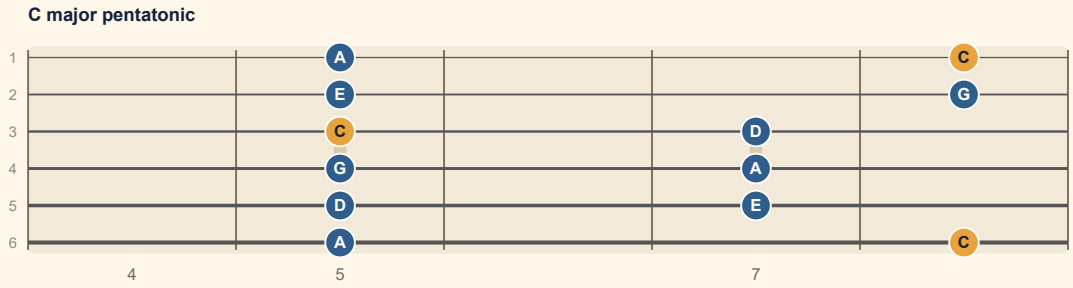
A minor pentatonic, box 1 at frets 5 to 8.

☐ Goal: You can play A minor pentatonic box 1 from memory.

EXERCISE 58 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: Pentatonic from the major scale

1. Take A minor and remove two notes: B (2nd) and F (6th). You get A C D E G.
2. Check that this box sits inside the C major position from the earlier exercises.
3. Now call the same shape C major pentatonic: C D E G A. Land on C (string 6, fret 8) and hear the change of mood.



C major pentatonic: same notes and shape as A minor pentatonic.

☐ Goal: You can explain that one box gives you either a minor pentatonic or a major pentatonic.

EXERCISE 59 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Slide box 1 to another key

1. Move box 1 five frets up: the root on string 6 is now D (fret 10). That is D minor pentatonic: D F G A C.
2. Play it from lowest to highest. Say the root each time you pass it.
3. Then move down to E (string 6, open) and play the box so that string 6 reads E (fret 0) and G (fret 3): E minor pentatonic is E G A B D.

☐ Goal: You can move box 1 to another root and name the root and notes.

EXERCISE 60 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Weeks 4 to 6 review jam

1. Pick C major. Spell it and play the C major position at frets 7 to 10.
2. Name its relative minor (A) and play box 1 of A minor pentatonic at frets 5 to 8.
3. Play any interval from week 4 (M3 or P5) from a root of your choice, then say its name aloud.

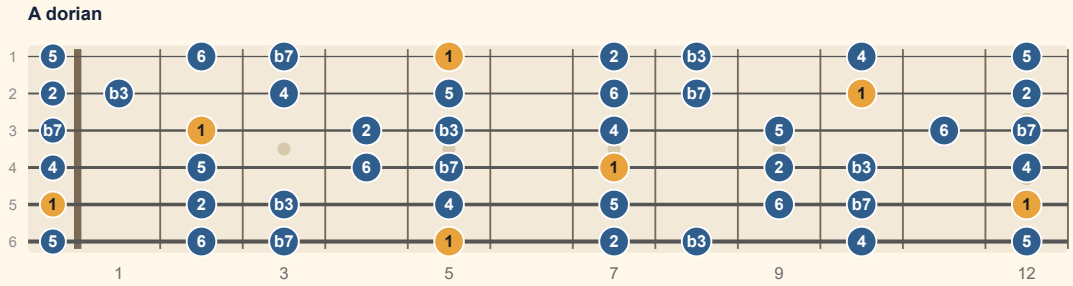
☐ Goal: You can chain scale, relative minor, pentatonic and an interval without stopping.

Week 7: Dorian and Mixolydian

EXERCISE 61 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: Dorian: minor with a bright sixth

1. Play A natural minor on string 5, starting at fret 0: A B C D E F G A. Listen to the F.
2. Now play A Dorian: A B C D E F# G A. Only the sixth note changed (F became F#).
3. Go up and down twice, slowly, saying the note names out loud.



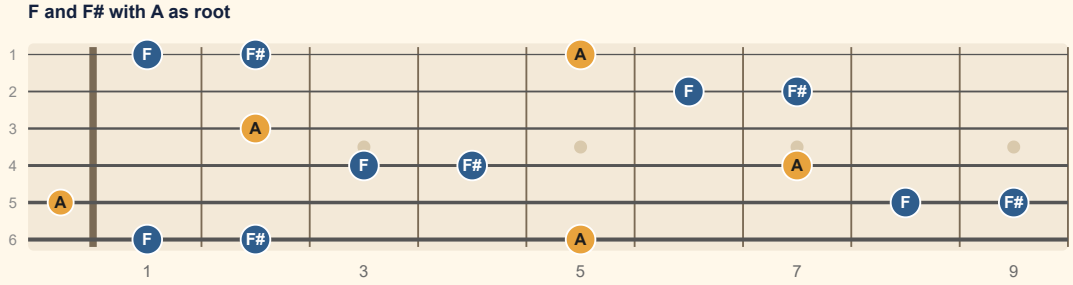
A Dorian: 1 2 b3 4 5 6 b7.

☐ Goal: Hear and name the one note that makes Dorian different from minor: the natural 6th.

EXERCISE 62 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Find the F and the F#

1. Locate every F and F# on strings 6, 5 and 4 using the diagram.
2. Play A (string 5, fret 0), then F (string 4, fret 3), then F# (string 4, fret 4). Hear the minor sixth, then the Dorian sixth.
3. Play A, E, F#, E. That small move is the Dorian sound.



One fret apart: F (minor 6th) and F# (Dorian 6th).

☐ Goal: See how the two sixths sit one fret apart.

EXERCISE 63 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: Dorian hides inside the major scale

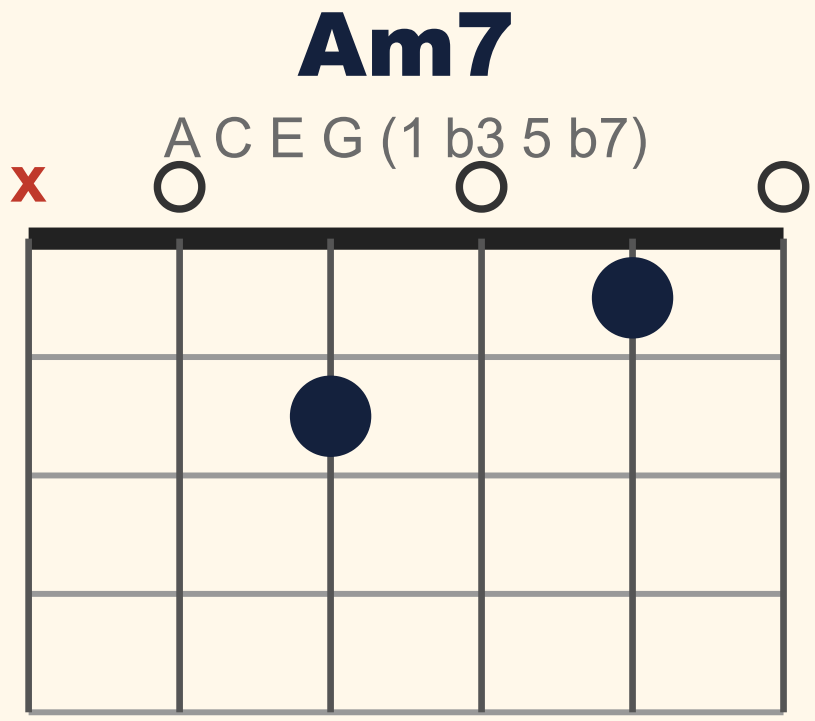
1. Write out G major: G A B C D E F#.
2. Start on the second note, A, and play A B C D E F# G A. That is A Dorian.
3. Say it aloud: Dorian starts on the 2nd note of a major scale.

☐ Goal: Connect Dorian to a major scale you already know: same notes, different home note.

EXERCISE 64 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: An A Dorian vamp

1. Strum Am7 for four beats, then D7 for four beats. Repeat for two minutes.
2. Over it, hum or play notes from A Dorian, landing on A, C or E at the end of each phrase.
3. Notice the F# in the D7 chord: it is the Dorian 6th.



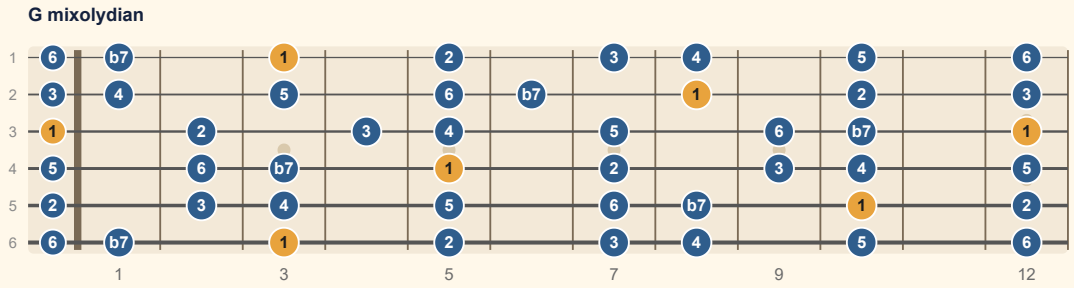
Am7 is chord i of A Dorian.

☐ Goal: Hear Dorian in context: a minor chord with a major-type chord built on its 4th.

EXERCISE 65 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Mixolydian: major with a flat seventh

1. Play G major from string 6 fret 3: G A B C D E F# G. Listen to the top note.
2. Play G Mixolydian: G A B C D E F G. The F# became F.
3. Repeat twice and finish on G each time.



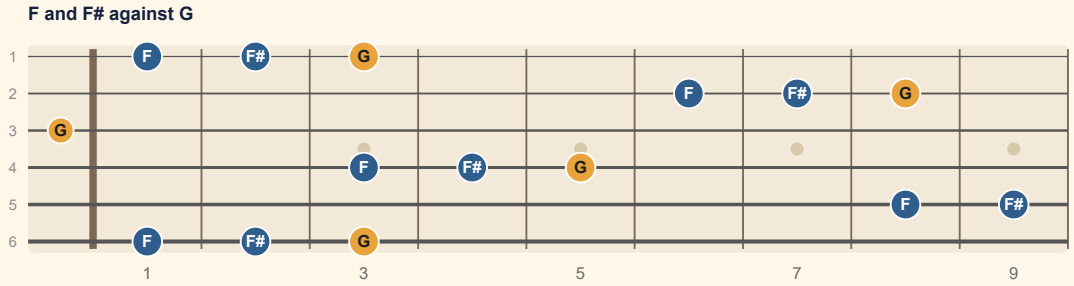
G Mixolydian: 1 2 3 4 5 6 b7.

☐ Goal: Hear the relaxed, bluesy pull of the flat 7th.

EXERCISE 66 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: The b7 against the major 7th

1. Locate every F and F# on the diagram, with G as root.
2. Play G on string 6 fret 3, then F on string 6 fret 1, then back to G. Hear the pull downward.
3. Play G, then F#, then G. Compare the two: which feels more finished?



F is the b7 of G; F# is the major 7th.

☐ Goal: Tell the b7 (F) from the major 7th (F#) by ear and by position.

EXERCISE 67 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: Mixolydian hides in the major scale

1. Write out C major: C D E F G A B.
2. Start on the fifth note, G: G A B C D E F G. That is G Mixolydian.
3. Play it on string 3 (open) up to string 1, name each note out loud.

☐ Goal: Know that Mixolydian starts on the 5th note of a major scale.

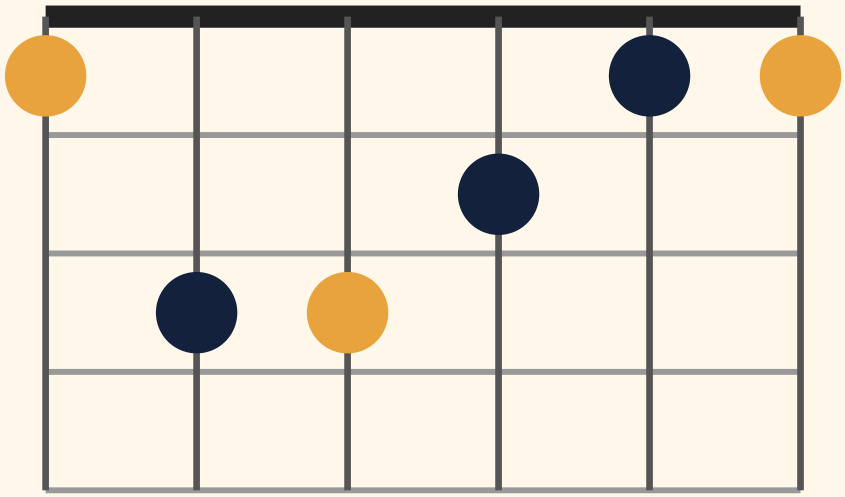
EXERCISE 68 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: A Mixolydian vamp: G to F

1. Strum G for four beats, then F for four beats (barre at fret 1). Repeat for two minutes.
2. Improvise over it with G Mixolydian notes, ending phrases on G, B or D.
3. Try one phrase that moves from F to G on the top strings.

F

F A C (1 3 5)



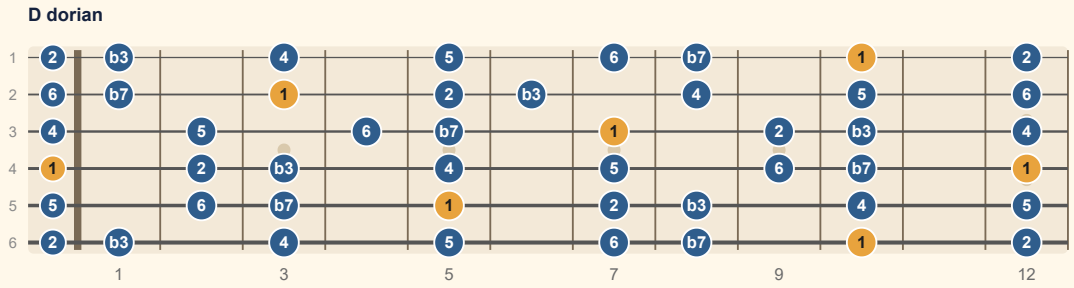
F (bVII of G) as an E-shape barre.

☐ Goal: Hear the I to bVII move that sounds like classic rock.

EXERCISE 69 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Dorian versus Mixolydian

1. Play D Dorian: D E F G A B C D. Then D Mixolydian: D E F# G A B C D.
2. Say which note differs. (Answer: the 3rd, F versus F#.)
3. Both have a flat 7th. Notice that Dorian sounds minor and Mixolydian sounds major.



D Dorian: 1 2 b3 4 5 6 b7.

☐ Goal: Sort the two modes by their 3rd.

EXERCISE 70 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Week 7 check: name that mode

1. Name these: (a) E F# G A B C# D, (b) B C# D E F# G# A, (c) E F# G# A B C# D.
2. Play each on any string set and listen: minor-sounding or major-sounding?
3. Check: (a) E Dorian, (b) B Dorian, (c) E Mixolydian.

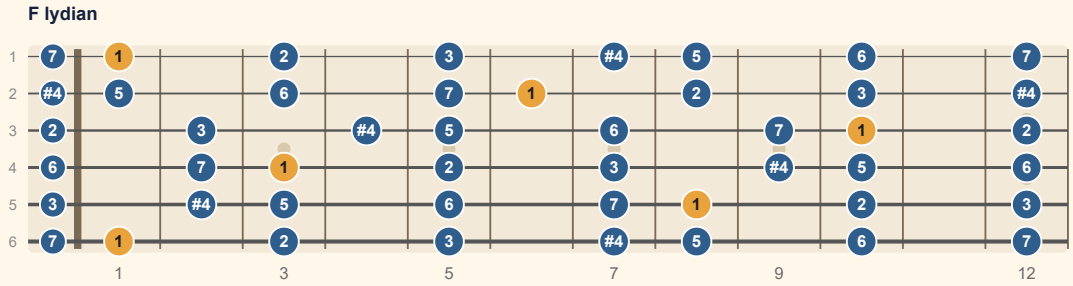
☐ Goal: Identify Dorian and Mixolydian from the note names alone.

Week 8: The other modes

EXERCISE 71 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: Lydian: major with a raised fourth

1. Play F major: F G A Bb C D E F. Then F Lydian: F G A B C D E F. The Bb became B.
2. Play the raised 4th (B) on its own and hold it, then resolve to C.
3. Repeat, then describe the sound in one word.



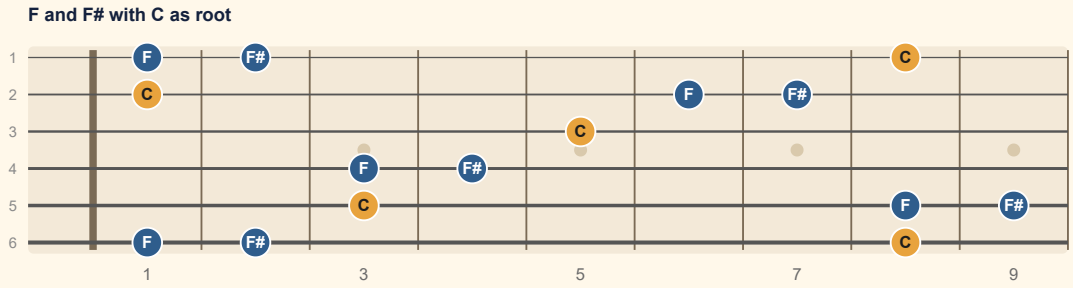
F Lydian: 1 2 3 #4 5 6 7.

☐ Goal: Hear the dreamy lift of the sharp 4th.

EXERCISE 72 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Lydian two ways

1. Write C major: C D E F G A B. Start on F: F G A B C D E. That is F Lydian.
2. Now play C major, then C Lydian: C D E F# G A B. Compare the F and the F#.
3. Hold a low C and play C Lydian over it.



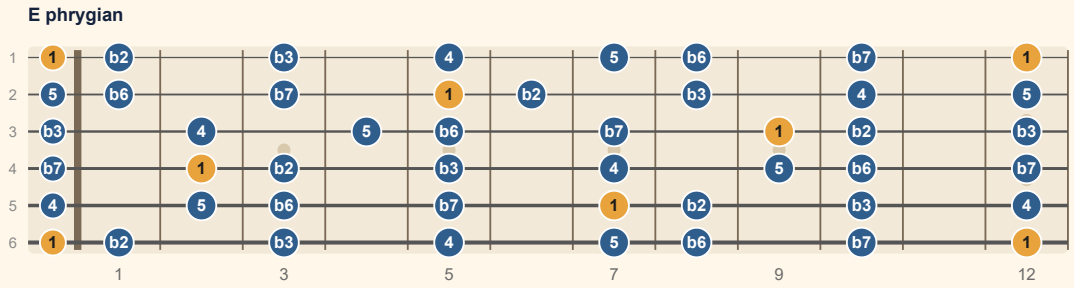
F is the 4th of C; F# is the Lydian #4.

☐ Goal: Find Lydian two ways: from the 4th note, or by sharpening the 4th.

EXERCISE 73 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: Phrygian: the dark flat second

1. Play E Phrygian on string 6: E F G A (frets 0 1 3 5), then on string 5: B C D E (frets 2 3 5 7).
2. The first step, E to F, is only one fret. That is the b2.
3. Play E then F three times, then E, G, F, E.



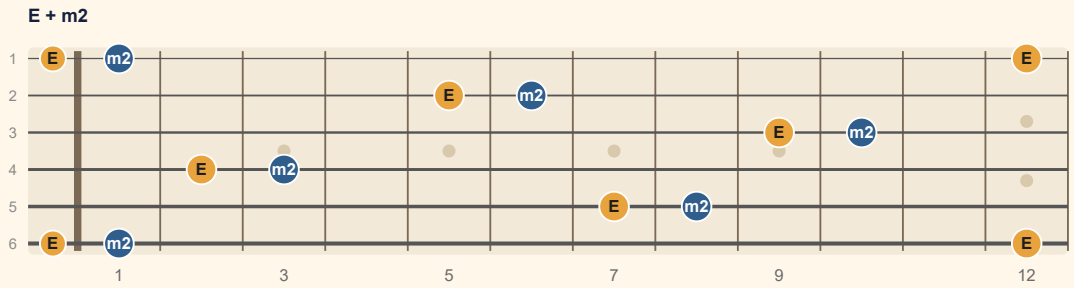
E Phrygian: 1 b2 b3 4 5 b6 b7.

☐ Goal: Recognize the tense, Spanish-flavored sound of the b2.

EXERCISE 74 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Phrygian versus natural minor

1. E natural minor is E F# G A B C D. E Phrygian is E F G A B C D.
2. Play string 6 fret 0, then fret 2 (F#), then back. Then fret 0 to fret 1 (F).
3. Which is darker? Most players find the one-fret step more tense.



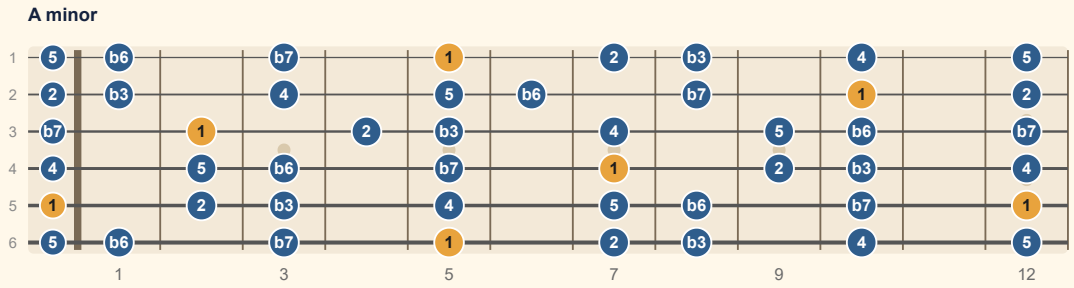
A minor 2nd above E is F.

☐ Goal: Hear the half step above the root that defines Phrygian.

EXERCISE 75 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Aeolian: natural minor, by its mode name

1. Play A Aeolian: A B C D E F G A. This is also natural minor.
2. Notice these are the notes of C major, starting on A.
3. Play it up and down, and finish on A.



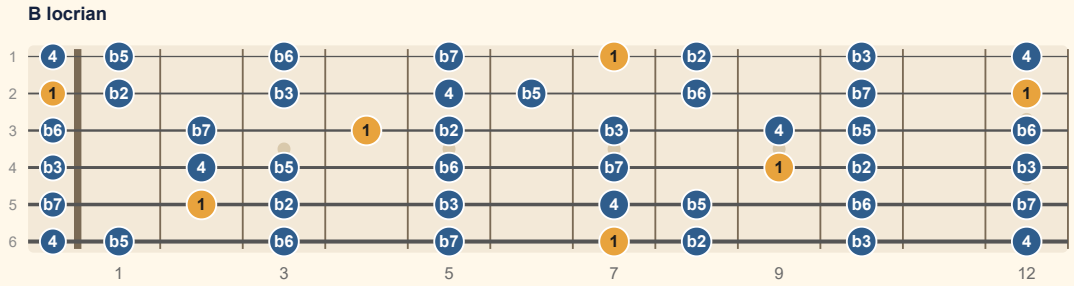
A Aeolian (natural minor): 1 2 b3 4 5 b6 b7.

☐ Goal: Know that Aeolian starts on the 6th note of the major scale.

EXERCISE 76 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Locrian: the unstable one

1. Play B Locrian: B C D E F G A B. The C is the b2 and the F is the b5.
2. Hold B, then play F. Hear how unsettled the flat fifth feels.
3. Move F down to E. Note the relief.



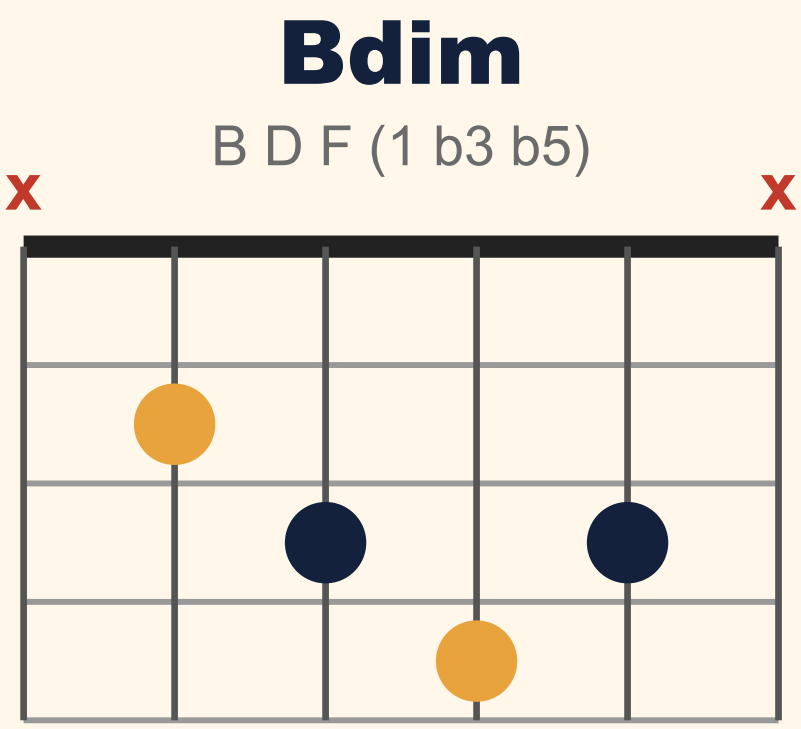
B Locrian: 1 b2 b3 4 b5 b6 b7.

☐ Goal: Hear why Locrian is rarely used as a home key.

EXERCISE 77 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: The Locrian chord

1. Locrian's home chord is diminished: B D F (1 b3 b5).
2. Play the diminished shape in the diagram and strum it.
3. Resolve it to C major: C E G.



Bdim: root on string 5, fret 2.

☐ Goal: See that Locrian lives on the diminished chord.

EXERCISE 78 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: The bright-to-dark ladder

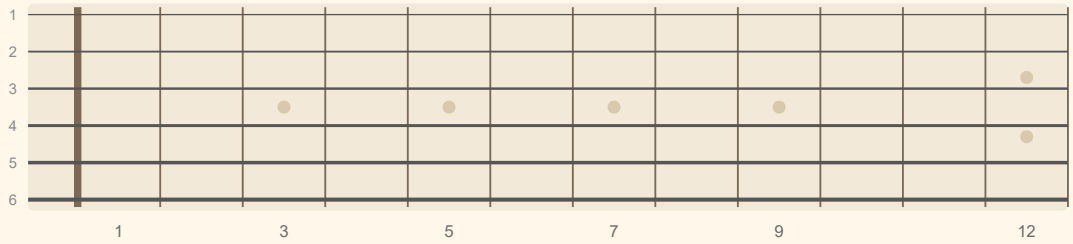
1. Write each mode on C: Lydian C D E F# G A B, Ionian C D E F G A B, Mixolydian C D E F G A Bb.
2. Then Dorian C D Eb F G A Bb, Aeolian C D Eb F G Ab Bb, Phrygian C Db Eb F G Ab Bb, Locrian C Db Eb F Gb Ab Bb.
3. Circle the note that differs from the line above it. Each step down flattens exactly one note.

☐ Goal: Order the seven modes from brightest to darkest with one simple rule.

EXERCISE 79 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Name that mode

1. Name: (a) G A B C# D E F#, (b) A Bb C D E F G, (c) D Eb F G A Bb C.
2. Find the characteristic note in each (#4 or b2).
3. Check: (a) G Lydian, (b) A Phrygian, (c) D Phrygian.



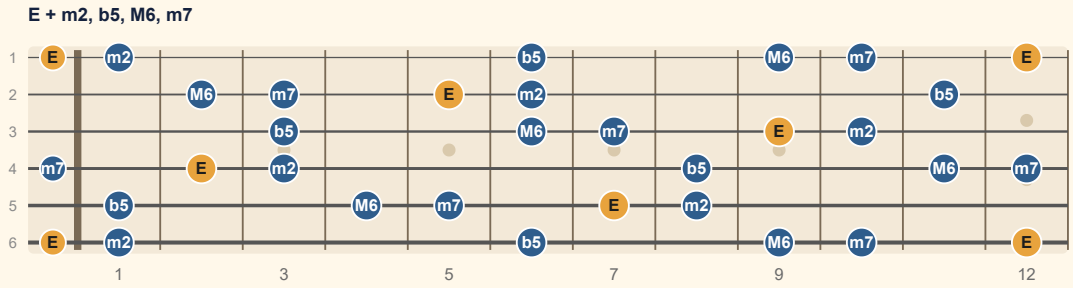
Mark each scale here, then check the answers.

☐ Goal: Use the characteristic note to name a mode quickly.

EXERCISE 80 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Week 8 check: signature intervals

1. On E, find these notes: m2 (F), b5 (Bb), M6 (C#), m7 (D).
2. Match each to its mode: F is Phrygian, Bb is Locrian, C# is Dorian, D is Mixolydian.
3. Play each note over an open low E and describe its color.



Intervals above E: signature notes of four modes.

☐ Goal: Link each mode with its signature interval.

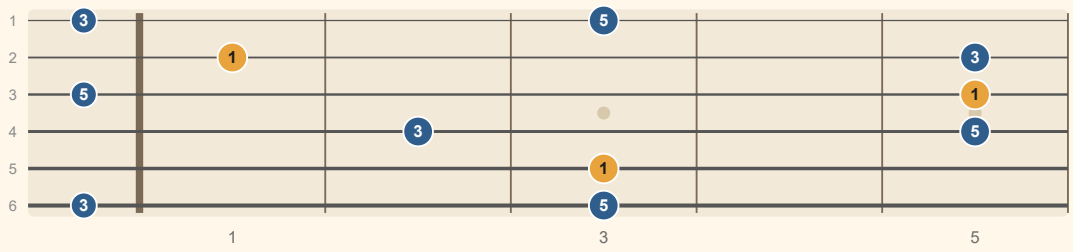
Week 9: Triads and harmonizing the scale

EXERCISE 81 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: Build major triads

1. A major triad is 1 3 5. For C: C E G. Find those notes on strings 3 to 1.
2. Play a C chord and name the three notes.
3. Say the formula out loud: root, major third, perfect fifth.

C major triad



1 3 5 of C.

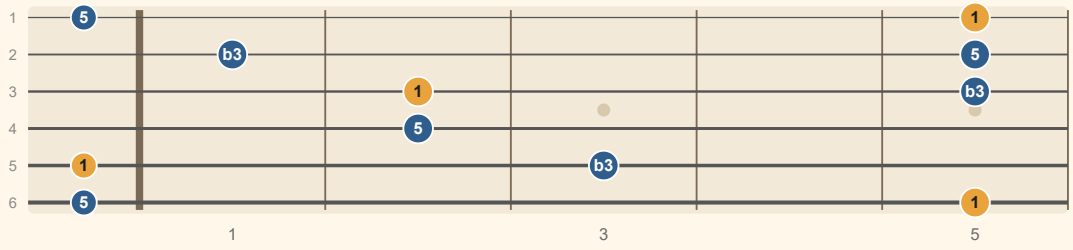
☐ Goal: Build a triad from a formula, not from memory.

EXERCISE 82 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Minor triads: one note changes

1. A minor triad is 1 b3 5. For A: A C E. Find those notes on the diagram.
2. Raise C to C# to make A major: A C# E (1 3 5).
3. Play each and say what changed: only the 3rd.

A minor triad



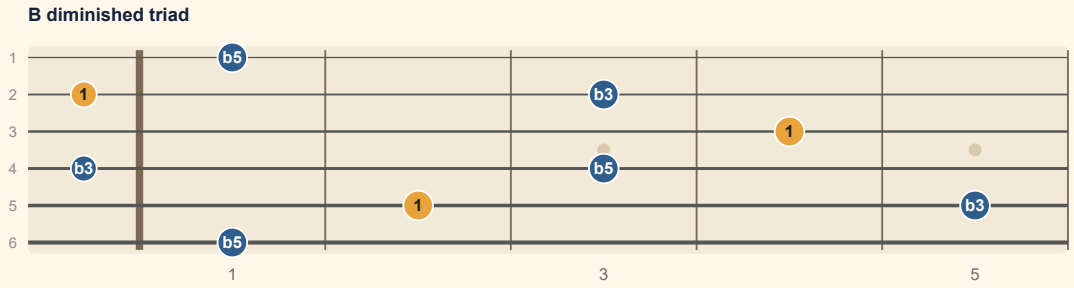
1 b3 5 of A.

☐ Goal: Show that the 3rd decides major or minor.

EXERCISE 83 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: Diminished and augmented triads

1. Diminished = 1 b3 b5. For B: B D F.
2. Augmented = 1 3 #5. For C: C E G#.
3. Play both and say which one feels tense and which floats.



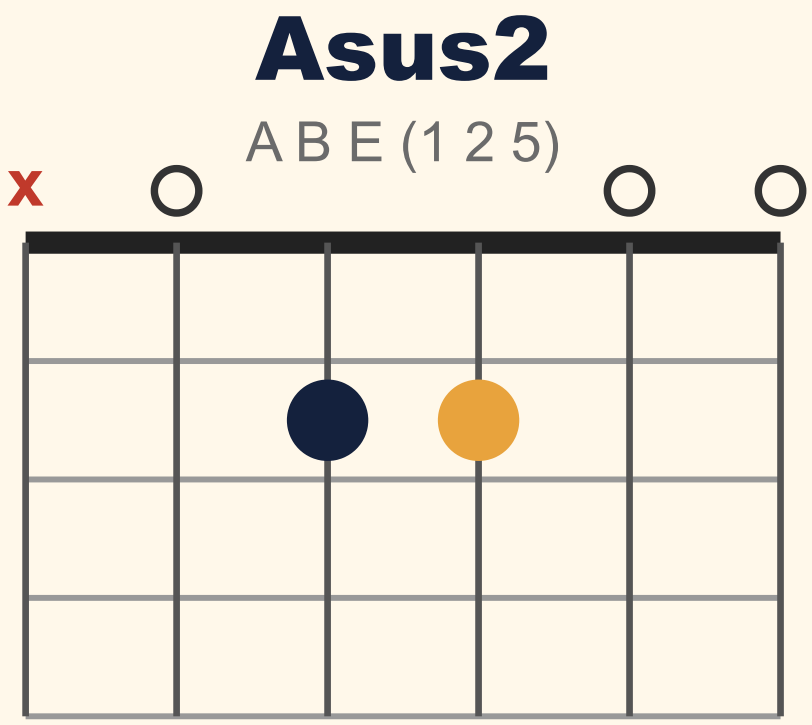
1 b3 b5 of B.

☐ Goal: Add the two altered triads to your formula list.

EXERCISE 84 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Suspended chords from formulas

1. Sus2 = 1 2 5; for A: A B E. Sus4 = 1 4 5; for A: A D E.
2. Strum Asus2, then Asus4, then A minor.
3. Name which note replaces the 3rd in each.



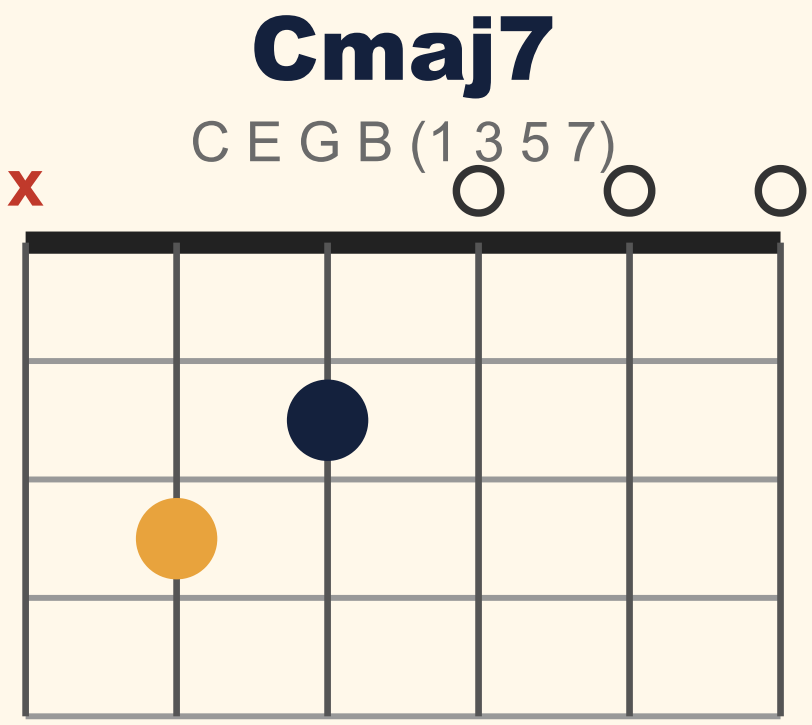
Asus2: A B E.

☐ Goal: Build sus chords from the 2nd and 4th.

EXERCISE 85 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Add the seventh

1. Cmaj7 = 1 3 5 7 = C E G B.
2. Play the open Cmaj7 and name each note.
3. Then play an open C7 (flatten the 7th to Bb) and compare the two.



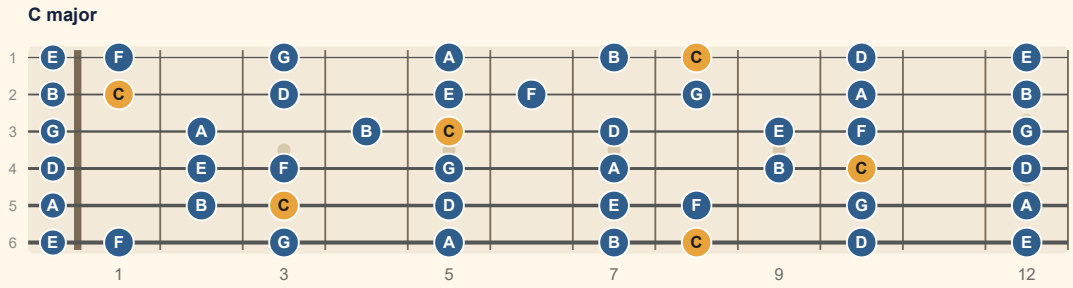
Cmaj7: C E G B.

☐ Goal: Extend a triad to a four-note chord by formula.

EXERCISE 86 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Stack thirds in C major

1. Write C D E F G A B. For each note, skip one and take two more: C E G, D F A, E G B, F A C, G B D, A C E, B D F.
2. Label each triad major, minor or diminished. Result: C, Dm, Em, F, G, Am, Bdim.
3. Strum C, Dm and Em in open position.



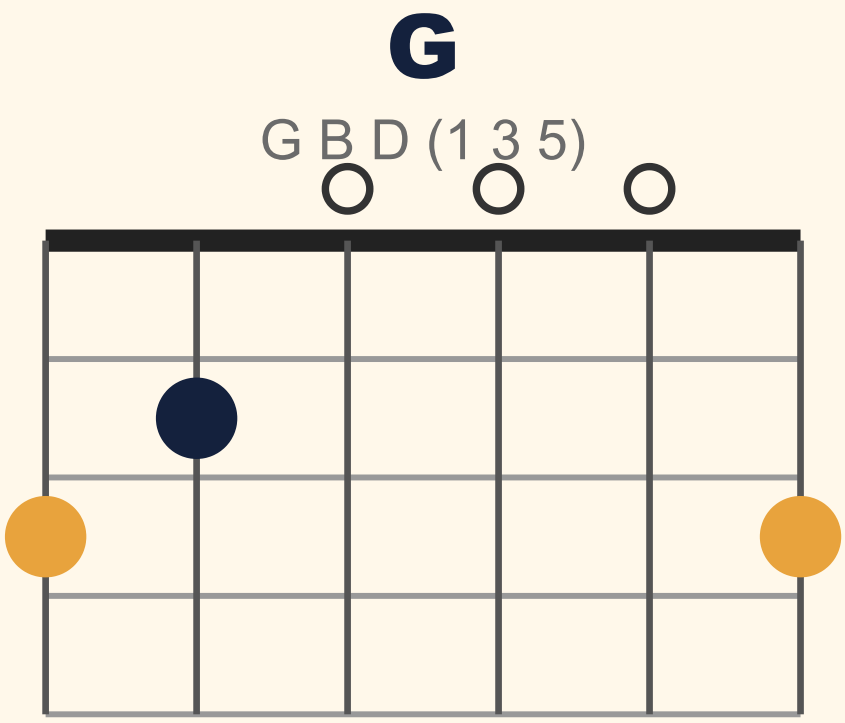
C major scale: the source of the chords.

☐ Goal: Harmonize a scale by stacking thirds.

EXERCISE 87 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: The pattern: I ii iii IV V vi vii dim

1. Chord qualities in any major key: major, minor, minor, major, major, minor, diminished.
2. Apply it to G major (G A B C D E F#): G, Am, Bm, C, D, Em, F#dim.
3. Play G, C, D and Em, saying each Roman numeral.



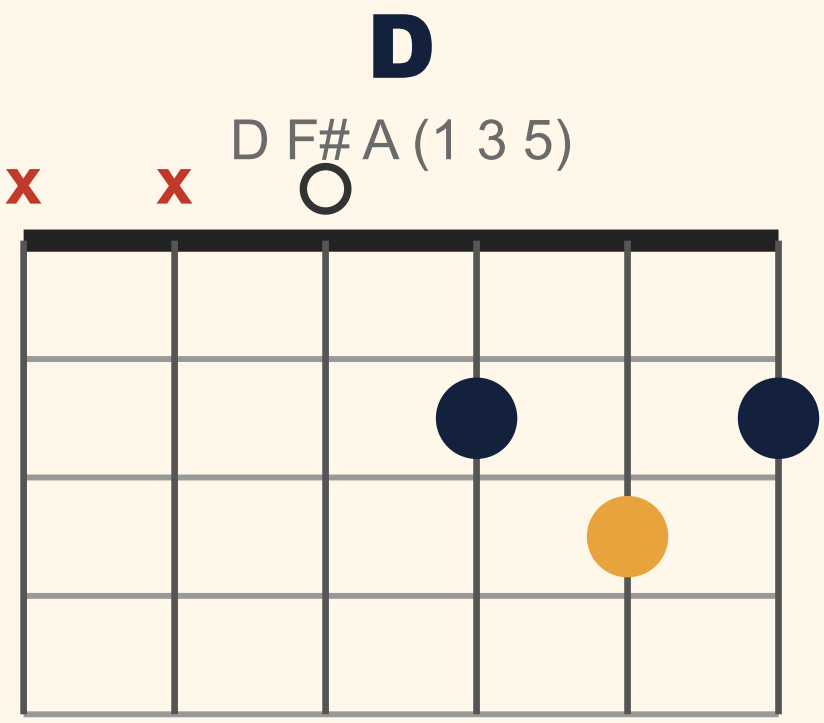
G: chord I in G major.

☐ Goal: Know the pattern that works in every major key.

EXERCISE 88 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: Harmonize D major

1. D major: D E F# G A B C#.
2. Build the chords: D, Em, F#m, G, A, Bm, C#dim.
3. Play D, G, A and Bm and say each number: I IV V vi.



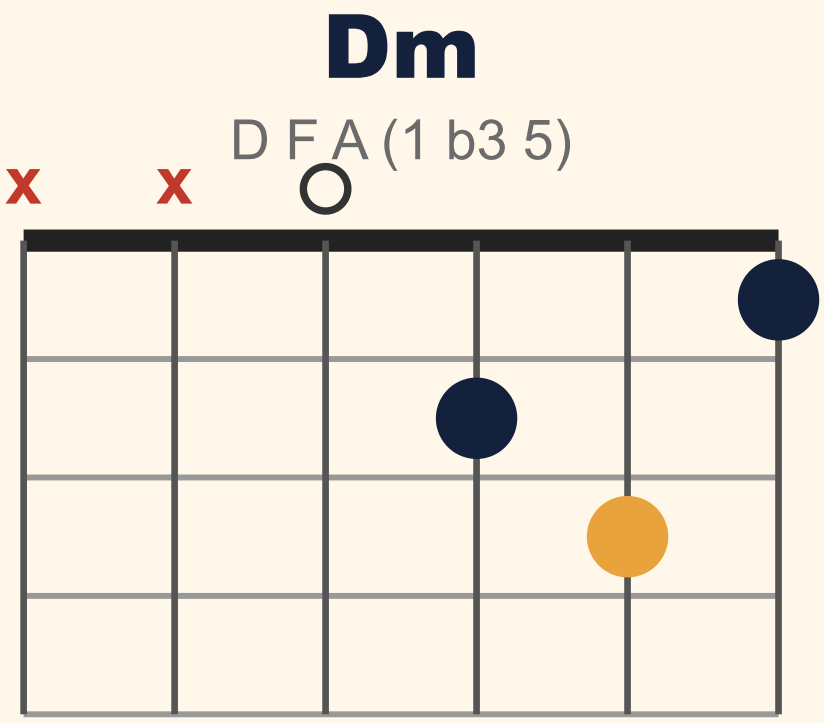
D: chord I in D major.

☐ Goal: Repeat the process in a new key.

EXERCISE 89 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Chords in C with open shapes

1. In C major: C, Dm, Em, F, G, Am. Use open shapes for all but F.
2. Play C, Am, Dm, G (I vi ii V). Hold each for four beats.
3. Swap one chord for Em and note the difference in mood.



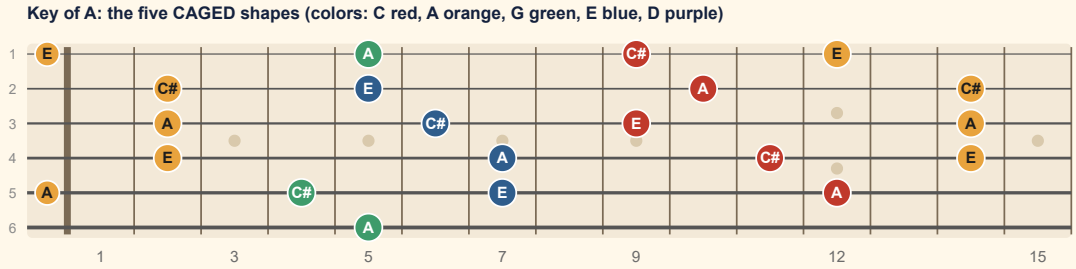
Dm: chord ii in C major.

☐ Goal: Use harmonized chords in a real progression.

EXERCISE 90 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Week 9 check: harmonize A major

1. A major: A B C# D E F# G#. Chords: A, Bm, C#m, D, E, F#m, G#dim.
2. Play I vi IV V as A, F#m, D, E for two minutes.
3. Write the three notes of each chord from memory.



A major across the neck.

☐ Goal: Harmonize a key of your choice and play it.

Week 10: Barre chords and sevenths

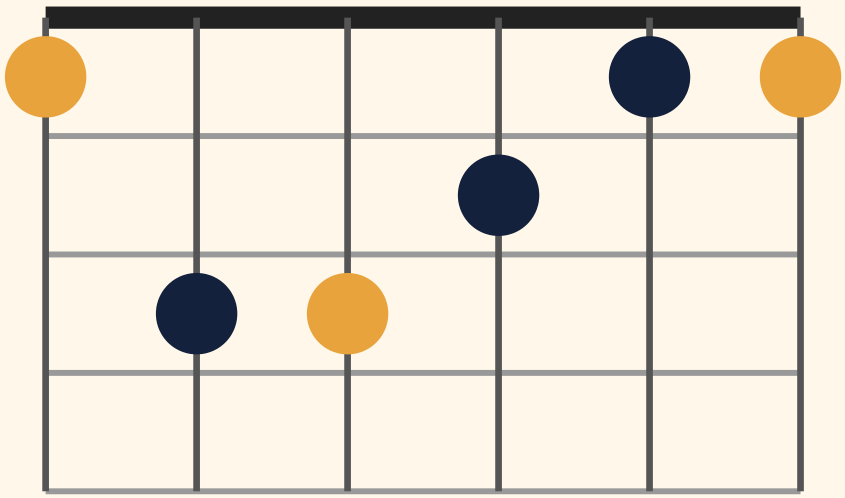
EXERCISE 91 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: E-form major barre: F at fret 1

1. Lay your index finger flat across all six strings at fret 1 (a full barre).
2. Build the rest of the open E shape above the barre with your other three fingers to make F major (F A C).
3. Pick each string one at a time and fix any buzzing by rolling your index finger slightly toward its bony edge.
4. Strum four slow beats, release, and rebuild it three times.

F

F A C (1 3 5)



F major, E-form barre at fret 1: the root F is on string 6.

☐ Goal: Hold a clean F major barre with every string ringing.

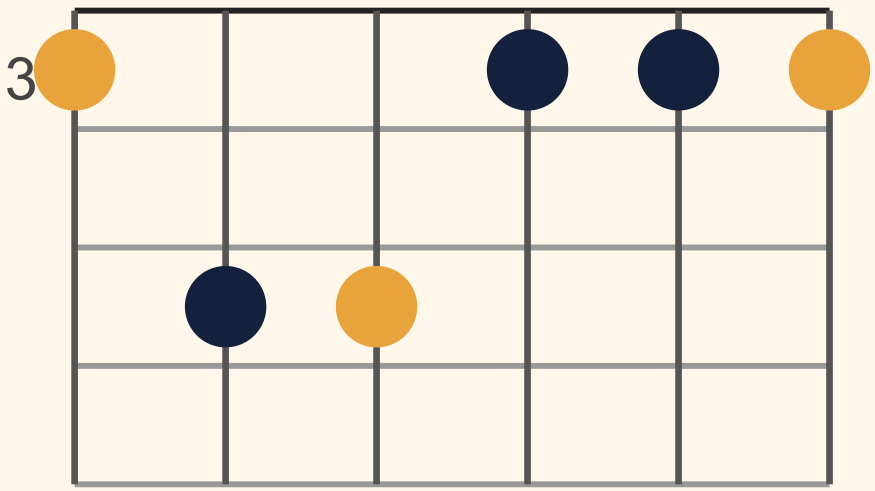
EXERCISE 92 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: E-form minor barre: Gm at fret 3

1. Barre all six strings at fret 3 with your index finger.
2. Make the open Em shape above the barre to form G minor (G Bb D).
3. Compare with the major: play G major (same barre, E-form major) and G minor back and forth, four beats each.
4. Say out loud which note changes: the third, B becomes Bb.

Gm

G Bb D (1 b3 5)



G minor, E-form barre at fret 3.

☐ Goal: Hear and play the difference between G and Gm on the same barre.

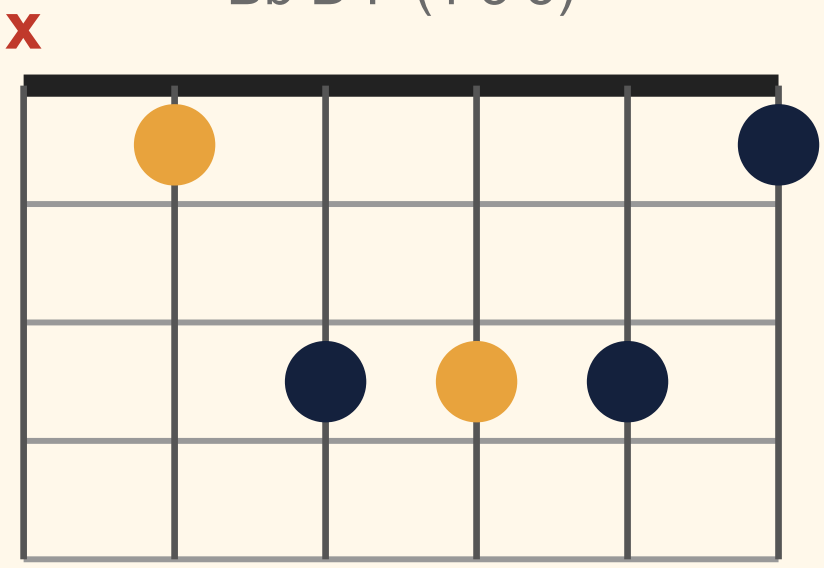
EXERCISE 93 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: A-form major barre: Bb at fret 1

1. Barre strings 5 through 1 at fret 1; string 6 stays muted.
2. Build the open A shape above the barre to make Bb major (Bb D F). The root is string 5, fret 1.
3. Strum only strings 5 to 1 for four beats.
4. Release and rebuild three times, aiming for a fast, clean landing.

Bb

Bb D F (1 3 5)



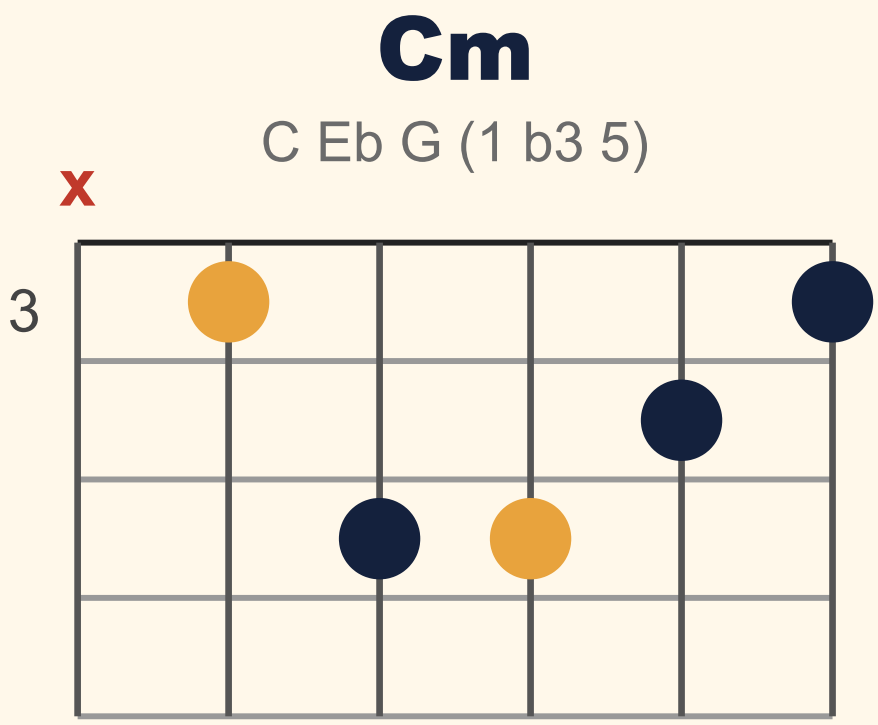
Bb major, A-form barre at fret 1: root on string 5.

☐ Goal: Land the A-form barre in one move with strings 5 to 1 clear.

EXERCISE 94 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: A-form minor barre: Cm at fret 3

1. Barre strings 5 to 1 at fret 3.
2. Make the open Am shape above the barre to form C minor (C Eb G).
3. Alternate C major (A-form) and C minor (A-form), four beats each, for two minutes.
4. Name the one note that changes: E becomes Eb.



C minor, A-form barre at fret 3.

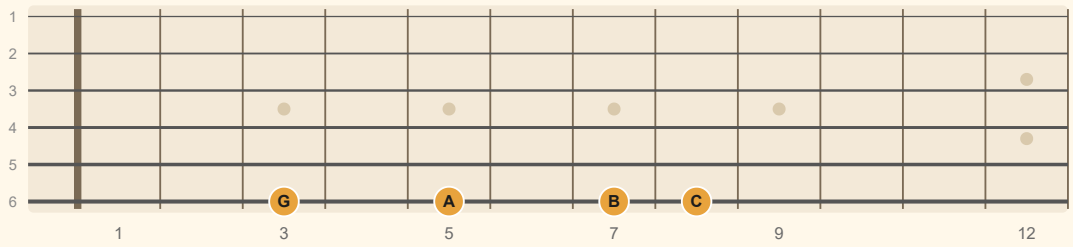
☐ Goal: Switch between major and minor on the A form without losing the barre.

EXERCISE 95 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Slide the E form up the neck

1. Play the E-form major barre with its root on string 6 at fret 3 (G), then slide the whole shape to fret 5 (A), fret 7 (B) and fret 8 (C).
2. Say each chord name as you land; the name is the note on string 6.
3. Strum two beats on each, then come back down.
4. Do two full trips up and down.

String 6 roots for the E form



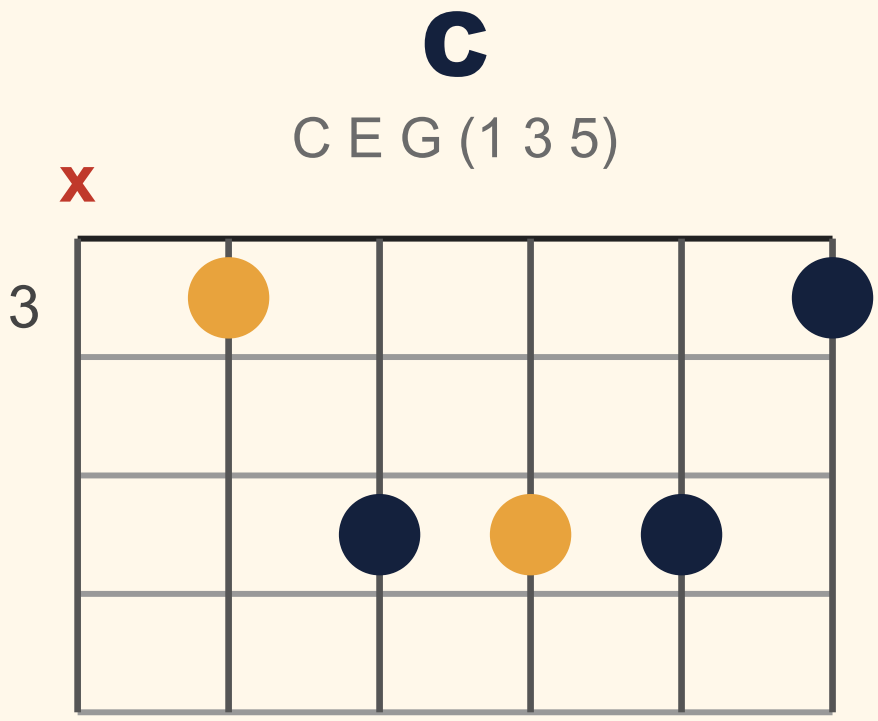
Each of these string 6 notes names the E-form barre built on it.

☐ Goal: Name any E-form major chord by reading its string 6 root.

EXERCISE 96 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Same chord, two forms: C major

1. Play C major as an E-form barre with the root on string 6, fret 8.
2. Now play C major as an A-form barre at fret 3 (root on string 5).
3. Alternate the two, four beats each, then listen: same notes (C E G), different register.
4. Try it with G major too: E form at fret 3, A form at fret 10.



C major, A form at fret 3. The E form of the same chord sits at fret 8.

☐ Goal: Play one chord in two places and hear that it is the same chord.

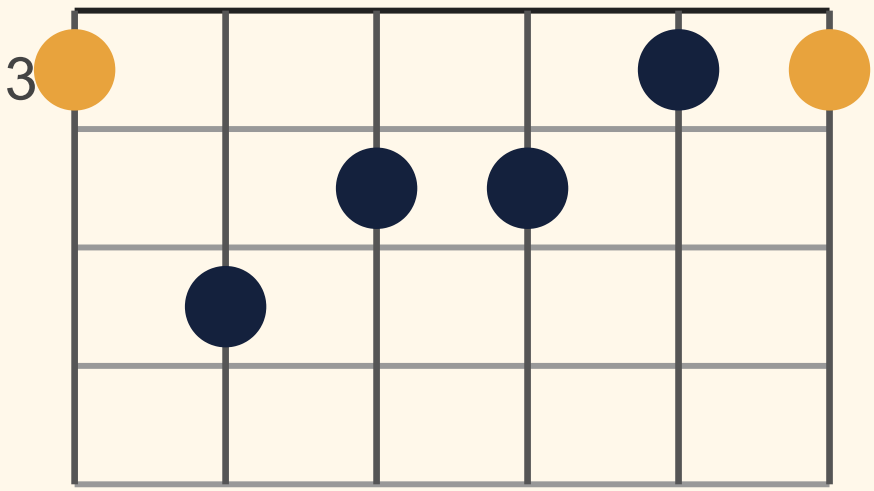
EXERCISE 97 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: Major seventh on the E form: Gmaj7

1. Play G major as an E-form barre at fret 3 (G B D).
2. Now play Gmaj7 (G B D F#) with the shape in the diagram, which adds the major 7th, F#.
3. Strum Gmaj7, then G, then Gmaj7 again; listen for the soft, dreamy lift.
4. Slide the shape to fret 5 and play Amaj7 (A C# E G#).

Gmaj7

G B D F# (1 3 5 7)



Gmaj7: G B D F#. Root on string 6, fret 3.

☐ Goal: Play and hear a major seventh built on a barre.

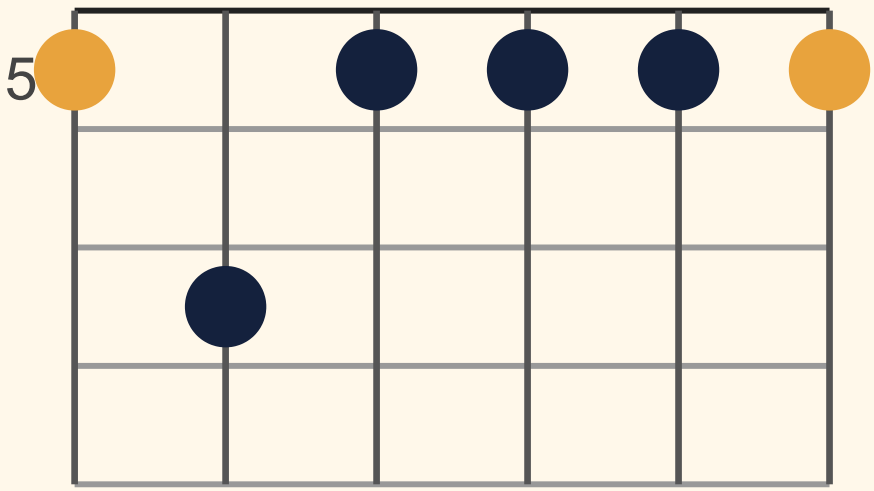
EXERCISE 98 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: Minor seventh on the E form: Am7

1. Play Am7 (A C E G) with the E-form shape at fret 5.
2. Compare with the plain Am barre: the added G is the minor 7th (b7).
3. Alternate Am7 and Am, four beats each.
4. Move to fret 7 and play Bm7 (B D F# A), then fret 3 for Gm7 (G Bb D F).

Am7

A C E G (1 b3 5 b7)



Am7: A C E G. Root on string 6, fret 5.

☐ Goal: Recognize the soft, relaxed sound of m7 and play it at three frets.

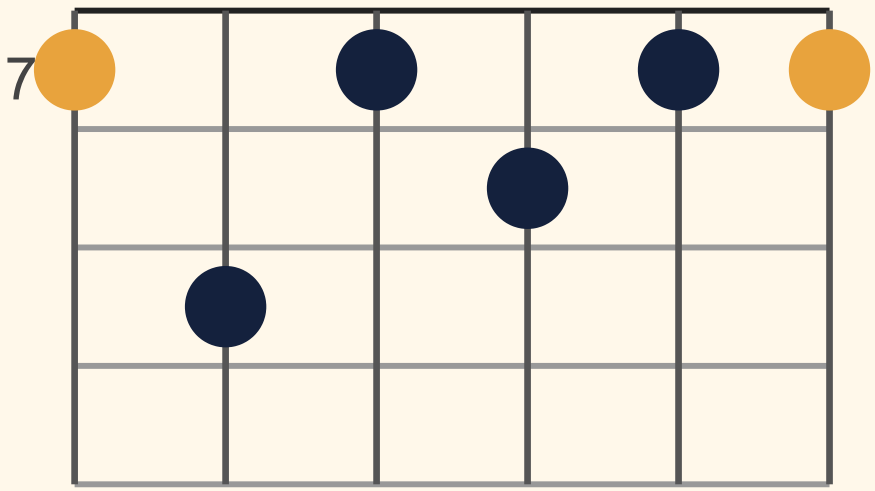
EXERCISE 99 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Dominant seventh on the E form: B7

1. Play B7 (B D# F# A) with the E-form shape at fret 7.
2. Strum it for four beats, then play plain B major (B D# F#) and listen for the tension the A adds.
3. Alternate B7 and B major slowly.
4. Move the shape to fret 3 and play G7 (G B D F); say which chord it wants to resolve to (C).

B7

B D# F# A (1 3 5 b7)



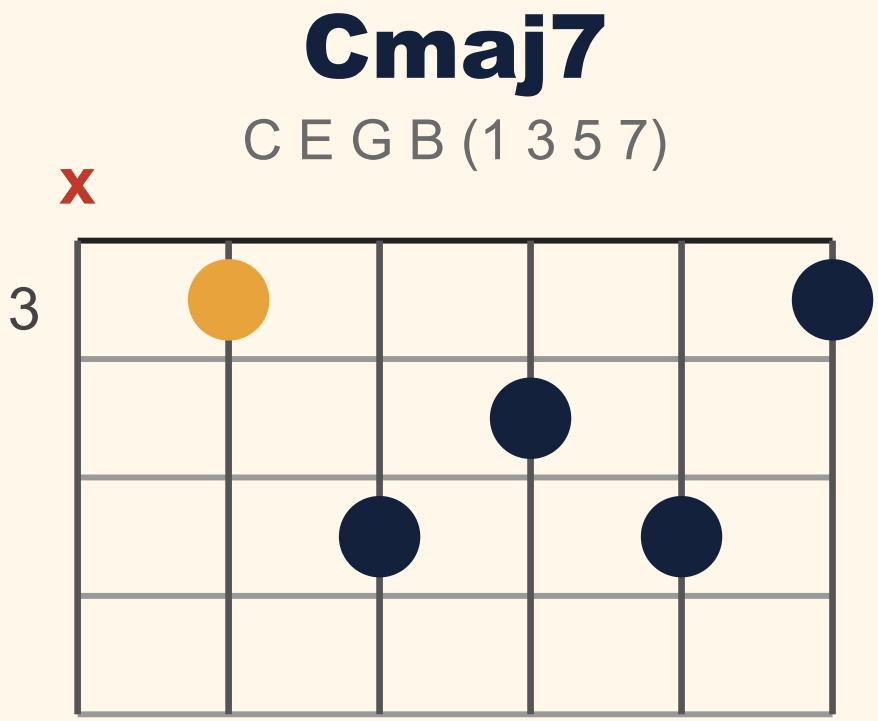
B7: B D# F# A. Root on string 6, fret 7.

☐ Goal: Hear the restless pull of a dominant 7th chord.

EXERCISE 100 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Four sevenths on C: the A form

1. Play the A-form shape at fret 3 four ways: C major (C E G), Cmaj7 (C E G B), C7 (C E G Bb), Cm7 (C Eb G Bb).
2. Strum each for two beats in that order, then loop.
3. Say the one note that changes between neighbors: B to Bb, E to Eb.
4. Do three loops, faster each time.



Cmaj7, A-form at fret 3. Flatten the 7th for C7, flatten the 3rd as well for Cm7.

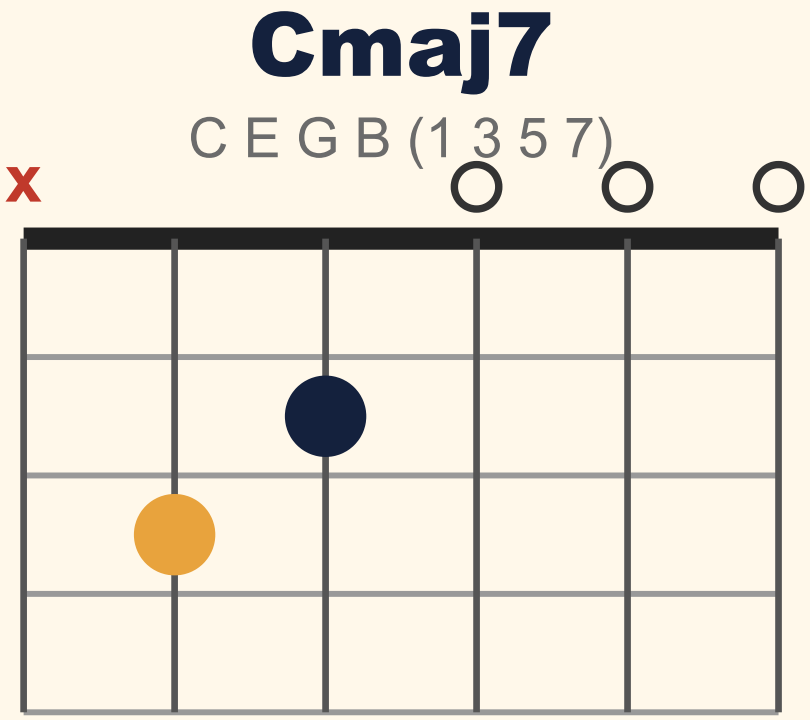
☐ Goal: Tell the four chord flavors apart by ear and by hand.

Week 11: Sevenths, sus chords, tensions

EXERCISE 101 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: Spell the sevenths of C major

1. Stack alternate notes of C major from each degree: Cmaj7 = C E G B, Dm7 = D F A C, Em7 = E G B D, Fmaj7 = F A C E, G7 = G B D F, Am7 = A C E G, Bm7b5 = B D F A.
2. Play the six open-position ones in order: Cmaj7, Dm7, Em7, Fmaj7, G7, Am7.
3. Strum each for four slow beats.
4. Self-check: which two are major seventh chords? (C and F.)



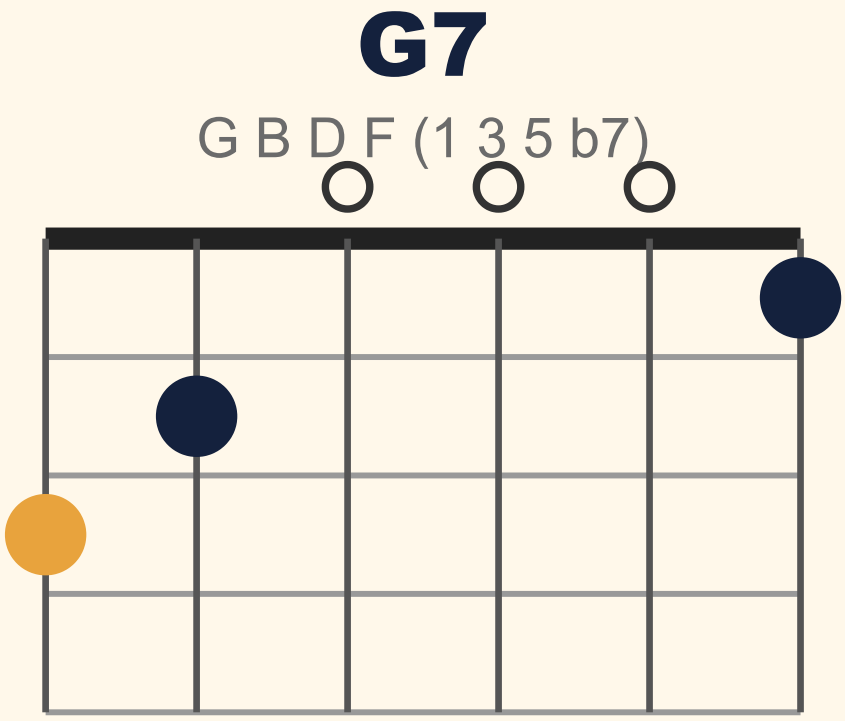
Open Cmaj7: C E G B.

☐ Goal: Know which seventh sits on each degree of the key.

EXERCISE 102 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: The ii-V-I in C with open sevenths

1. Play Dm7, then G7, then Cmaj7, two beats each.
2. Loop it for two minutes with steady time.
3. Notice the pull: G7 wants to go home to Cmaj7.
4. Slow down to one chord per bar and listen to how the notes move.



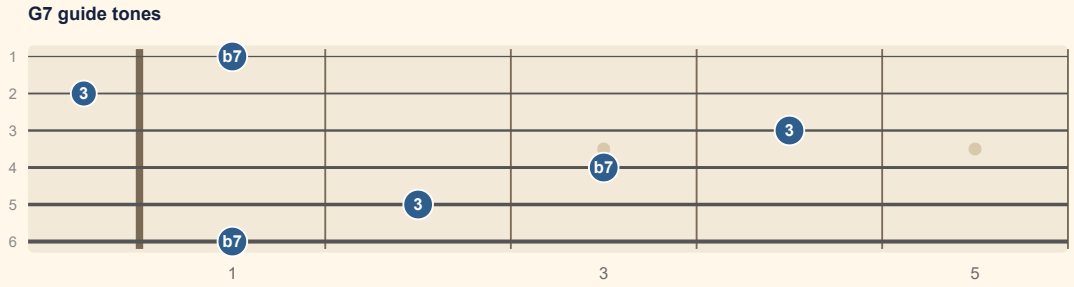
Open G7: G B D F.

☐ Goal: Play your first ii-V-I and hear why it feels like arriving home.

EXERCISE 103 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: Guide tones: the 3rd and 7th

1. On G7, the 3rd is B and the b7 is F. Find them using the diagram, frets 0 to 5.
2. Play B and F together on adjacent strings, then add the G root below.
3. Resolve both notes to Cmaj7: B moves up to C, F moves down to E. Play that resolution three times.
4. Say out loud: the 3rd and 7th carry the chord.



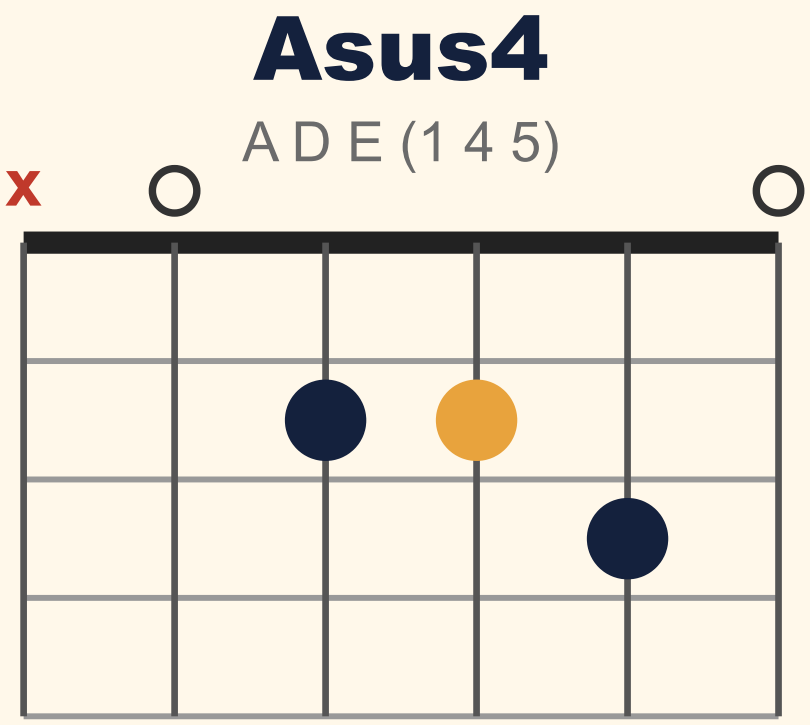
Shown as degrees of G7: B is the 3, F is the b7.

☐ Goal: Hear that two notes can define a whole seventh chord.

EXERCISE 104 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Sus2 and sus4 on A

1. Play open A major, then Asus2 (A B E), then Asus4 (A D E).
2. Strum each chord for four beats in that order, then repeat.
3. Describe each sound in a word: open, airy, hanging.
4. Finish by resolving Asus4 back to A major.



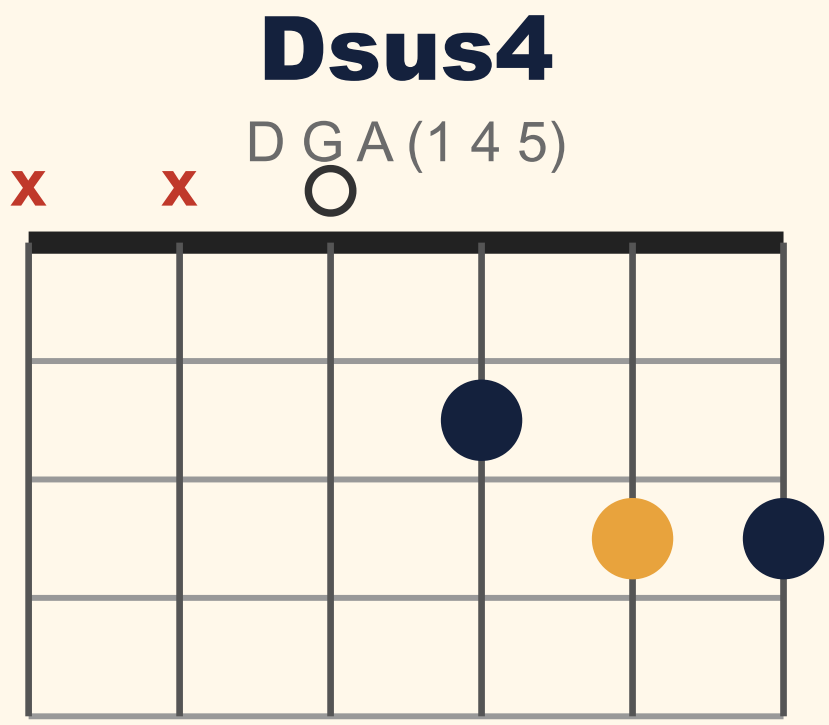
Asus4: A D E. For Asus2, swap D for B.

☐ Goal: Recognize sus chords by the missing third.

EXERCISE 105 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Dsus chords resolving home

1. Play D, Dsus2 (D E A), D, then Dsus4 (D G A), D.
2. Hold each for two beats; the sus note then moves into the third.
3. Add an A major in front: A, Dsus4, D.
4. Loop for two minutes.



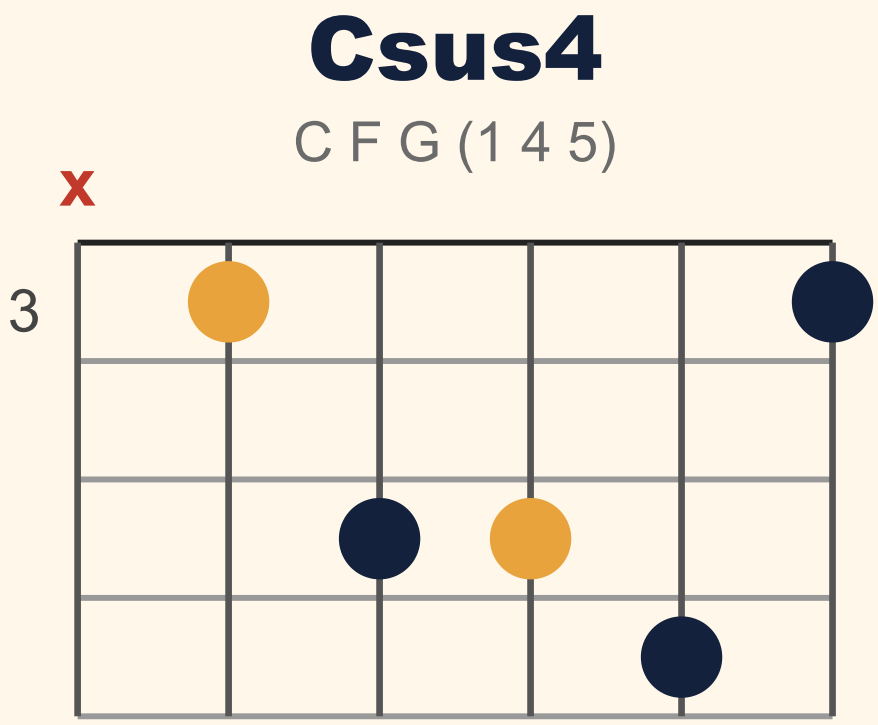
Dsus4: D G A. The G falls to F# when it resolves to D.

☐ Goal: Use sus chords as tension that resolves.

EXERCISE 106 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Sus chords up the neck: Csus4

1. Play Csus4 (C F G) with the A-form shape at fret 3.
2. Resolve it to C major (C E G) at the same fret.
3. Do the same with the E form: Gsus4 at fret 3 (G C D) to G.
4. Alternate three times each.



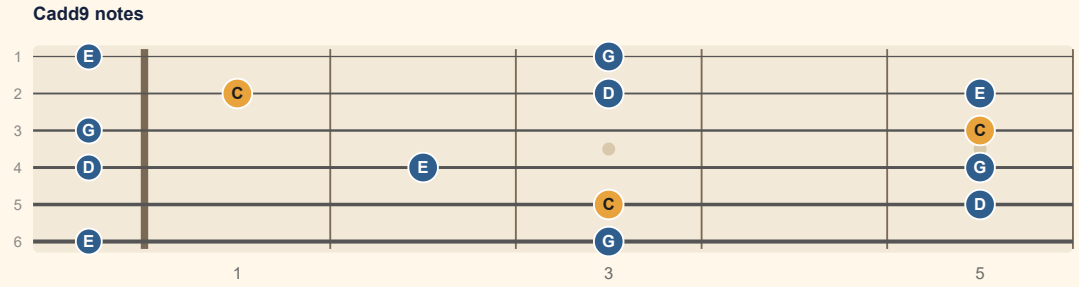
Csus4: C F G, A-form at fret 3.

☐ Goal: Move the sus idea onto movable shapes.

EXERCISE 107 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: Add the 9th: Cadd9

1. Play an open C (C E G).
2. Add the D note (the 9th) on top. The diagram shows every C, E, G and D in frets 0 to 5; find the D on string 2, fret 3 or string 1, fret 10.
3. Alternate C and Cadd9, four beats each.
4. Describe what the D adds: sparkle.



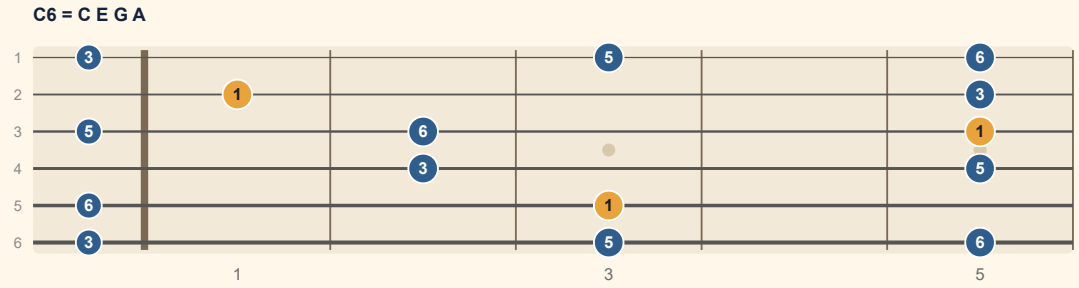
Cadd9 = C E G D. The D is the 9th, the same note as the 2nd, an octave up.

☐ Goal: Hear a 9th as color on top of a plain major chord.

EXERCISE 108 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: The 6th chord: C6 versus Am7

1. C6 contains C E G A. Play it using the notes in the diagram.
2. Am7 contains A C E G, the same four notes. Play Am7 next.
3. Alternate and listen: the bass note decides the sound.
4. Say out loud: same notes, different bass note, different chord.



Degrees from C: 1, 3, 5 and 6.

☐ Goal: Understand how a 6th chord and its relative m7 share notes.

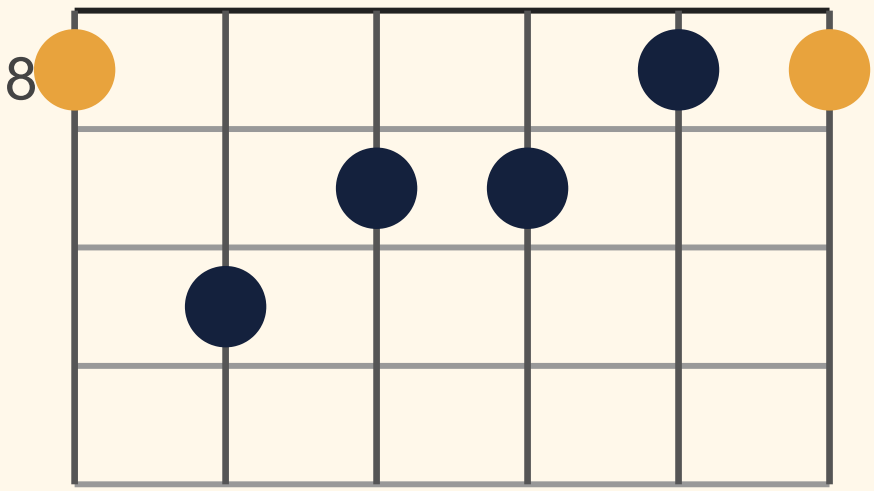
EXERCISE 109 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: One chord, three voicings: Cmaj7

1. Play open Cmaj7 (C E G B).
2. Play Cmaj7 as an A-form shape at fret 3.
3. Play Cmaj7 as an E-form shape at fret 8.
4. Go low, middle, high, and back, two beats each.

Cmaj7

C E G B (1 3 5 7)



Cmaj7, E-form at fret 8: root on string 6.

☐ Goal: Know three places to play the same seventh chord.

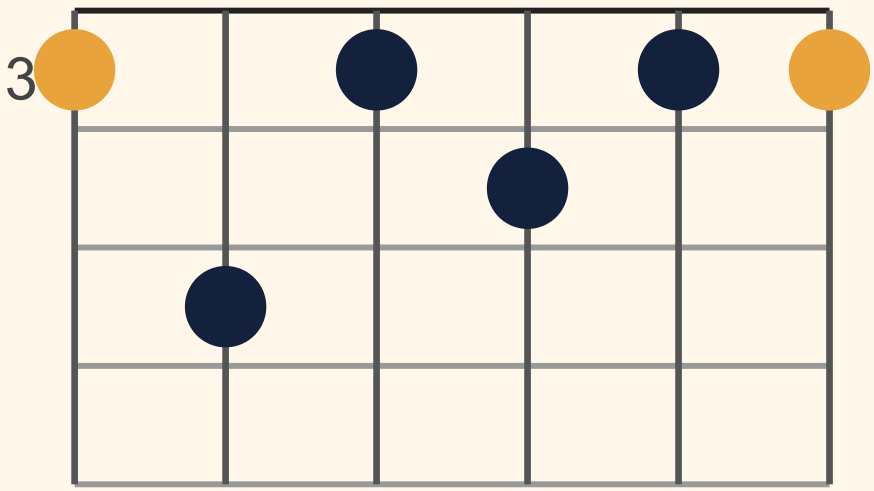
EXERCISE 110 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Smooth ii-V-I with barre forms

1. Play Dm7 as an A-form shape at fret 5 (D F A C).
2. Play G7 as an E-form shape at fret 3 (G B D F).
3. Play Cmaj7 as an A-form shape at fret 3 (C E G B).
4. Loop the three chords: the hand moves only a couple of frets each time.

G7

G B D F (1 3 5 b7)



G7, E-form at fret 3, the middle chord of the loop.

☐ Goal: Play a ii-V-I with tiny movements.

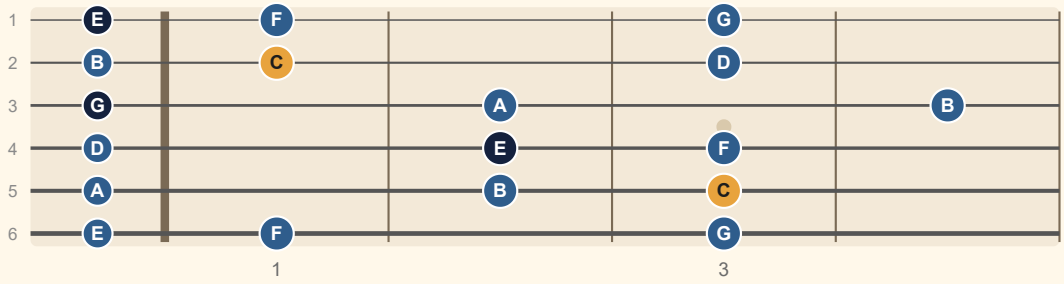
Week 12: CAGED: shapes C, A, G

EXERCISE 111 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: The C shape in the key of C

1. Play the open C chord (C E G C E): this is the C shape of CAGED.
2. Pick it one string at a time from string 5 to string 1.
3. Find the roots: string 5 fret 3 and string 2 fret 1.
4. Strum it four beats, then pause and repeat.

C major, C-shape (chord tones dark, root orange, other scale notes blue)



The C shape, in key C: this is open C.

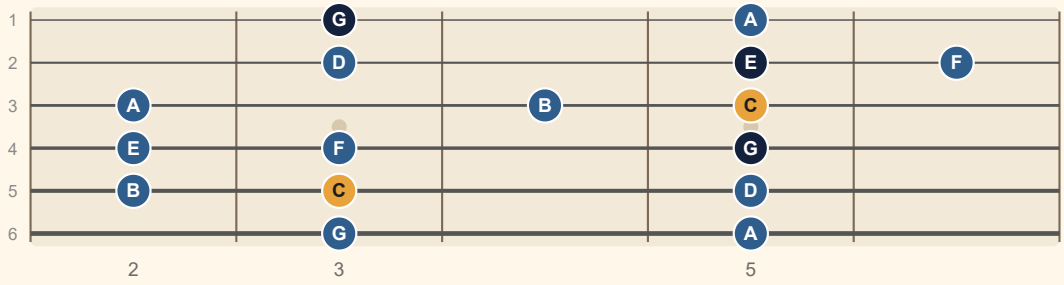
☐ Goal: See open C as the first of five shapes.

EXERCISE 112 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: The A shape in the key of C

1. Play C major as an A-form barre at fret 3 (strings 5 to 1).
2. Find the roots: string 5 fret 3 and string 3 fret 5.
3. Pick the notes one by one: C, G, C, E, G.
4. Strum it, then play open C and the A shape back to back.

C major, A-shape (chord tones dark, root orange, other scale notes blue)



The A shape in key C, around frets 3 to 5.

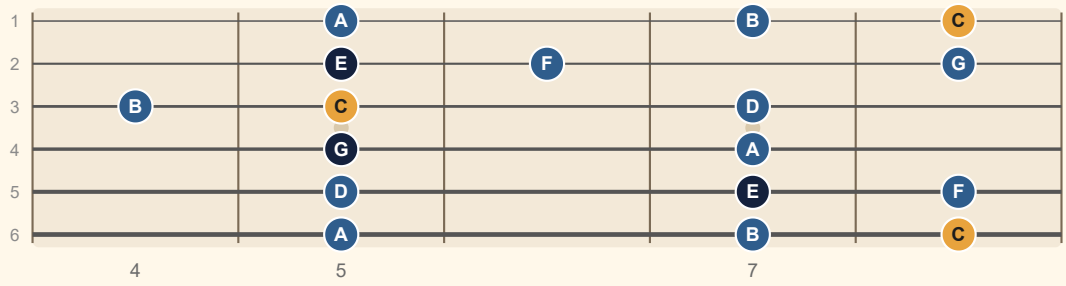
☐ Goal: Play the A shape for C and link it to the open C.

EXERCISE 113 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: The G shape in the key of C

1. Play the G-shape C chord: frets 8, 7, 5, 5, 5, 8 on strings 6 to 1 (C E G C E C).
2. Use your ring finger or pinky for the notes at fret 8 on strings 6 and 1.
3. Pick it string by string, then strum.
4. Then play the A shape followed by the G shape.

C major, G-shape (chord tones dark, root orange, other scale notes blue)



The G shape in key C: fret 8 is its root on string 6.

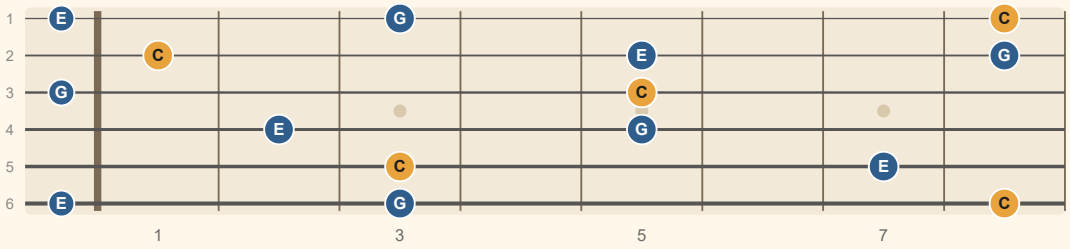
☐ Goal: Place the G shape of C around frets 5 to 8.

EXERCISE 114 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Climb C, A, G in order

1. Play C in the C shape (open).
2. Play C in the A shape (fret 3).
3. Play C in the G shape (frets 5 to 8).
4. Say the shape names as you go, two beats each, then climb back down.

C, E and G across the neck



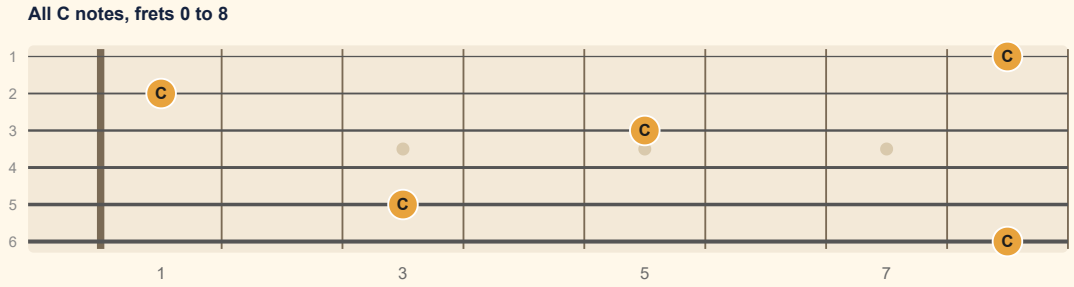
The same three chord tones everywhere: each shape is a slice of this picture.

☐ Goal: Connect three shapes in order, low to high.

EXERCISE 115 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Find every C

1. Find each C between frets 0 and 8: string 5 fret 3, string 3 fret 5, string 2 fret 1, string 6 fret 8, string 1 fret 8.
2. Play each one slowly and say its string and fret.
3. Then spot which of them are the roots of the C, A and G shapes.
4. Repeat without the diagram.



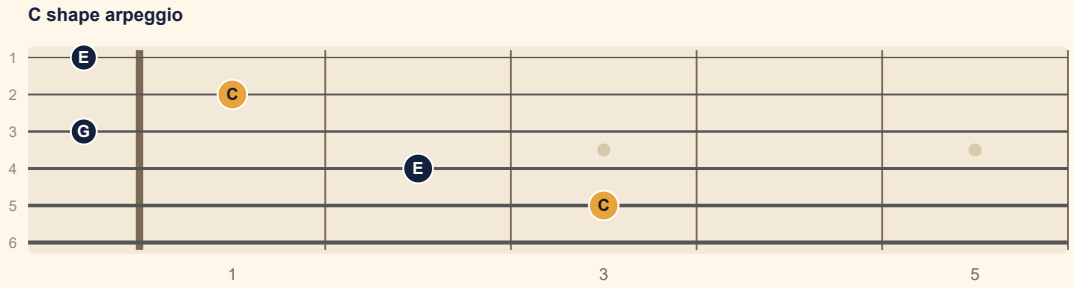
The roots are your landmarks.

☐ Goal: Locate the roots that anchor each shape.

EXERCISE 116 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Arpeggiate the C shape, then the A shape

1. Play the open C shape one note at a time: C, E, G, C, E.
2. Slide into the A shape at fret 3 and play C, G, C, E, G.
3. Alternate the two arpeggios four times.
4. Keep a steady, relaxed pulse.



The open C shape: C E G C E.

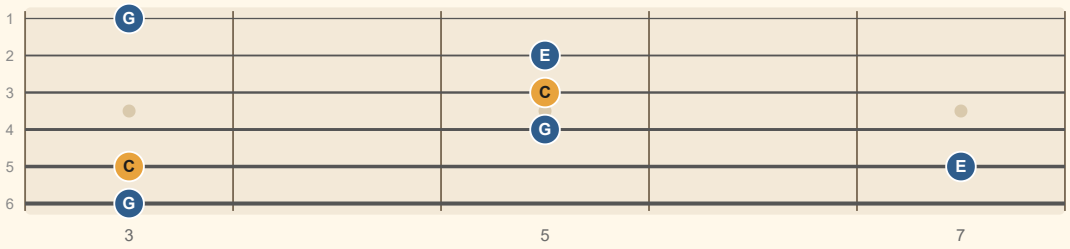
☐ Goal: Hear how each shape holds the same three notes.

EXERCISE 117 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: Shared notes between shapes

1. Play the A shape at fret 3 and look at strings 4, 3 and 2 at fret 5: G, C and E.
2. Now play the G shape: strings 4, 3 and 2 at fret 5 are the same notes.
3. Switch between the A shape and the G shape by changing only the top and bottom strings.
4. Notice how easily the shapes overlap.

The overlap zone



Around fret 5, the A shape and the G shape use the same three notes.

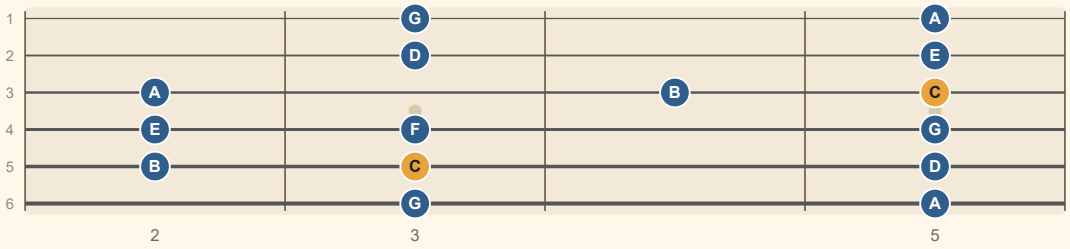
☐ Goal: See that CAGED shapes share notes and so link naturally.

EXERCISE 118 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: A major scale through the shapes

1. Play the C major scale (C D E F G A B C) in the zone shown, frets 2 to 6, one string at a time.
2. Play it up and down at a slow, steady tempo.
3. Whenever you pass a C, E or G, hold it a little longer: those are your chord tones.
4. Finish by strumming the A shape at fret 3.

C major



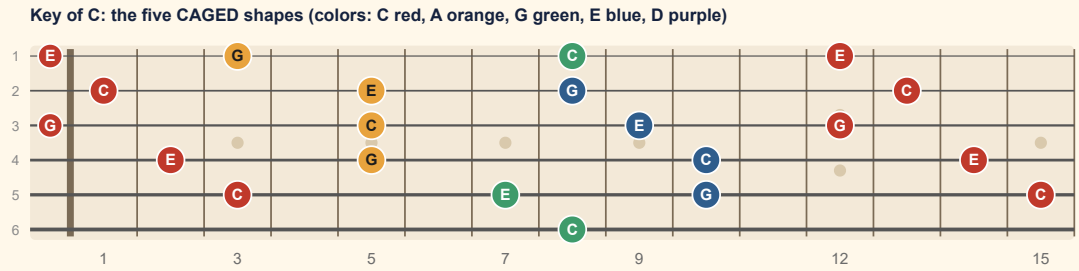
C major notes around the A shape.

☐ Goal: Link scale notes to the chord shape in the same area.

EXERCISE 119 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Loop the shapes with a steady beat

1. Set a slow beat around 60 per minute.
2. Play C (C shape), C (A shape), C (G shape), C (A shape), four beats each.
3. Aim for a gap between shapes shorter than one beat.
4. Repeat for the full five minutes.



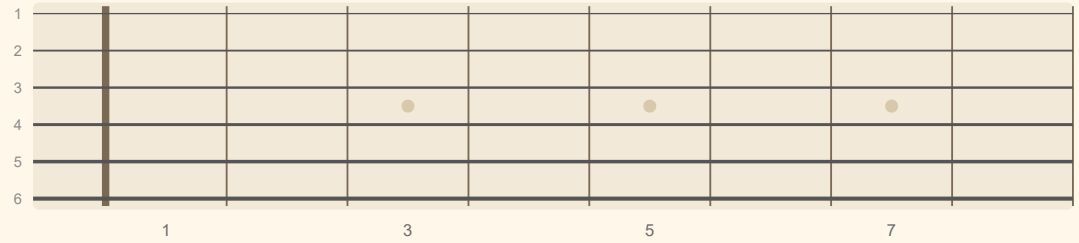
All five shapes in key C. This week uses C, A and G.

☐ Goal: Connect the shapes with time and confidence.

EXERCISE 120 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Draw your own map of C

1. Look at the blank fretboard in the diagram.
2. Mark, from memory, all C notes in frets 0 to 8.
3. Add the E and G beside them to complete the C shape, the A shape and the G shape.
4. Check against your earlier diagrams and fix anything you missed.



Mark C, E and G, then outline the three shapes.

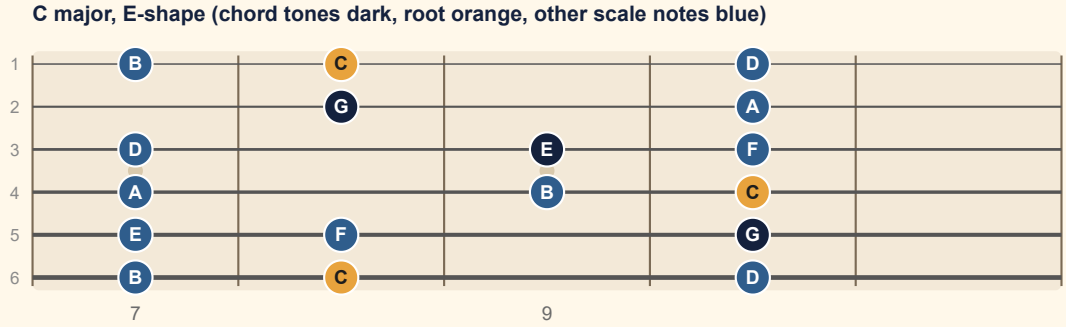
☐ Goal: Rebuild the three-shape map of C from memory.

Week 13: CAGED completed and pentatonic boxes

EXERCISE 121 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: The E shape in C

1. Play a C major chord as an E-shape barre: index finger across fret 8, then build the familiar E-chord shape from there.
2. Strum slowly and check that every string rings.
3. Look at the diagram and find the three C roots (strings 6, 4 and 1).



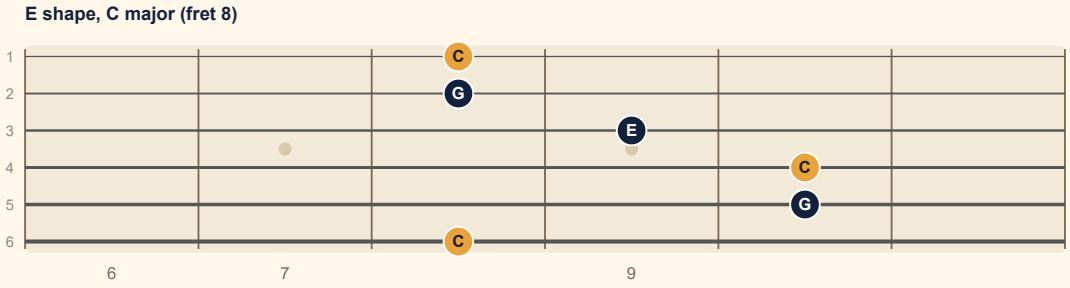
E shape for C major: the root sits on string 6, fret 8.

☐ Goal: Play and recognize the E shape for C major at fret 8.

EXERCISE 122 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Name every note of the E shape

1. Play the E-shape C chord at fret 8 one string at a time, from string 6 to string 1.
2. Say each note aloud as you pick it: C, G, C, E, G, C.
3. Replay it, this time saying the chord tone: root, 5th, root, 3rd, 5th, root.



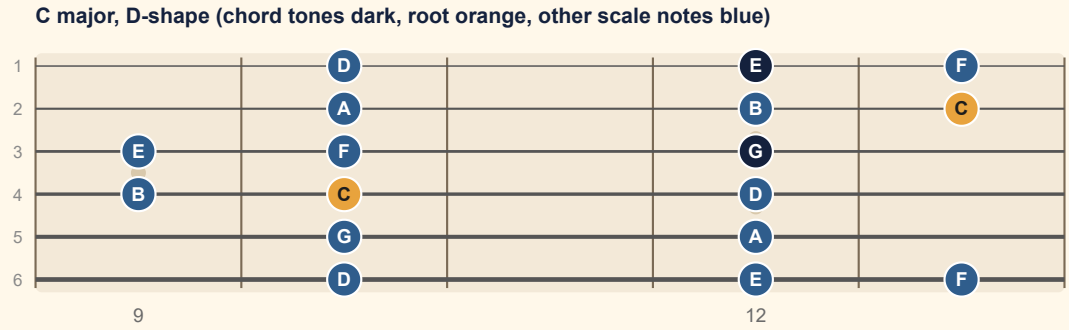
Roots in color; the other dots are the 3rd (E) and 5th (G).

☐ Goal: Know the note and function of every string in the E shape.

EXERCISE 123 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: The D shape in C

1. Find C on string 4: it is fret 10.
2. Build the D shape around it: string 3 fret 12, string 2 fret 13, string 1 fret 12 (strings 6 and 5 stay muted).
3. Strum the four strings and compare the sound to your open C chord. Same chord, higher voice.



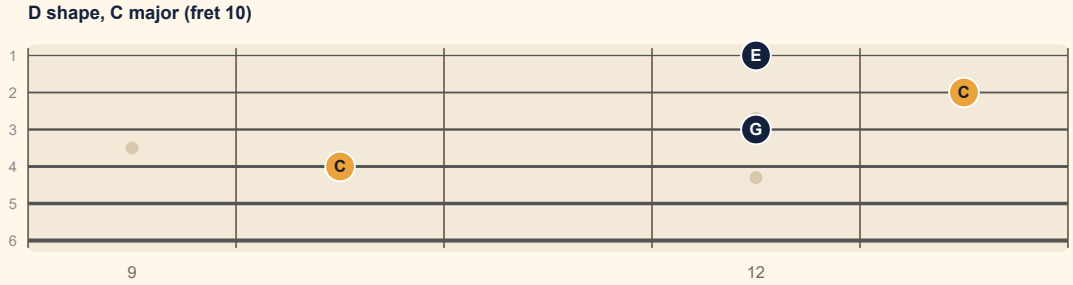
D shape for C major: root on string 4, fret 10.

☐ Goal: Play the D shape for C major at fret 10.

EXERCISE 124 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Name every note of the D shape

1. Pick the four notes of the D-shape C chord one at a time.
2. Say them as you play: C, G, C, E.
3. Find the two C notes in the shape and say which strings they are on (4 and 2).



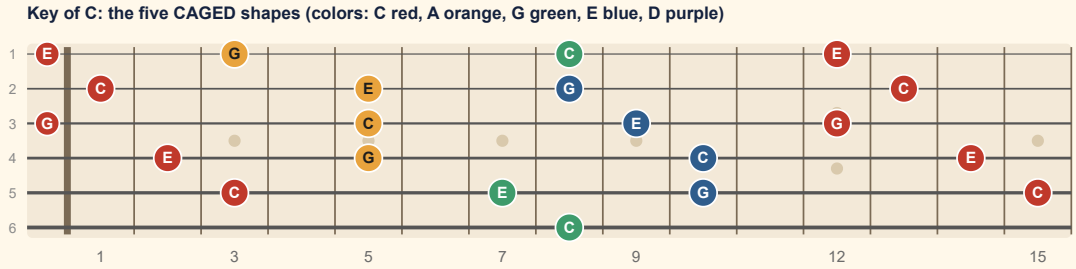
Four strings, three different notes: C, G and E.

☐ Goal: Know the notes inside the D shape.

EXERCISE 125 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Link the E shape to the D shape

1. Play the E-shape C chord at fret 8, then slide up to the D-shape C chord at fret 10.
2. Go back and forth four times, listening for the same C major sound.
3. Notice which notes the two shapes share around frets 8 to 10.



All five CAGED shapes of C major strung up the neck. Today: E then D.

☐ Goal: Move between neighboring CAGED shapes without losing the chord.

EXERCISE 126 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Chain all five shapes in C

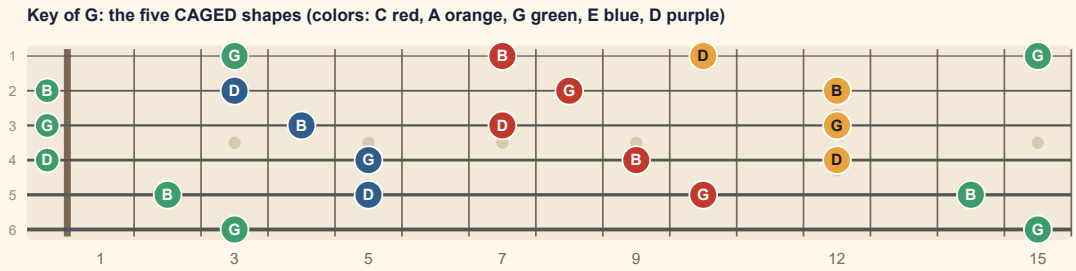
1. Play C major in the open C shape, then the A shape (fret 3), the G shape (frets 5 to 8), the E shape (fret 8) and the D shape (fret 10).
2. Pause on each one and say its name out loud.
3. Keep the same strumming rhythm all the way up.

☐ Goal: Travel the whole neck on one chord using the five shapes.

EXERCISE 127 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: Five shapes in the key of G

1. Play G major in order: G shape (open), E shape (fret 3), D shape (fret 5), C shape (root on string 5, fret 10), A shape (also fret 10).
2. Compare with yesterday's C chain: the order of shapes is always C A G E D.
3. Pick the shape that feels hardest and play it three extra times.



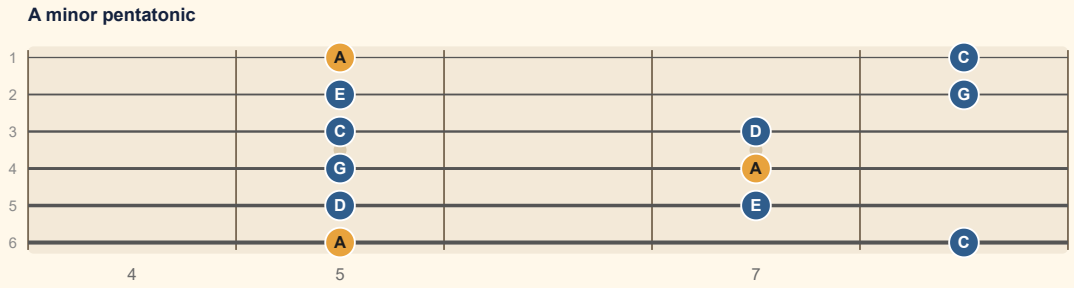
The five shapes for G major.

☐ Goal: Prove the shape order stays the same in any key.

EXERCISE 128 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: Pentatonic box 1 (A minor)

1. Put your index finger on fret 5 and play A minor pentatonic: A C D E G across frets 5 to 8.
2. Play it up and down using two notes per string.
3. Say the note names out loud as you go.



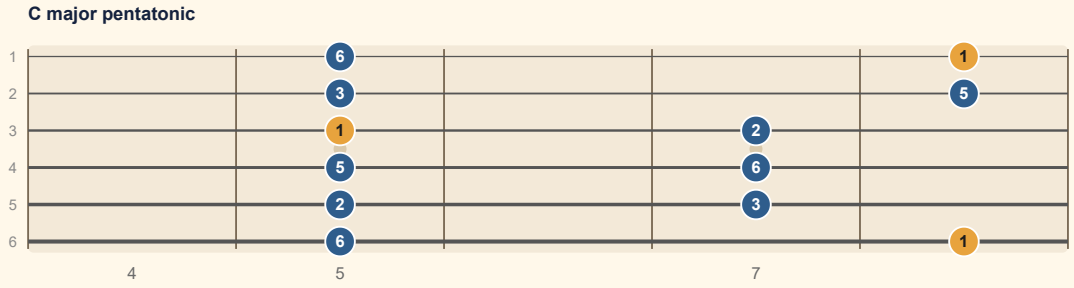
A minor pentatonic, box 1.

☐ Goal: Own the first pentatonic box, with the root on string 6.

EXERCISE 129 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: The same box is C major pentatonic

1. Play the box 1 pattern from yesterday, but now start and land on C (string 3, fret 5).
2. Hear it resolve to C instead of A. Same notes, new home.
3. Play a C chord, then solo over it with only those five notes.



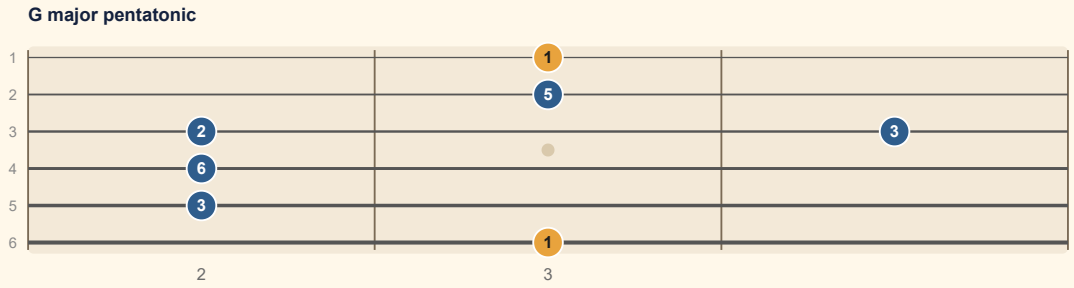
C major pentatonic: C D E G A, the same dots as A minor pentatonic.

☐ Goal: Understand that relative major and minor pentatonic share one box.

EXERCISE 130 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Pentatonic inside the E shape (G)

1. Play the E-shape G chord at fret 3.
2. Play G major pentatonic (G A B D E) in the frets 2 to 5 around it.
3. Alternate: chord, three notes of the scale, chord.



G major pentatonic around the E-shape G chord.

☐ Goal: Connect a chord shape to the scale box wrapped around it.

Week 14: Progressions and Roman numerals

EXERCISE 131 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: Number the chords of C major

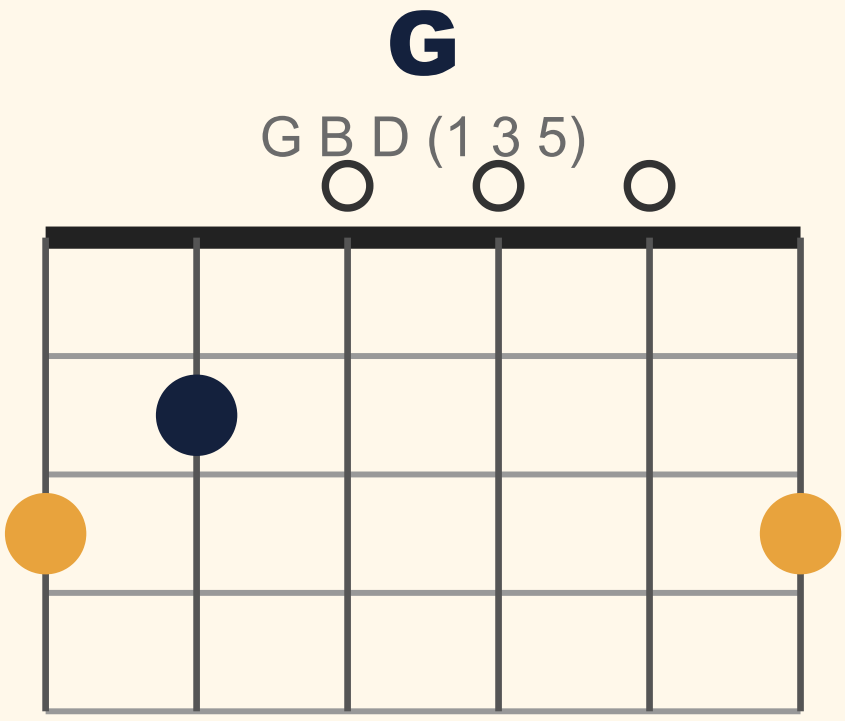
1. Write the seven chords of C major: C, Dm, Em, F, G, Am, Bdim.
2. Under each, write its Roman numeral: I ii iii IV V vi vii-dim.
3. Play the first, fourth and fifth (C, F, G) and say the numerals aloud.

☐ Goal: Connect each chord of the key to its Roman numeral.

EXERCISE 132 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: I IV V in C

1. Strum C for four beats, F for four, G for four, C for four.
2. Say the numerals as you change: one, four, five, one.
3. Repeat three times, keeping the beat steady.



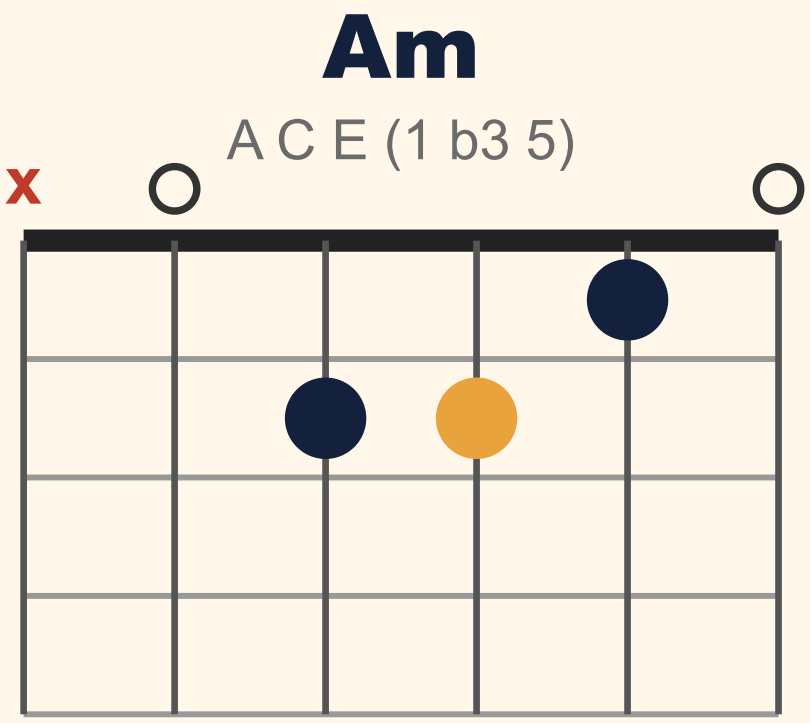
The V chord of C.

☐ Goal: Hear the three most common chords working together.

EXERCISE 133 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: The pop loop I V vi IV

1. In C, play C (I), G (V), Am (vi), F (IV), two strums each.
2. Loop it for five minutes without stopping.
3. Note how the Am gives a sad turn before F brings it back.



vi in the key of C.

☐ Goal: Play the most used progression in popular music.

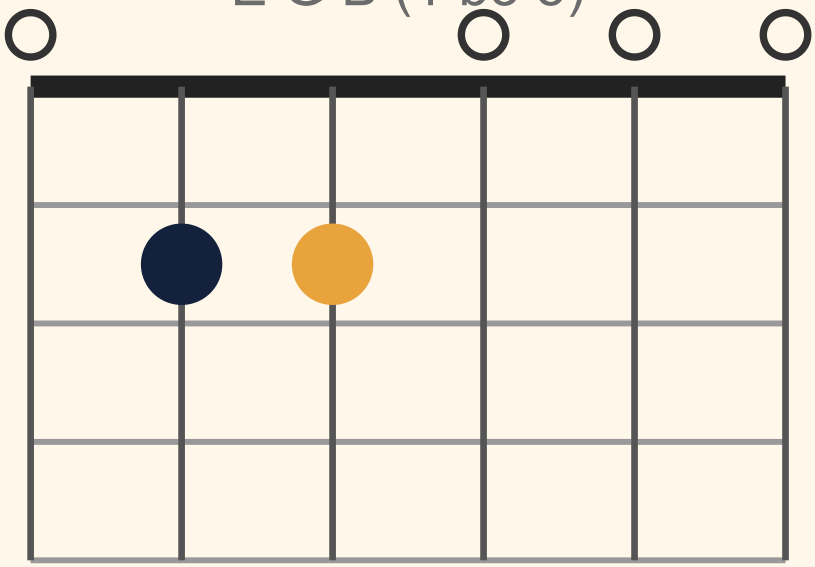
EXERCISE 134 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Transpose I V vi IV to G

1. Work out the chords: I = G, V = D, vi = Em, IV = C.
2. Play G D Em C with the same rhythm as yesterday.
3. Switch back and forth between the C and G versions.

Em

E G B (1 b3 5)



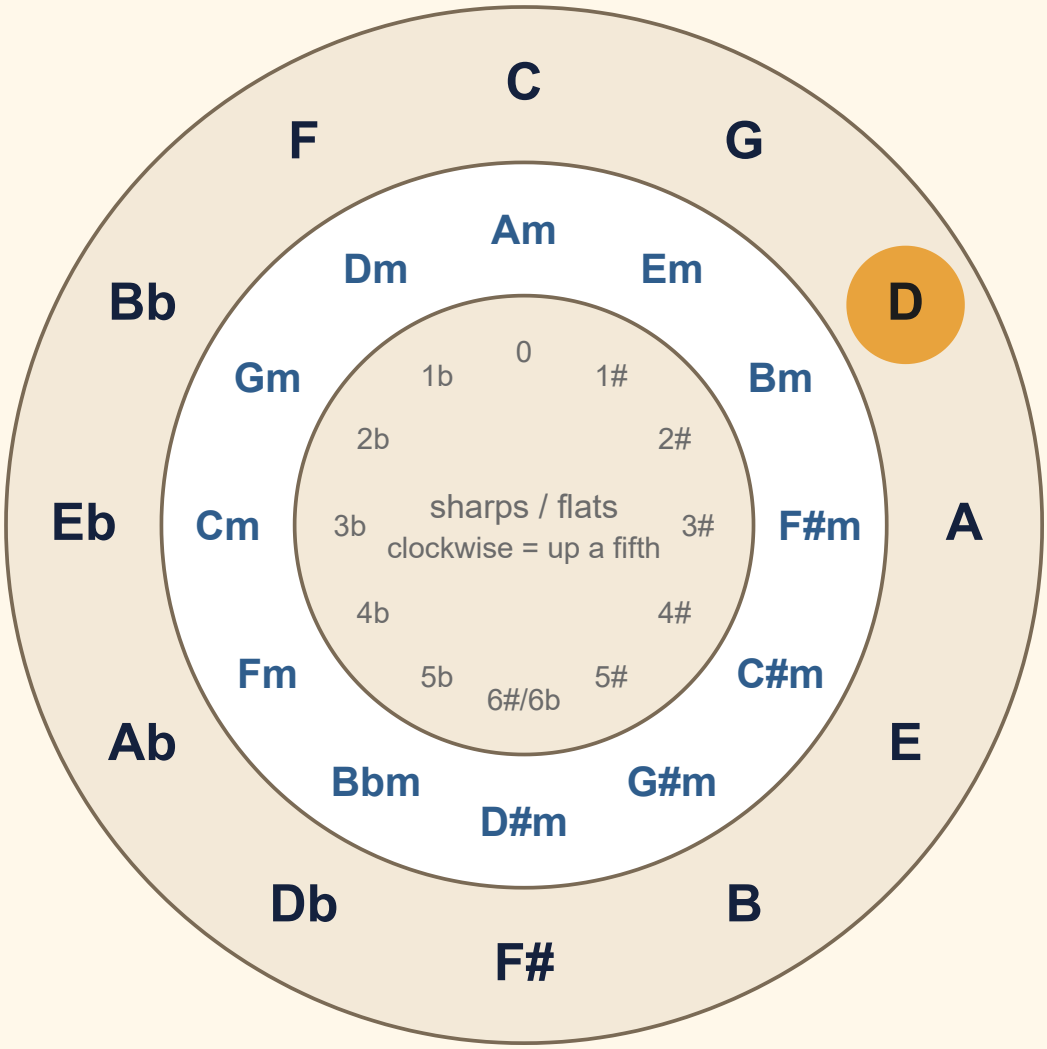
vi in the key of G.

☐ Goal: Transpose a progression by thinking in numerals.

EXERCISE 135 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Transpose to D

1. Spell D major: D E F# G A B C#.
2. Pick the chords: I = D, V = A, vi = Bm, IV = G.
3. Play D A Bm G; use a barre for Bm on fret 2.



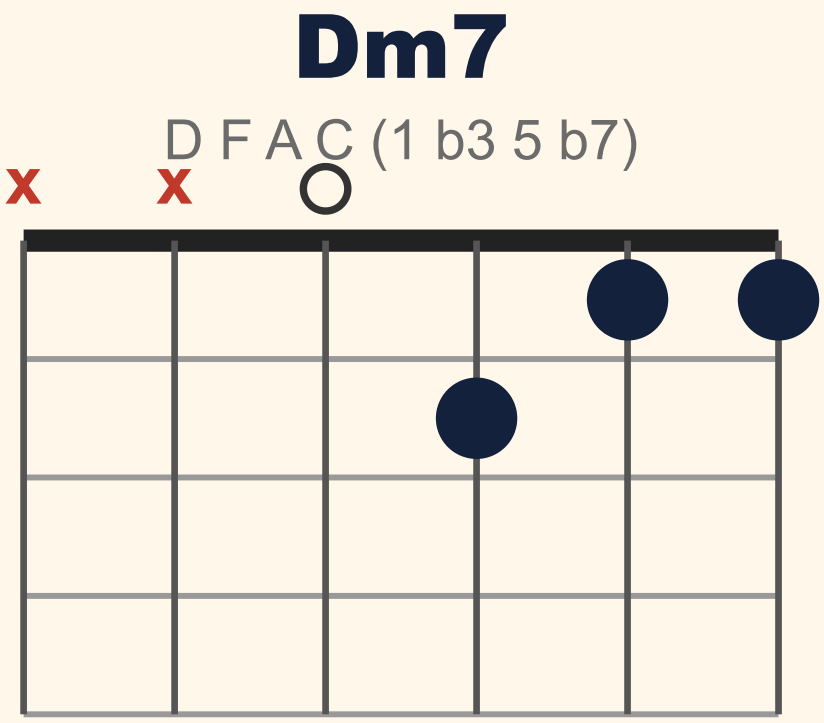
D major: two sharps (F# and C#).

☐ Goal: Transpose the same loop into a third key.

EXERCISE 136 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: ii V I in C

1. Play Dm7, G7 and Cmaj7, two strums each.
2. Say the numerals: ii, V, I.
3. Listen for the pull from G7 toward C.



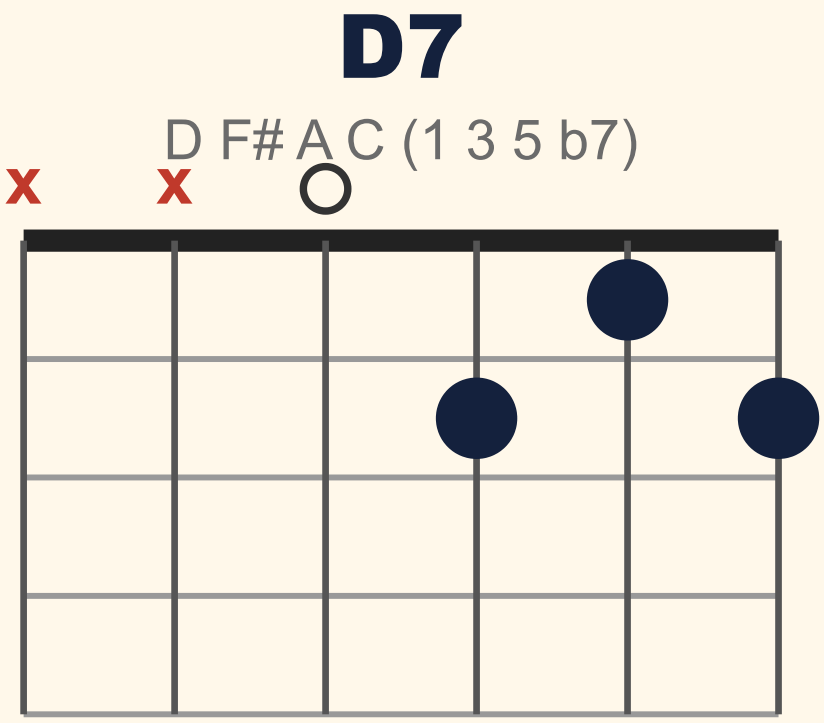
ii7 in the key of C.

☐ Goal: Hear and play the cadence behind countless songs.

EXERCISE 137 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: ii V I in G

1. Spell the chords: Am7 (ii), D7 (V), Gmaj7 (I).
2. Play them slowly, using Gmaj7 as 3 2 0 0 0 2 (strings 6 to 1).
3. Compare with yesterday's C version.



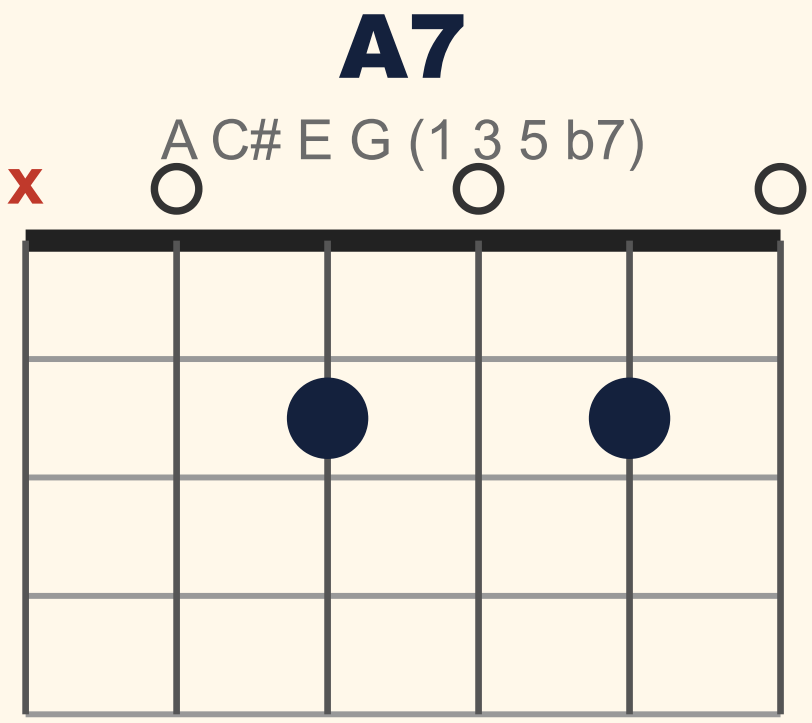
V7 in the key of G.

☐ Goal: Move ii V I to a new key.

EXERCISE 138 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: 12-bar blues in A

1. Play A7 for four bars, D7 for two, A7 for two, E7 for one, D7 for one, A7 for two (two strums per bar).
2. Say the numerals: I I I I, IV IV I I, V IV I I.
3. Run the full 12 bars twice.



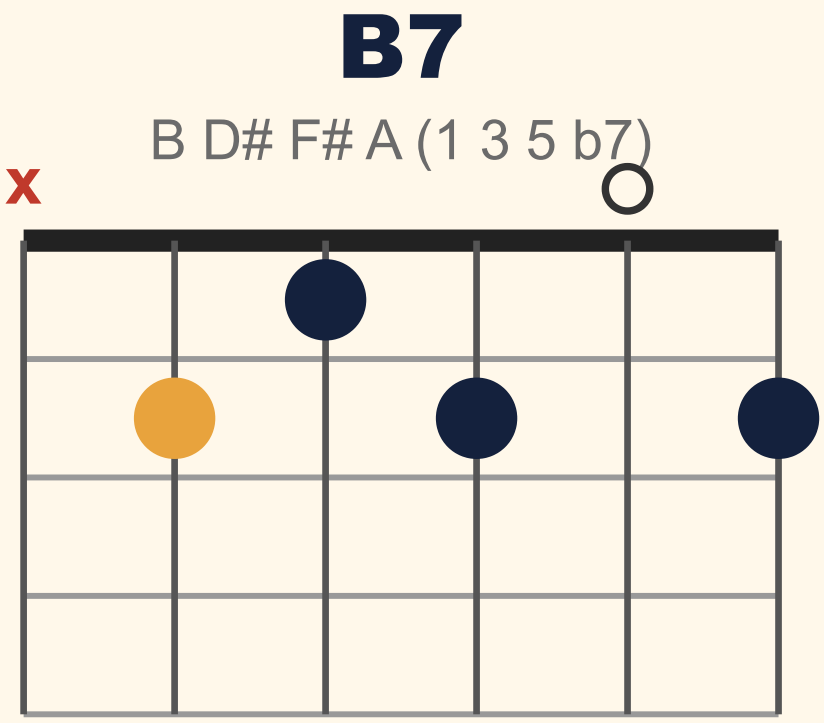
I7 of the blues in A.

☐ Goal: Play a complete 12-bar blues form.

EXERCISE 139 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: 12-bar blues in E

1. Use E7 (I), A7 (IV) and B7 (V).
2. Follow the same 12-bar map as yesterday: four I, two IV, two I, V, IV, two I.
3. Count bars out loud to stay in the form.



V7 of the blues in E.

☐ Goal: Transfer the blues map to another key.

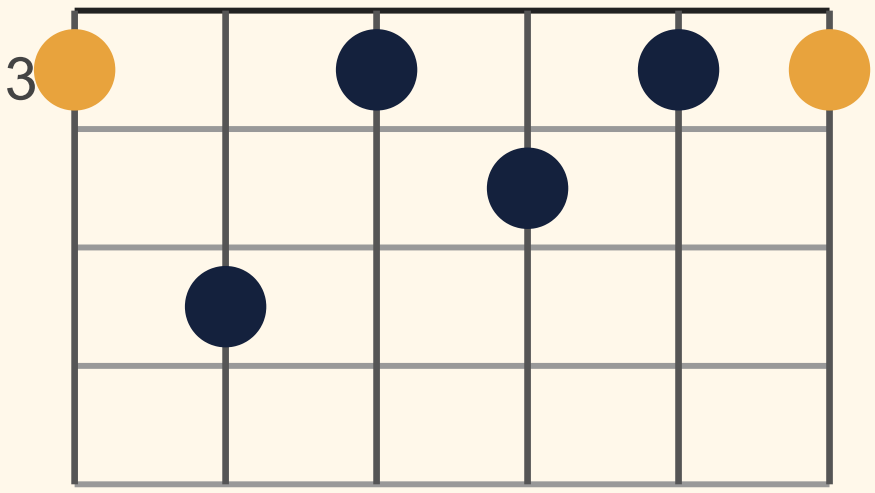
EXERCISE 140 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Blues in G with moveable shapes

1. Use G7 (E shape, fret 3), C7 (A shape, fret 3) and D7 (A shape, fret 5).
2. Try the quick change: bar 2 goes to IV for one bar, then back to I.
3. Play the 12 bars once with straight chords and once with the quick change.

G7

G B D F (1 3 5 b7)



G7 as an E-shape barre at fret 3.

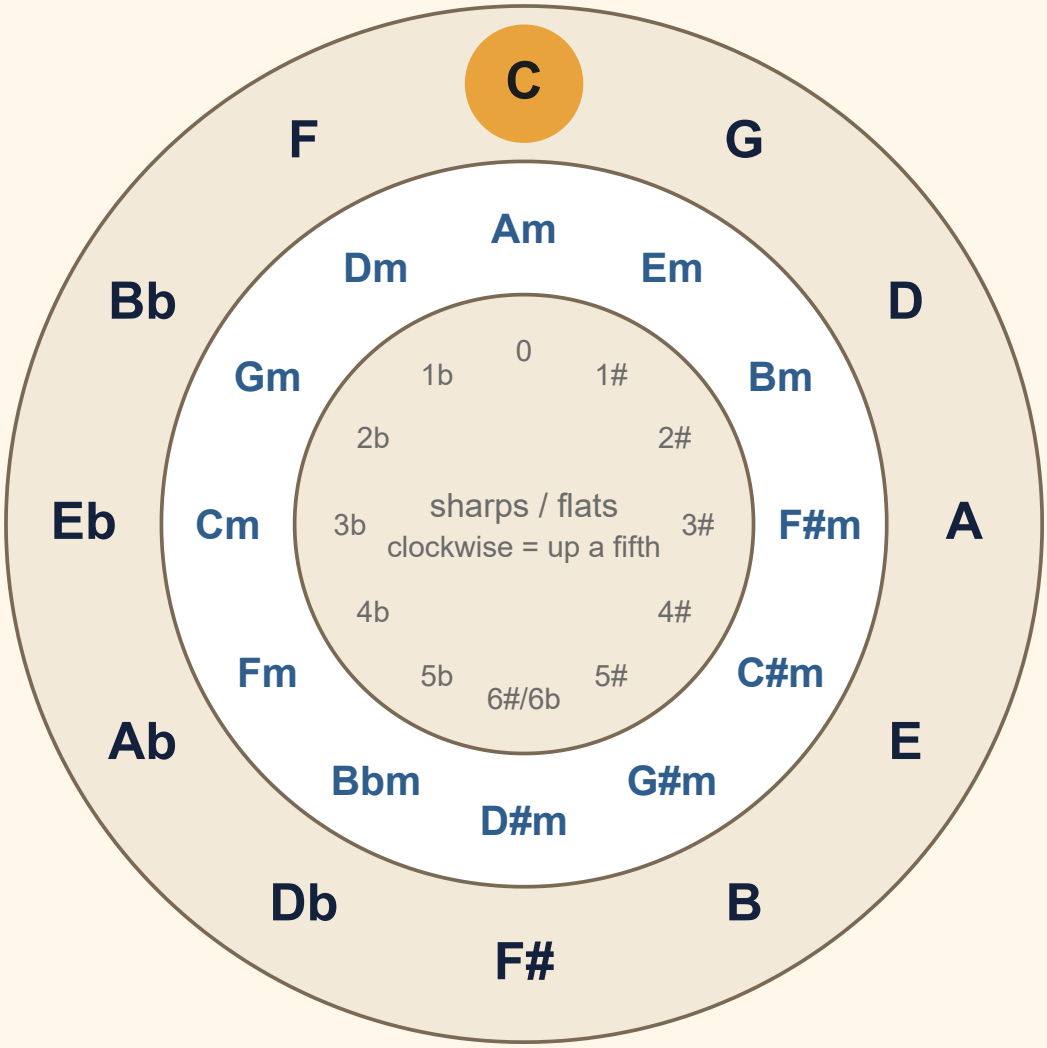
☐ Goal: Play a blues using barre shapes, so it works in any key.

Week 15: Circle of fifths and modulation

EXERCISE 141 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: Walk the circle of fifths

1. Starting at C, say each key a fifth up: C, G, D, A, E, B, F#.
2. Pick up your guitar and play the major chord for each key you can.
3. Go back down: F#, B, E, A, D, G, C.



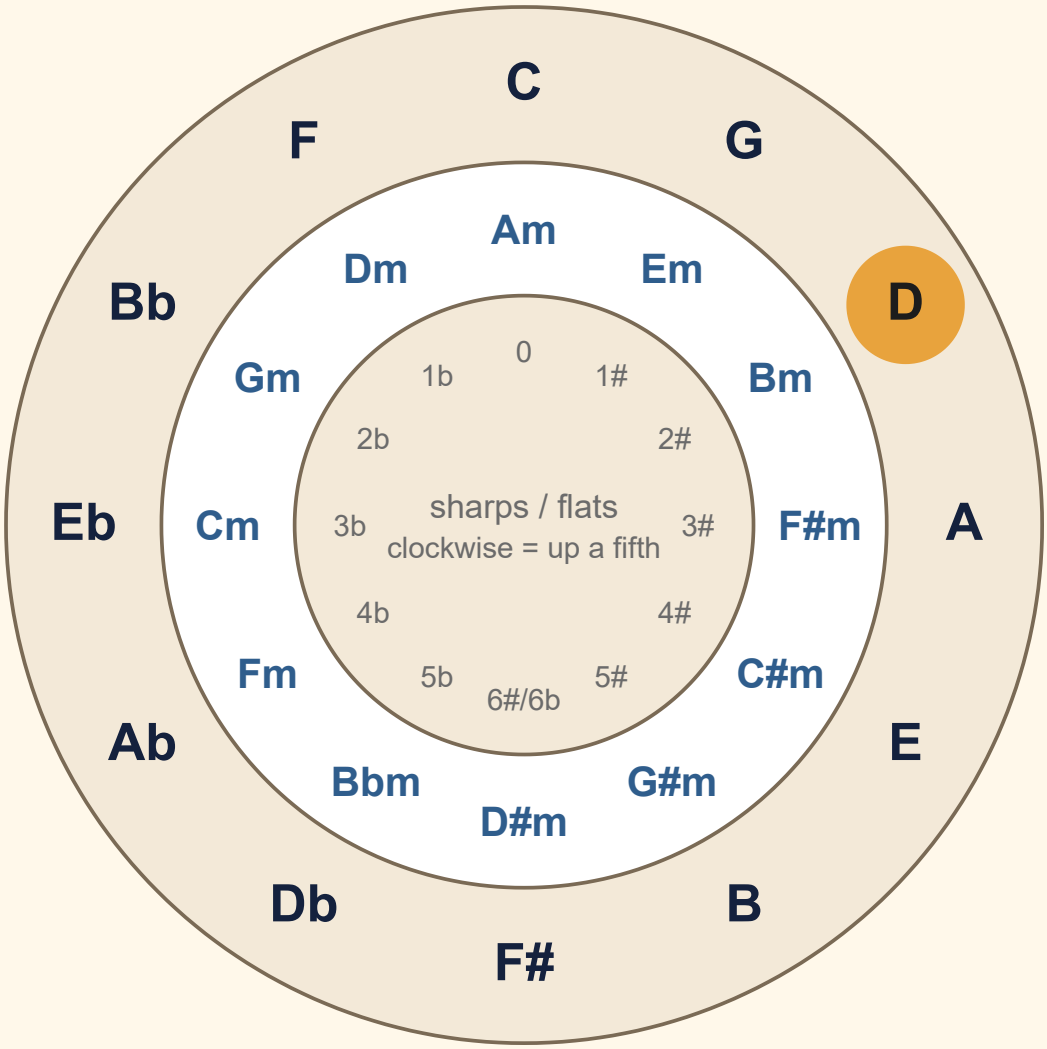
Clockwise = up a fifth.

☐ Goal: Know the order of the keys around the circle.

EXERCISE 142 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Count sharps and flats

1. G has one sharp (F#), D has two (F#, C#), A has three, E has four.
2. Going the other way: F has one flat (Bb), Bb has two (Bb, Eb), Eb has three.
3. Quiz yourself: say the key, then count out the sharps or flats.



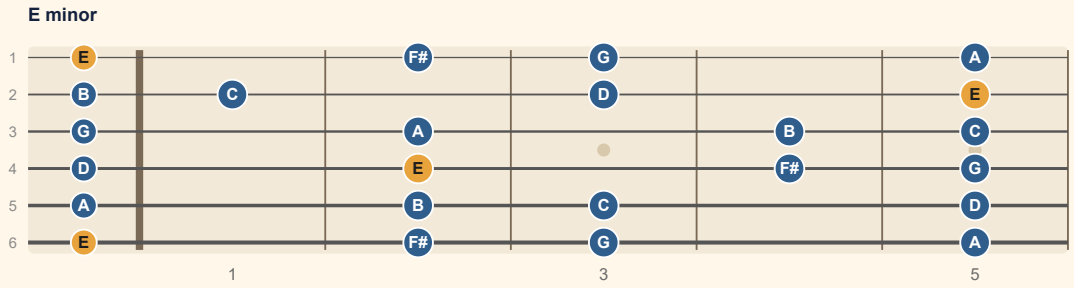
D major sits two steps clockwise from C.

☐ Goal: Link each key on the circle to its sharps and flats.

EXERCISE 143 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: Relative minors

1. Find the relative minor of C: count down three frets (three semitones) from C, and you land on A.
2. Play G major from fret 3 on string 6, then E minor from fret 0; both use G A B C D E F#.
3. Name the relative minors of D (B) and F (D).



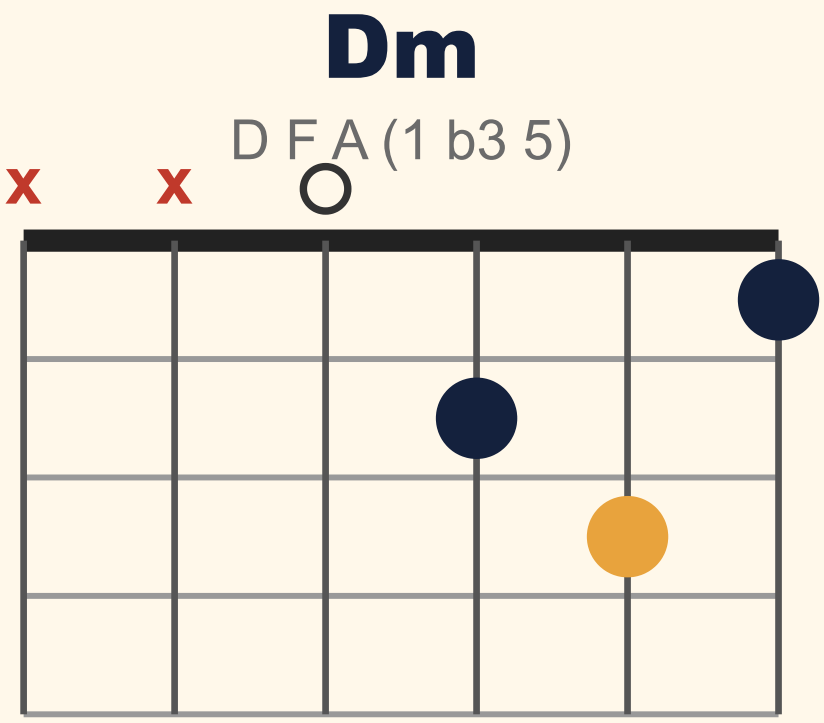
E minor: the same notes as G major.

☐ Goal: Find the relative minor of any major key.

EXERCISE 144 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Same notes, two homes

1. Play Am to C and back, then Em to G and back, then Dm to F and back.
2. Play the C major notes landing on A, then the same notes landing on C.
3. Describe the mood difference in a few words.



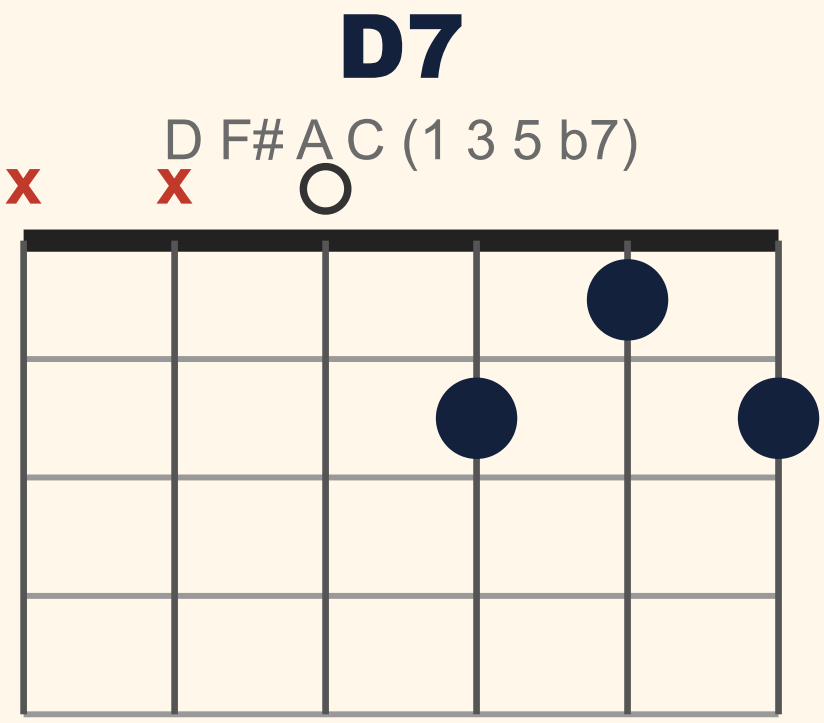
Dm is the relative minor of F.

☐ Goal: Hear how relative major and minor share notes but not feeling.

EXERCISE 145 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Secondary dominant: V of V

1. In C, play C then D7: the F# in D7 is not in the key.
2. Resolve D7 to G7, then G7 to C.
3. Hear how D7 acts as V of V.



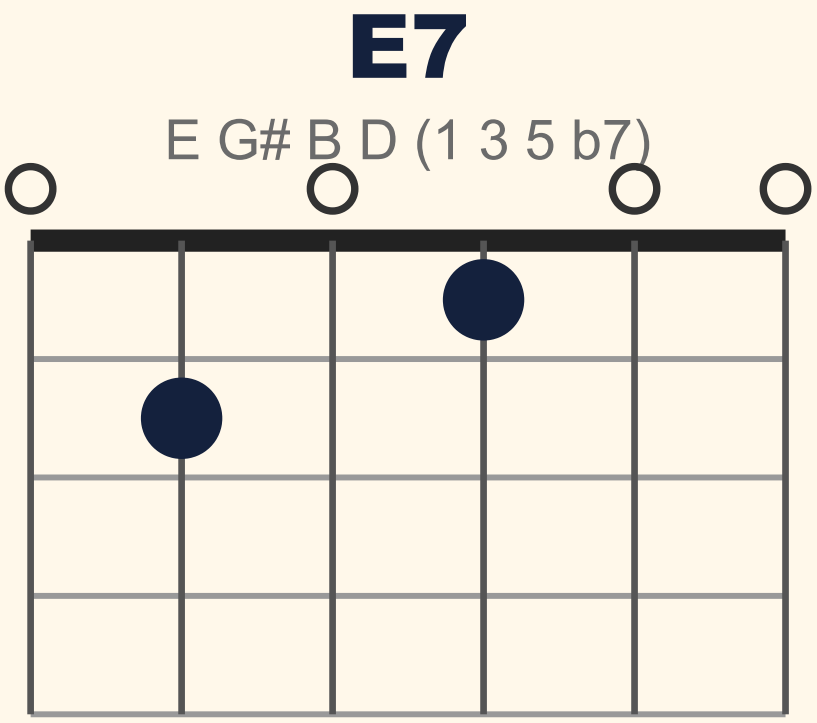
D7 is V/V in C.

☐ Goal: Understand a chord borrowed to lead to V.

EXERCISE 146 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Secondary dominant: V of vi

1. In C, play C then E7: the G# in E7 pulls up to A.
2. Resolve E7 to Am.
3. Play C, E7, Am, then F to finish.



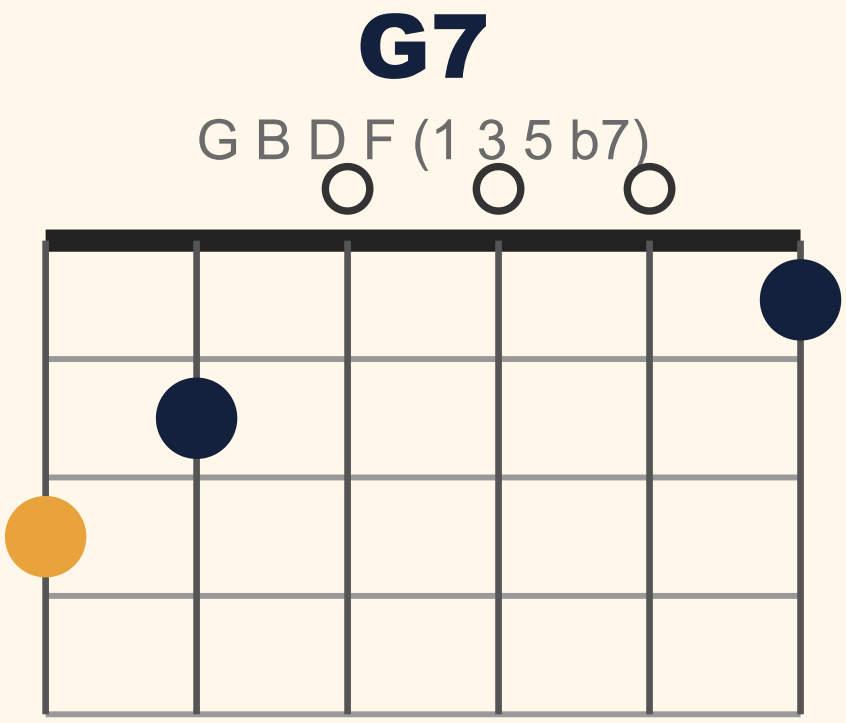
E7 is V/vi in C.

☐ Goal: Hear the strongest secondary dominant.

EXERCISE 147 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: A progression with two secondary dominants

1. Play C, E7, Am, D7, G7, C.
2. Label them: I, V/vi, vi, V/V, V, I.
3. Loop it until the changes feel smooth.



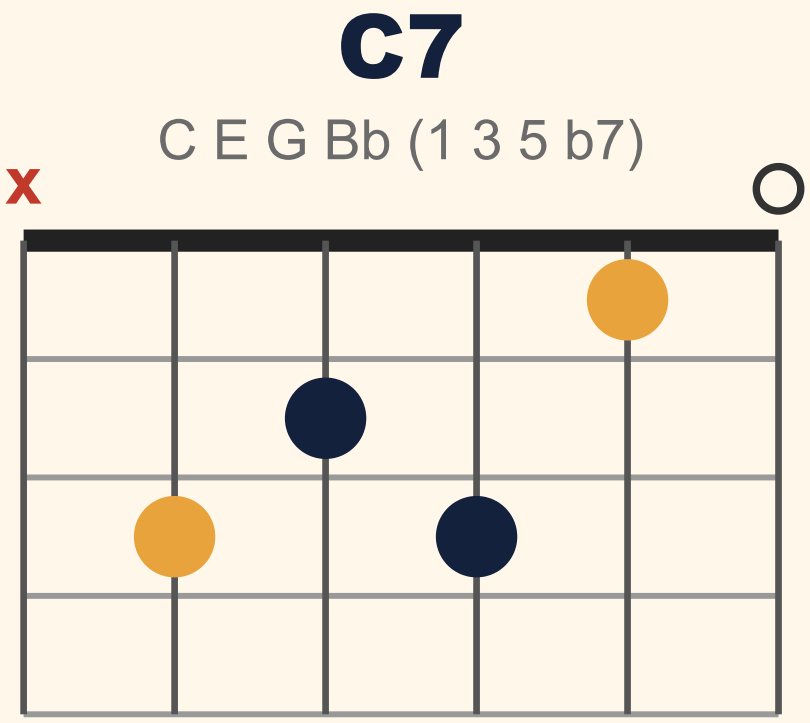
V7 in the key of C.

☐ Goal: Use secondary dominants inside a real progression.

EXERCISE 148 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: Secondary dominant: V of IV

1. In C, play C then C7: the Bb in C7 leads down to A in F.
2. Resolve C7 to F, then continue G7, C.
3. Compare plain C to F with the C7 version.



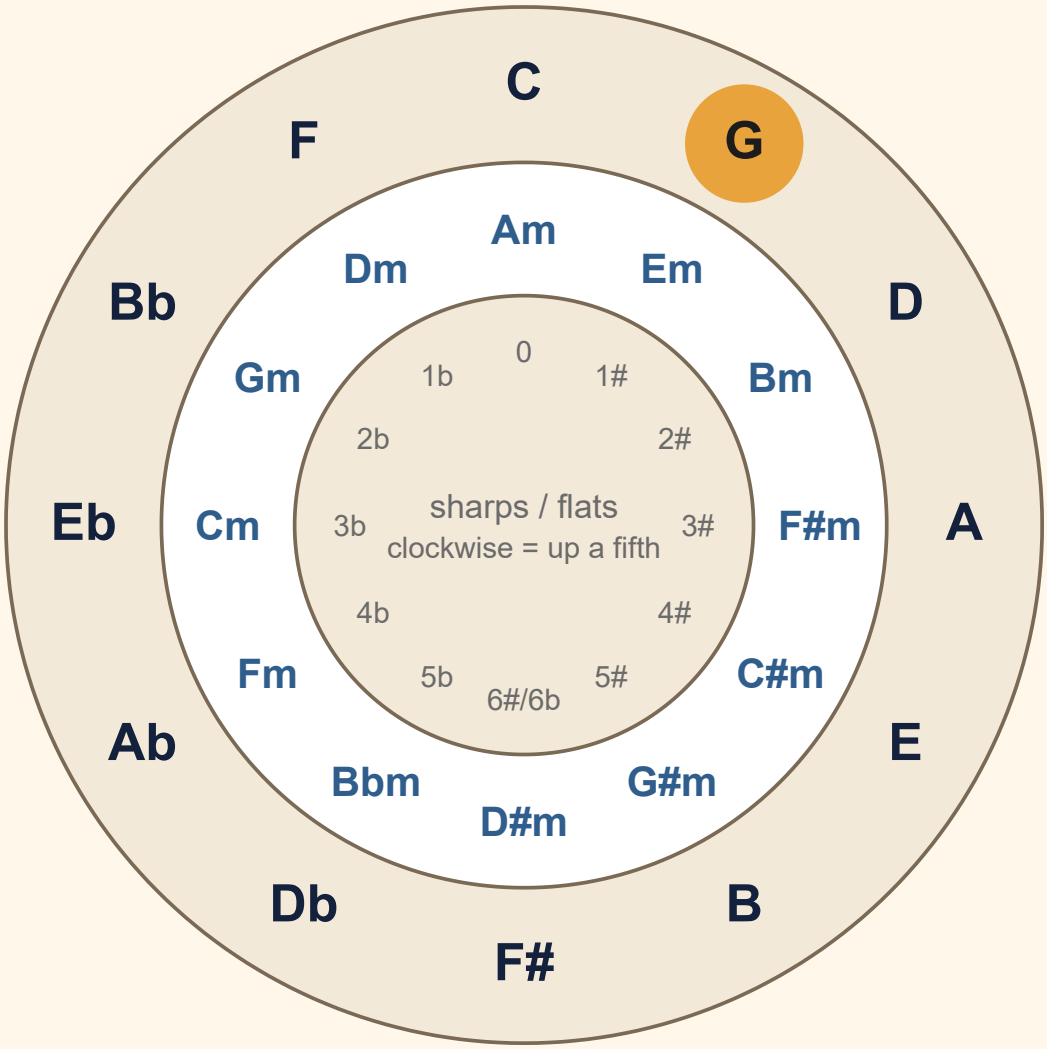
C7 is V/IV in C.

☐ Goal: Hear how adding the b7 points toward IV.

EXERCISE 149 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Modulation with a pivot chord

1. Play C, F, Am, D7, G.
2. Am is vi in C and ii in G; treat it as the pivot.
3. D7 is V in G, so the last G sounds like a new home.



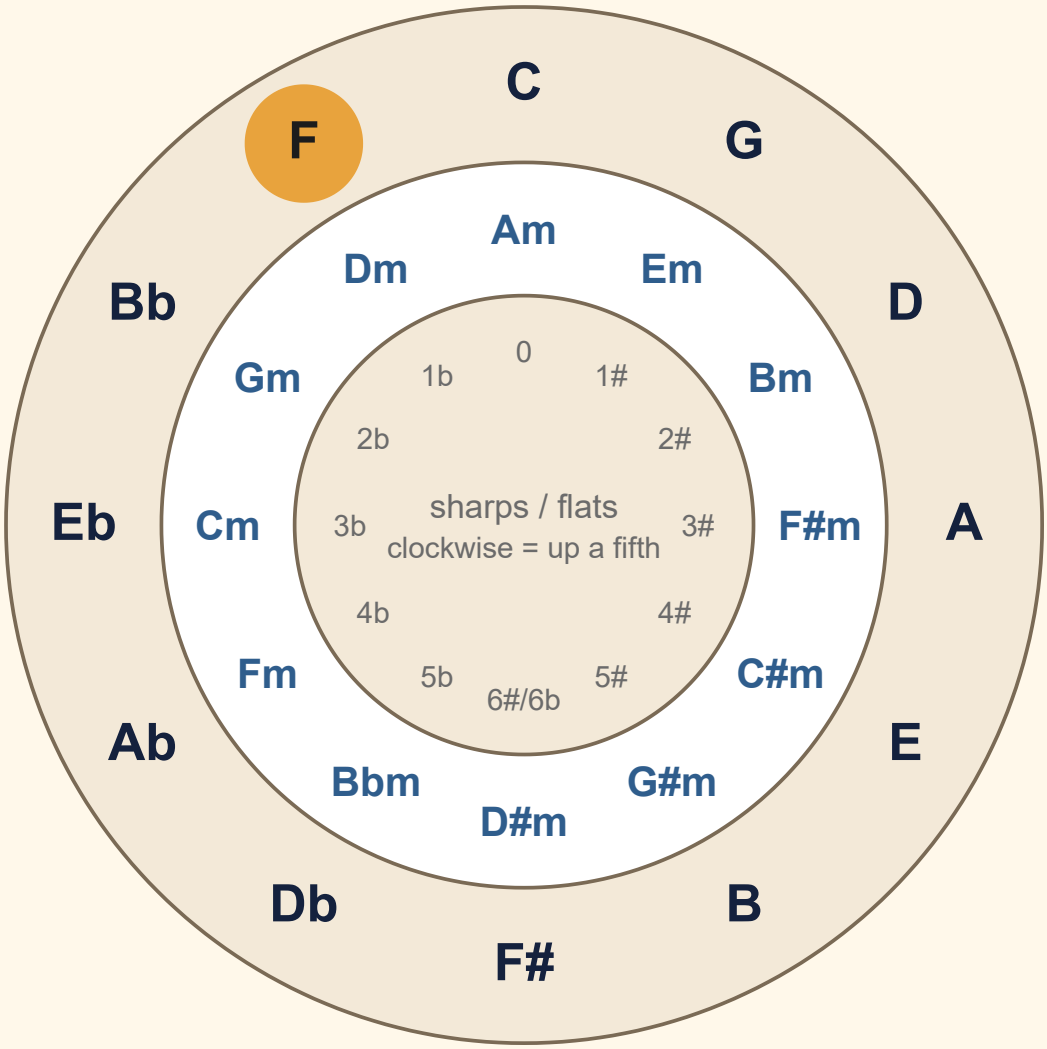
G is one step clockwise of C.

☐ Goal: Move from C to G using a chord both keys share.

EXERCISE 150 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Modulate from C to F

1. Play C, Dm, G7, C, then C7, F.
2. Dm is ii in C and vi in F; C7 is V of F.
3. Do the change twice and say which chord signals the new key.



F is one step counterclockwise of C.

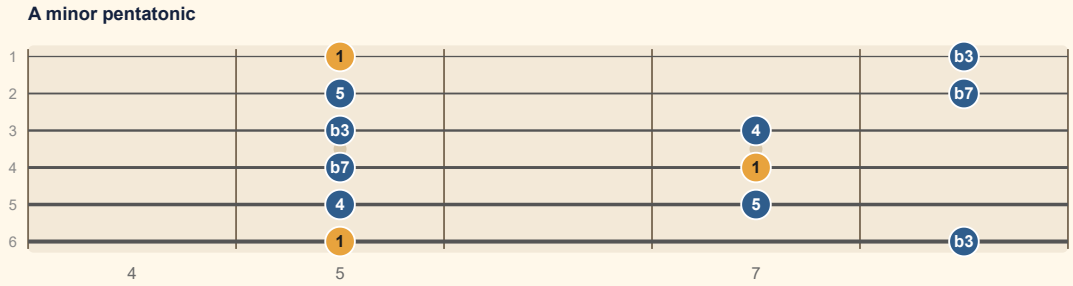
☐ Goal: Create a smooth modulation by using a pivot and a V7.

Week 16: Soloing with intention

EXERCISE 151 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: Loop and Breathe

1. Play or play back an Am loop (Am for two beats, G for two beats works fine) at a slow tempo.
2. Using only A minor pentatonic box 1, play one note per bar and leave the rest of the bar silent.
3. Repeat for eight bars, focusing on a clean tone and a steady pulse.



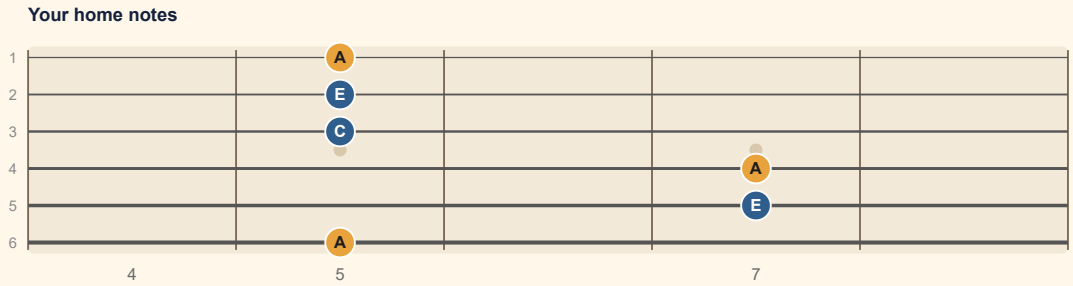
A minor pentatonic, box 1 (frets 5-8). Root A = 1.

☐ Goal: Get comfortable with space: a solo starts with the notes you choose not to play.

EXERCISE 152 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Start and End on A

1. Over the same loop, play four-note phrases that begin and end on the root A.
2. Use only box 1. Land the last note exactly on beat 1 of the next bar.
3. Try five different phrases, each with a different shape in the middle.



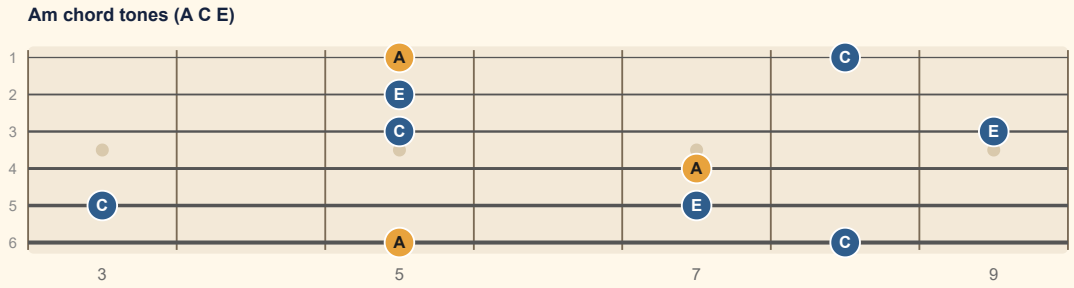
Three roots (A) in box 1 to start and end on. C and E are friendly neighbors.

☐ Goal: Hear how the root gives a phrase a sense of home.

EXERCISE 153 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: Chord-Tone Targets over Am

1. Over an Am chord, find every A, C and E in box 1.
2. Play a short run and aim to end on one of those three notes on each downbeat.
3. Say the note name out loud as you land on it.



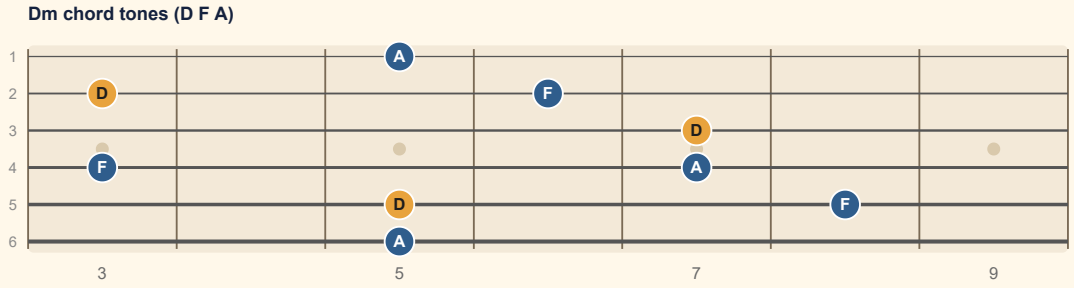
Chord tones of Am: A (root), C (b3), E (5). Frets 3-10.

☐ Goal: Aim your solo at the notes that are inside the chord.

EXERCISE 154 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Switch Targets with the Chord

1. Loop Am for two bars, then Dm for two bars.
2. Over Am, land on A, C or E. When Dm arrives, land on D, F or A.
3. Find the nearest target note to where you just were (move by a fret or two).



Dm chord tones: D (root), F (b3), A (5). A is shared with Am.

☐ Goal: Learn that the best target is the closest chord tone after a chord change.

EXERCISE 155 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Long, Short, Long

1. Over an Am loop, play a phrase with one long note, two short notes, then one long note.
2. Hold each long note for a full beat or more.
3. Repeat with five different note choices, always from box 1.

☐ Goal: Build rhythm contrast so phrases sound like sentences.

EXERCISE 156 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Question and Answer Phrases

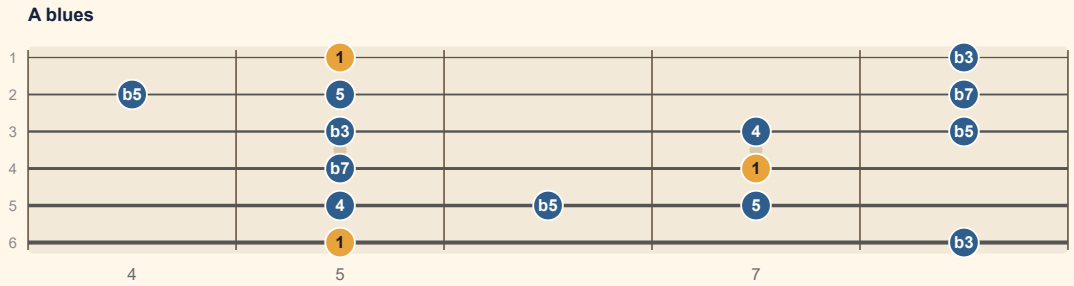
1. Play a two-beat phrase that ends away from the root (a question), for example on D or G.
2. Answer it with a two-beat phrase that ends on A.
3. Do this over four bars of the loop, then try again with new phrases.

☐ Goal: Hear how the end note changes the feeling of a phrase from open to closed.

EXERCISE 157 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: The Blue Note Pass

1. Find the b5 (Eb) of A on string 3, fret 8.
2. Over the Am loop, slide into it from D (fret 7) and resolve to E (fret 9) on the same string.
3. Do not rest on the blue note; use it as a passing color.



A blues scale, box 1. The b5 is the single added note beyond the pentatonic.

☐ Goal: Use a passing note for tension, then resolve it.

EXERCISE 158 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: Repeat and Vary

1. Make up a four-note motif in box 1 and play it twice exactly.
2. On the third time, change just the last note. On the fourth, change the rhythm.
3. Record yourself if you can and listen back.

☐ Goal: Learn that repetition with small changes sounds planned rather than random.

EXERCISE 159 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Phrasing with Vibrato and Slides

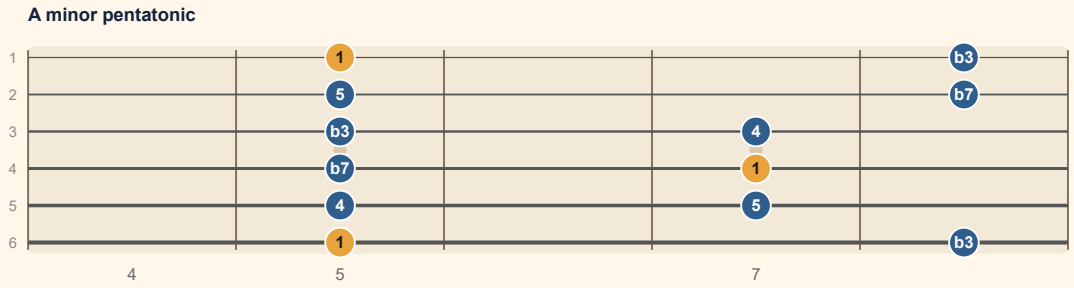
1. Pick three notes in box 1 and add either a slow vibrato or a slide into each one.
2. Play a four-bar solo using only those three notes, each with its own touch.
3. Keep the notes simple and the expression big.

☐ Goal: Shape each note: expression often matters more than speed.

EXERCISE 160 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Sixty-Second Solo

1. Set a one-minute loop on Am and G.
2. Play a full solo using targets, space, repeat-and-vary and one blue note.
3. Afterward, write down which idea worked best in one sentence.



A minor pentatonic, box 1 (frets 5-8). Root A = 1.

☐ Goal: Combine everything from this week into one short, complete solo.

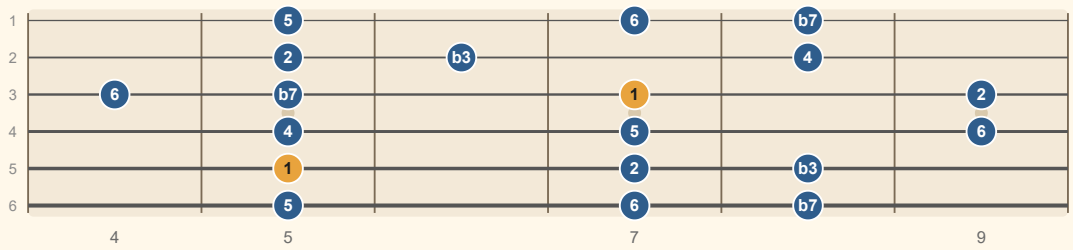
Week 17: Modal vamps and expression

EXERCISE 161 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: The D Dorian Vamp

1. Loop Dm7 for one bar and play it repeatedly.
2. Play D dorian across frets 5-10 and notice the natural 6 (B).
3. Land on B once and listen to the bright color it adds.

D dorian



D dorian: D E F G A B C. The 6 (B) is the note that separates it from natural minor.

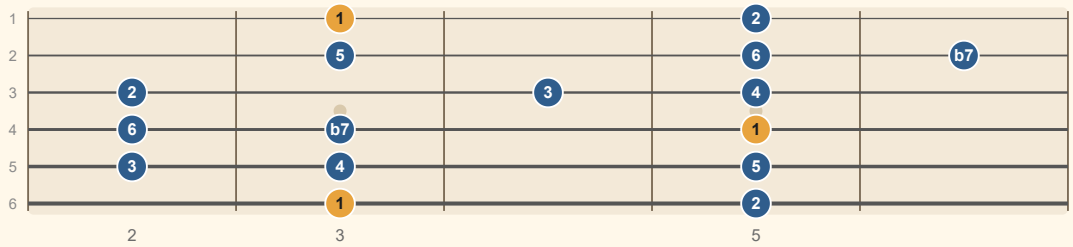
☐ Goal: Hear the color of the dorian b3 and natural 6 over one chord.

EXERCISE 162 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: The G Mixolydian Vamp

1. Loop G for one bar, then F for one bar (a G to F vamp).
2. Play G mixolydian: G A B C D E F. Land on F on the F bar.
3. Notice the b7 (F) in the G scale becomes the root of the F chord.

G mixolydian



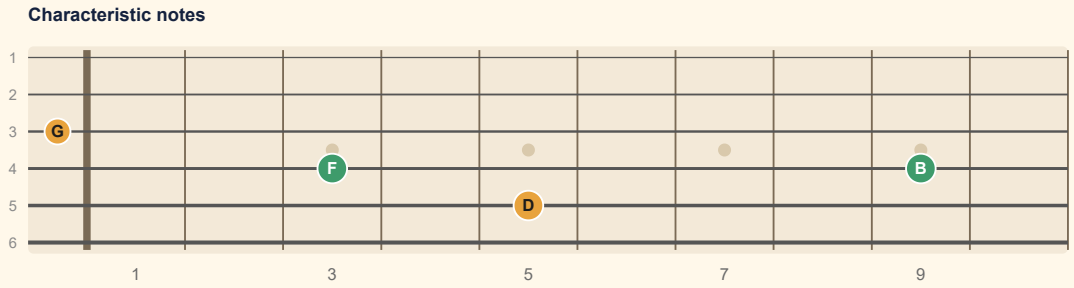
G mixolydian. The b7 is F: the same note as the root of the F chord.

☐ Goal: Feel why I to bVII is the classic mixolydian sound.

EXERCISE 163 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: Spot the Characteristic Note

1. Play D dorian for two minutes over a Dm7 loop, then play G mixolydian over a G loop.
2. In each, find and sustain the note that makes the mode special: the 6 (B) in dorian, the b7 (F) in mixolydian.
3. Say the degree out loud each time.



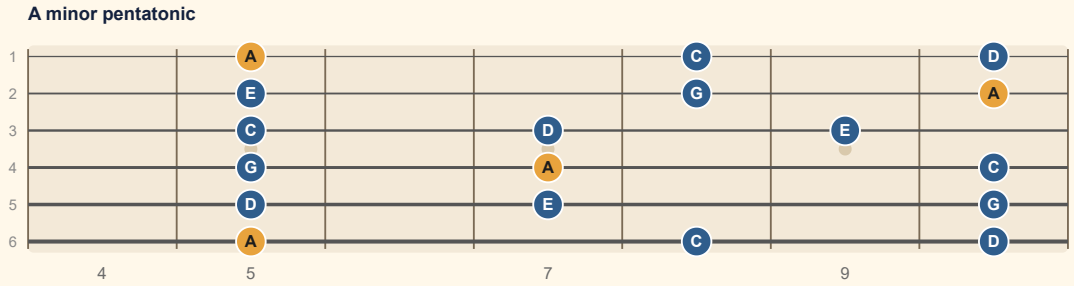
B (6 of D dorian) on string 4, fret 9; F (b7 of G mixolydian) on string 4, fret 3. Roots in color.

☐ Goal: Hear a mode through its one defining note.

EXERCISE 164 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Two Boxes, One Slide

1. In A minor pentatonic, play box 1 (frets 5-8) and box 2 (frets 7-10).
2. Notice that the boxes overlap at frets 7-8, and slide from one box to the next on the same string.
3. Climb through both boxes slowly, then come back down.



A minor pentatonic over frets 5-10: box 1 and box 2 overlap at frets 7-8.

☐ Goal: Start moving between positions instead of living in one box.

EXERCISE 165 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Slide Between Boxes in a Phrase

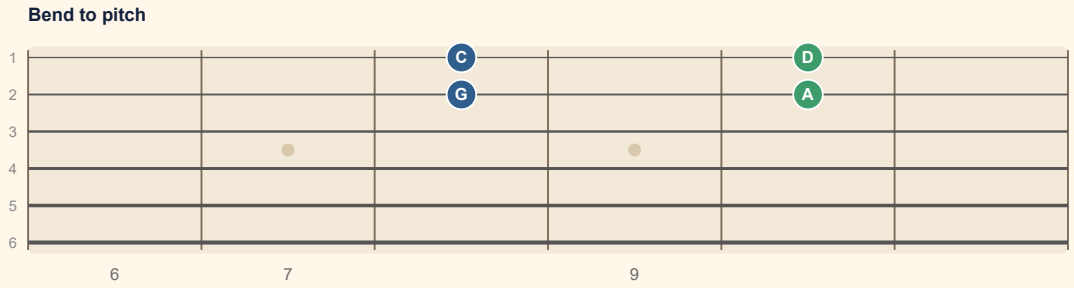
1. Over an Am loop, start a phrase in box 1, slide up a string to box 2, and end on A.
2. Plan the slide beforehand: choose the string and fret.
3. Do it five times and make the slide smooth, not rushed.

☐ Goal: Use position changes as a musical move.

EXERCISE 166 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Whole-Step Bend Target

1. Over Am, on string 2 fret 8 (G) bend up a whole step until it matches A (string 2, fret 10).
2. Play fret 10 first to hear the target, then bend fret 8 to meet it.
3. Hold the bent note for two beats with a slow vibrato.



G (str 2, fret 8) bends up a whole step to A (fret 10). C (str 1, fret 8) bends to D (fret 10).

☐ Goal: Learn to bend to a pitch you can already hear, not to a guess.

EXERCISE 167 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: Bend, Release, Land

1. Bend C (string 1, fret 8) up to D (fret 10), release back down to C, then land on A (string 1, fret 5).
2. Check each pitch against the fretted target note first.
3. Repeat at three different tempos.

☐ Goal: Control the release as well as the bend.

EXERCISE 168 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: Call and Response with a Loop

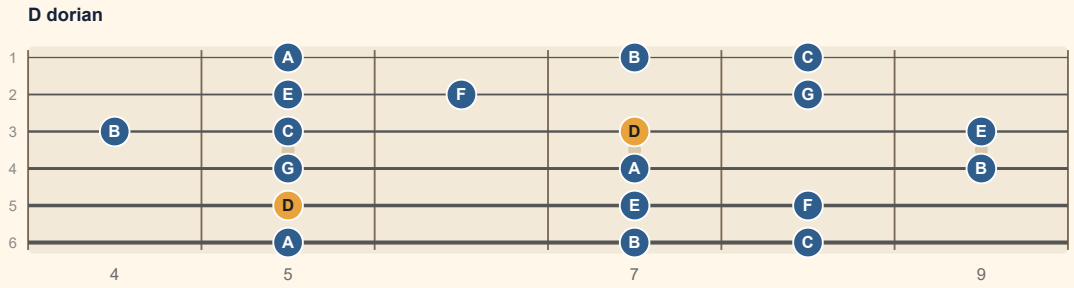
1. Play a two-beat call, then leave two beats of silence.
2. In the silence, hear your answer in your head, then play it.
3. Do eight calls and answers over an Am loop; keep each phrase short.

☐ Goal: Make your playing a conversation with yourself.

EXERCISE 169 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Echo Yourself

1. Play a three-note phrase, then repeat it a string higher or a box higher.
2. Answer with the same rhythm but different notes.
3. Try the same idea in D dorian over Dm7.



D dorian notes, frets 5-10, for your echo phrases.

☐ Goal: Use the same rhythm with different notes to build coherent responses.

EXERCISE 170 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Modal Mini-Solo

1. Pick one vamp (Dm7 or G to F) and set a one-minute loop.
2. Play a solo that uses the characteristic note at least twice, one bend, and one call and response.
3. Rate yourself 1-5 on each of those three ideas.

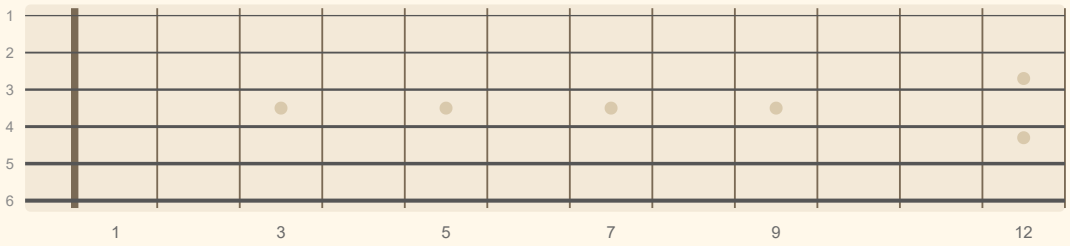
☐ Goal: Combine modal color, bends and conversation in one take.

Week 18: Working songs out and writing

EXERCISE 171 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 1: Find the Root by Ear

1. Put on a song you know well and hum the note that feels like home.
2. Find that note on your low E or A string by trial and error.
3. Check by playing it against the track; it should feel finished, not leaning.



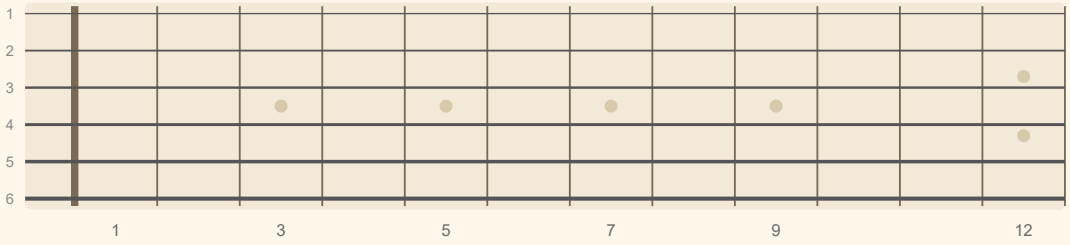
Mark your found root on this blank fretboard.

☐ Goal: Train your ear to the key center before reaching for any chart.

EXERCISE 172 — 5 MIN

Day 1, exercise 2: Sing It, Then Find It

1. Sing the first three notes of a simple melody on a neutral syllable.
2. Find them on string 2 or 1, one note at a time.
3. Write the note names you found.



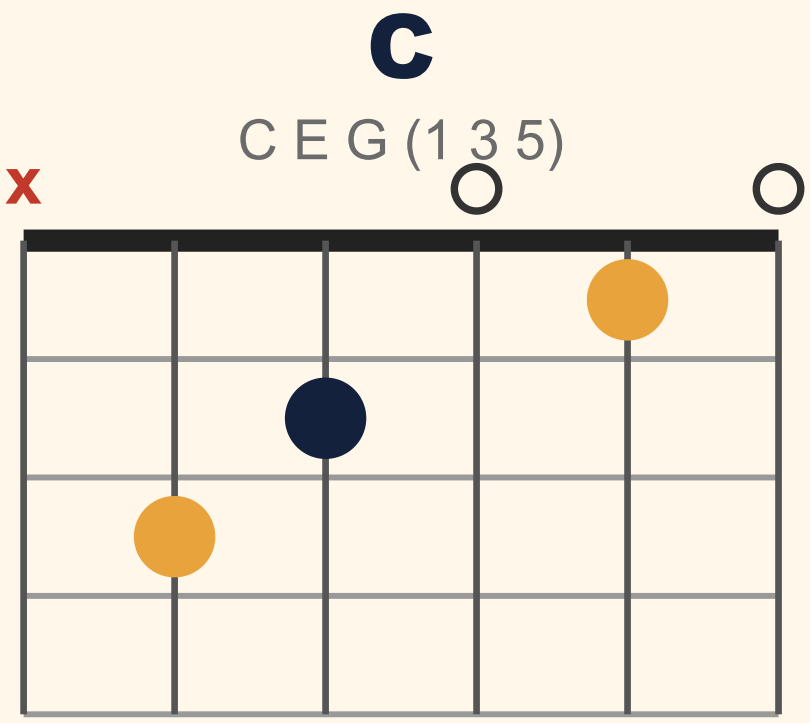
Write the first three notes of your melody on strings 1 and 2.

☐ Goal: Connect your singing voice to your fingers.

EXERCISE 173 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 1: Is It Major or Minor?

1. Play a major chord (C) and a minor chord (Am), then listen to a song's main chord.
2. Decide: does the home chord sound bright (major) or dark (minor)?
3. Confirm by playing the chord you guessed.



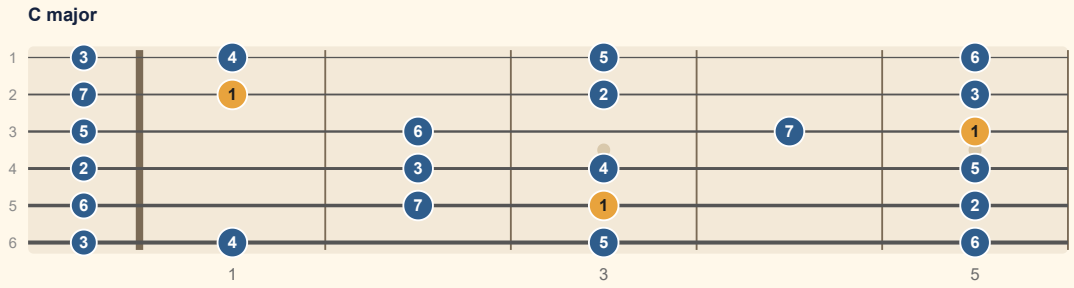
C major, the bright reference.

☐ Goal: Learn the first fork in ear work: bright or dark.

EXERCISE 174 5 MIN

Day 2, exercise 2: Name It by Degree

1. Pick a note from a melody and name it as a degree of the key (1 to 7).
2. Test: find the root, then count the steps in the major scale.
3. Do this for four different notes.



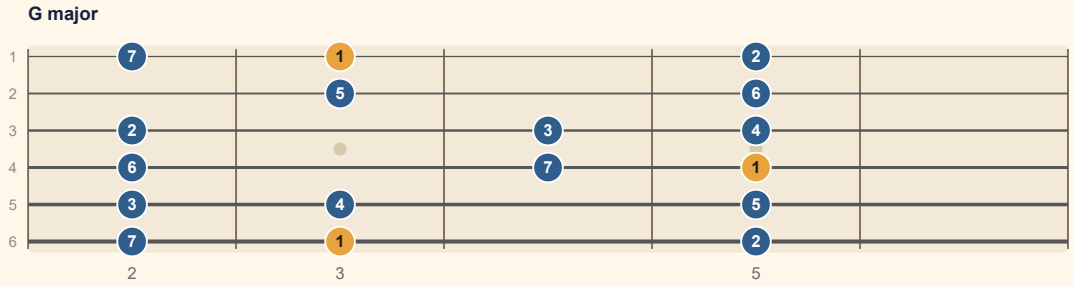
C major scale in degrees, frets 0-5. Use it to count your melody against the root.

☐ Goal: Think in degrees, because degrees transfer to every key.

EXERCISE 175 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 1: Transcribe in Degrees

1. Play four notes of a melody and write each as a degree: for example 1 3 5 3.
2. Then play the same degrees in a new key: start on G.
3. Notice that the melody is the same, only the root moved.



G major scale in degrees, frets 2-7.

☐ Goal: See that a transcription by degrees works in every key.

EXERCISE 176 5 MIN

Day 3, exercise 2: Hear the Bass Move

1. Choose a song with a clear bass line and find its first four bass notes on string 6 or 5.
2. Write them as note names and as degrees of the key.
3. Play them with a steady rhythm and listen for the chord changes.

☐ Goal: Use the bass line to reveal the chord progression.

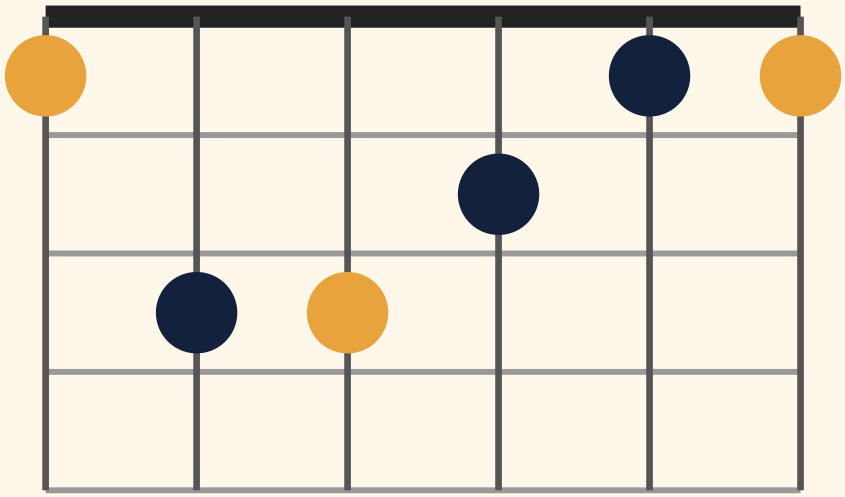
EXERCISE 177 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 1: Write a Progression

1. In C major, choose four chords from C, Dm, Em, F, G, Am. For example I vi IV V is C Am F G.
2. Play each chord for one bar and repeat for four loops.
3. Change one chord and listen to how the feeling changes.

F

F A C (1 3 5)



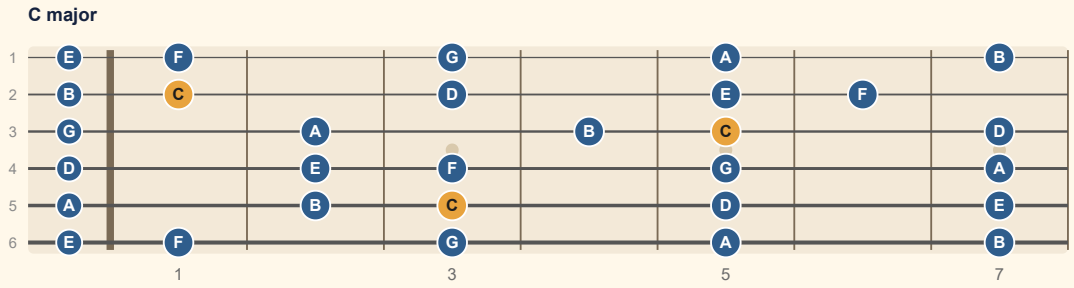
F major (E-form barre, root on string 6, fret 1) for IV in C.

☐ Goal: Create your own chord progression using the major scale harmony.

EXERCISE 178 5 MIN

Day 4, exercise 2: Add a Melody

1. Over your progression, sing a simple melody for four bars.
2. Find it on the fretboard using notes from C major.
3. Make the last note a chord tone of the final chord, ideally C.



C major scale notes, frets 0-7, for melody writing.

☐ Goal: Create a melody that fits your chords.

EXERCISE 179 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 1: Shape the Song

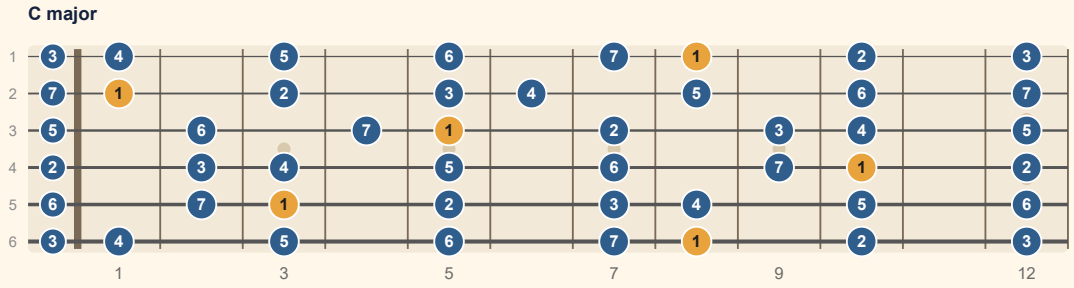
1. Give your song a section A (the progression and melody) and a short section B (a new chord order or a new starting note).
2. Play A, B, A without stopping.
3. Add one expressive touch: a slide, a bend or vibrato.

☐ Goal: Turn two ideas into a short form.

EXERCISE 180 5 MIN

Day 5, exercise 2: Final Mini-Project

1. Choose a key and write a four-chord progression plus a four-bar melody.
2. Play it three times: once with chords, once with only melody, and once with both.
3. Write down the key, chords by degree and melody by degree, and note your favorite choice.



The C major scale across the neck. Use any key you like; the degrees stay the same.

☐ Goal: Combine ear training, degrees, writing and phrasing into one finished piece.

Next step

Finish week 18, then go back to the weeks where you felt less sure and repeat them. Keep a small practice log of what you can do.